For my eyes only

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/76066431.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warnings:
No Archive Warnings Apply, Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
M/M

Fandom:
崩坏：星穹铁道 | Honkai: Star Rail (Video Game)

Relationships:
Mydei/Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Mydei & Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)

Characters:
Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Gorgo | Mydei's Mother (Honkai: Star Rail), Castorice (Honkai: Star Rail), Anaxa (Honkai: Star Rail), Krateros (Honkai: Star Rail), Eurypon (Honkai: Star Rail)

Additional Tags:
Top Phainon/Bottom Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Top Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Bottom Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Both men have trauma, Phainon pines really hard, Phainon has very emotional child hood trauma and self loathing, He sees himself as a horrible person, But ISN’T, Voyeurism, Exhibitionism, Masturbation, Masturbation in Shower, Sex Toys, May be more tags to add later, text conversations, Phainon is a lonely boy, Yes Phainon is a top, he just likes toys, Phainon has tried all types of porn and toys to see what he likes. Figured he'd be alone forever, Praise Kink, Body Worship, Nipple Piercings, Road blow jobs

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2025-12-20 Completed: 2026-04-26 Words: 85,305 Chapters: 17/17

For my eyes only

by AsuranDreamz

Summary

The CEO of the Evernight Restaurants is finally getting to do somehting he's longed for since he was young. To move out of mom and dad's. Under Mydei's watchful eye and skills behind a knife, he's now willing to spend some of his savings to buy a home of his own. But being a prominent member of society, there is always risks. So to make sure his new investment is safe, he needs the help of one tech wizard.

One tech wizard who has had a crush on the Ceo since he was a teenager; maybe to an unhealthy obescession. Will he be able to handle spending more time around the one thing he desires?

Notes

This story was inspired by the one PV that had implyed Phainon installed camera in Castrum Kremnos. This is taking that a little further.

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1

Thursday 12:34 PM

Up on the high-rise, around the 10th floor, sat the main office of the Evernight Restaurant chain. Five 4-star restaurants were located around the country, with the biggest here in Okhema city. Unlike some fancy restaurants, the waiting list was always very short. They tried very hard to accommodate everyone who wanted to dine.

The CEO's office had a special visitor today.

A tall woman in a grey suit was on the guest side of a huge office desk. “Mr. Deimos, I do wish to thank you again for this wonderful opportunity. The purchase of this estate will be just what you need to fully be on your own.” She was very relaxed in his presence. Everything was wonderful in their interactions.

Mydeimos Kremnos, the only heir to the Kremnos family fortune, head chef and CEO of the Evernight restaurants, was finally getting out on his own. He had been living with his parents for some time while finishing culinary and business school. Now that both schoolings were done and the restaurants were doing way better than before, his own place was a must.

He was a modest and simple man. He didn't need much, but a place to call his own and have some privacy. It was definitely needed after all the years of answering to butlers, maids, and his parents. Everyone was always a part of his business, whether he wanted them to or not.

Gorgo had mentioned to him in passing that his father had wanted him to find a partner and marry, but she knew her son. He was much like her in that he followed what his heart told him. When he wanted something, that's when he went after it. Knowing how determined he was to do well running his own company, she knew love wasn't even on the docket for him.

Proving himself as a capable leader and chef was the most important thing to him. Making good food was the glory that he sought after.

Now that all restaurants were turning a much better profit than before he took over, he used a small portion of his income and finally bought a house. Most of the other time, a good portion went to charity.

It was a modern home, but not overly eccentric. Most with money bought places that were just for show, hardly living in them. He wanted something practical.

He only had a few requirements for it: a restaurant-grade kitchen so the things he made there could also be made by his staff; a pool; and room enough for workout equipment. Keeping a fit mind and body was always a philosophy of his. Also, a room big enough for a small library. The books he'd collected over the years were steadily growing, plus the addition of artifacts he'd collected from various places. His own private collection was very important to him.

The biggest thing of all? Privacy. Away from the town and people. He liked the peace of nature. There were a bunch of places that had made offers. Everyone wanted the best head chef in the city to live in their establishment. There was a collective disappointment when he chose to buy his own place. They were all looking for clout.

And it just so happens that Mrs. Vipsania had the perfect place for him. It actually had a bit more features than what he was looking for, but the requirements were still met.

Finishing up a text she was in, "I was just in contact with your parents, and they will be getting the movers to get your stuff in right away. Looking through everything..." Shuffling through all the paperwork to make sure it was all signed and dated, "...We are good to go." She handed him the keys to the place.

"Mrs. Vipsania, I greatly appreciate your time in finding this place for me. I know I will be more than happy to finally be on my own. This place is just

perfect. Thank you." Shaking her hand, she bowed and departed his office. On the way out, she passed his secretary coming in.

Finally getting a chance to sit, he poured a glass of imported pomegranate juice. “Congratulations on your new place, sir.”

“Thank you, Miss Castorice. Drink?” Offering her a glass.

She politely shook her head no. “I do hope that this new place will be less stressful for you. I know you have been complaining about home life for quite some time. Being an adult, you do need your privacy.”

He motioned for her to sit. “Yes, I agree. It was more than needed. It was very hard to even get five minutes to myself some days. At least now, I can finally drive that car I got to pick for my birthday a few years back.”

“Are you going to be alright not having any support people there? Just by yourself?” She was concerned that the heir was going to need help in his single living conditions.

“OK, yes, the place is a bit more on the fancy side, but not as bad as others. At least that gives me a chance to almost be a normal person.” Sighing, he looked through the pictures of the place. There was a lot he was going to need to learn. Book and knife skills are one thing. Regular living skills were another.

Being from a prominent family, it was hard to know what normal life was like. Everything was always taken care of for you, never having to do anything for yourself. Until one day, many, many moons ago, and much shorter in height, when he meandered into the kitchen before anyone was up, startling their head chef, who was concerned the young master needed something.

He did.

It was to learn.

He was always fascinated by food and the culinary arts, so he took it upon himself to learn, even if in secret. The chef was more than happy to teach the inquisitive young man about his craft. Everything he had learned over 45 years in the kitchen was going to be passed on. Seeing the passion in the young master's eyes was so prideful for him. Those skills he was taught helped him through school and to be where he is now. That head chef was as proud as a parent.

Yes, some may be called in to do menial tasks for him, but almost every day, he would be doing everything on his own. Making his own food, cleaning, driving; he wanted to do it all, even going to a grocery store to shop.

He was more than excited to finally live his life how he wanted.

“I was wondering if you could put a call into the head of my security team? I wish to have a meeting with him.” Gathering up the documents, everything was filed in a folder, all except for the blueprints of the house.

Castorice pulled out her tablet and sent the message as requested.

It just so happened the head of the tech office was in the building, so the reply was quick.

“He can be here in 5 minutes. If you have the time?”

Mydei was surprised that the message came back that quickly. “Yes, please, if he is available.”

Within the said five minutes, there came a knock at his door. Mydei stood to accept his company. “Door’s open.”

A young man, around Mydei's age, poked his head in the door. “You called for me, Mr. Deimos?”

“Yes, please, Mr. Khaslana. Please come in.”

The head of his security team, Phainon Khaslana, was a tech wizard from the Telesaltes Technology Company (TTC). He made sure all of the

restaurants had round-the-clock security. Because the price of some ingredients was very high, it could be the cause of theft. The computer system that was used by all restaurants was kept under regular maintenance and security. All staff and customers needed their orders and information secured.

Phainon was the man who headed the whole team of six. He had a bright and bubbly personality, always keeping the mood up, even when some felt down. Amongst most of his kitchen staff and office, Phainon stood out the most. He was the only man Mydei had ever known with hair that could rival the first snowfall and eyes brighter than any gemstone on the market.

“Please have a seat.” Picking up the bottle he was drinking, he motioned it towards the security head. “Can I offer you a drink?”

Smiling, Phainon couldn't resist, “Who am I to turn down such a good offer? Anything that you've ever offered me was amazing. What were you able to get a hold of this time?”

Grabbing a glass from the cabinet behind him, Mydei poured the juice, “Imported pomegranate juice from my homeland. My parents had recently come back and brought me a few bottles. How it is cultivated and made is quite different from other places.”

Handing him the glass, Phainon treated it like a fine wine. Seeing how it swirled in the glass, the smell, and even the texture on his lips, everything was different and amazing about it. It was thicker, but richer. You could taste something different in the mix.

“If I may ask, what makes this so different in taste?”

“It's how it's made. The grove where they are has trees with and without fruit. The two are combined to make a different flavor. You get a minor hint of cranberry or grape, depending on your taste buds or just the flower.” He takes another drink of it. Mydei never savors it like wine; he grew up on it, so he consumed it just like water.

“Incredible. Thank you for sharing this with me. So, I did get a message from Miss Castorice stating, "You wanted to see me?” He was hoping the meeting wasn't a bad thing. Sometimes you can never tell.

“Yes. Since you and your team do such an impeccable job at security for both our real and internet world…”

Phainon could feel his cheeks getting a little red. “Now, sir, please. We don't need that kind of adoration. We are just doing our jobs.” He wasn't used to getting this kind of praise, certainly not from the head of everything.

“No, I insist. Since I have had your team in charge of things, I have not had a problem.“ Sitting down, he pulled out the blueprints to the house. “I was wondering if I could give YOU a special task?”

Phainon pointed to himself, confused.

Mydei smiled at the gesture. It almost looked like a confused puppy.

Gawd, that smile is gorgeous. He is an utterly attractive man. The hair, glasses, suit, and physique. Shit, it's all perfect. I could get lost in all of him.~ Phainon was lost in thought.

“Yes, you.” Sliding the documents towards him, “Just 15 minutes ago, I finished all the documents securing a purchase of a new home.”

Phainon’s face lit up with excitement. “That's wonderful news. I'm so glad to hear that, but how am I involved with this?”

“I would like you personally to set up and manage security at the place.” Phainon almost choked on his drink.

He felt like a bomb had just exploded in his mind. The man he's lusted after for years is asking HIM. Not his team. HIM to manage it. His insides almost didn't know what to do.

“If I can be so bold, sir? Not to question your judgment, but why just me?” *Shit.. is he offering for me to watch him? Like I don't get to see him enough*

as is, but to be the sole person.. fuck-he can feel his excitement growing- … *I need to calm down, I don't need to be showing anything bad in his office.*

“You, I feel, are the most skilled on your team. The constant schooling you put yourself through to keep up with the changes in technology is impressive. Most don't go as far as you.” Phainon wasn't sure he could handle all this praise from someone who looked like a stunning sunset.

“And I would rather leave it to just one person. It is the whole reason why I bought the place where I did. Privacy. I don't need everyone knowing where I live.”

“It is understandable, it would give you peace of mind then.” *Not me, fuck. Dream come true. Then again, it's the only chance I'll get. Rumor has it that he isn't interested in either sex. So I probably don't have a chance, but to get to stare at him more often, even if through video. I'll fucking take it.*

“If you are not busy, I would like you to accompany me to the house to see where security could be set up. That copy of the blueprint is yours if you'd like to take notes on it.” Reaching behind him, he grabbed his jacket. A simple black one with a small gold lion pin, matching the rest of his attire. Black pants and a turtleneck finished off the look.

“Actually, no, I am not busy. It would be an honor to be the first guest in your new home. Let me run back to the office to get my tablet, and I'll meet you at the front doors?” Phainon was having the hardest time holding in his elation. This is the first time in the 7 years they have known each other that they would get to be alone. No one around but them. No security. He was the security.

“I will see you there, thank you so much again.” Watching the snow-haired man leave, he was more than excited to get this set up and finally get to live something relatively normal.

After the man had left the office, Mydei packed his things up for the day. Making sure everything had its place. Locked up if need be. He had already had a few amenities taken to the house when they had agreed to buy the place. There was already word given from the head of the realtor company

that he could move some stuff in before signing. He had clout because of his family name.

Now that it was his, he wanted to be there. All plans were for him to spend the weekend there, officially moving in. It was Friday night, and work didn't come around again till Wednesday morning. An extra two days were taken to move stuff in.

Grabbing his bag and keys, he headed out to his secretary's desk. “I'm off, Miss Castorice. I am taking Mr. Khaslana to the house to plan out security for it. If you don't have anything pressing to do, please take the rest of the afternoon off.”

Her smile was always sweet and warm. “Thank you so much, sir. There are a few more reports I need to handle since you won't be back till the middle of next week. I want to get them settled before then, and after I will happily take your offer. I hope you two get everything squared away with it.“

“Again, your hard work is always appreciated. I will see you next week,” he started towards the elevator.

“You too, Mr. Deimos.”

On the other side of the office…

Phainon was in a tizzy. Trying to get his stuff together and not be excited to spend alone time with the hottest single man in the city was getting to him.

“I can do this. I CAN be professional……shit, I don't know. Fuck. Why do I have to want something I can't touch?” Finishing up his bag, he goes to leave. The future prospects looked promising to say the least.

When he got down to the front, there was no fancy car. No driver.

Then a sleek black car pulled up to him. When it stopped, he noticed a maroon iridescence shining in the sunlight. The car was simply beautiful. Stunning. Then there was the diver.

Mydei got out of the driver's seat to greet him.

Phainon was dumbfounded. He didn't know that the heir to the Kremons dynasty could drive, and he didn't think that he'd be allowed to. All expectations were now being thrown out the window.

Phainon also didn't know which was more ravishing: the car or the driver. Noticing his hair was now pulled back in a messy bun, the driver won that battle. He was trying so hard not to drool. Dressed down or up, his man was getting to him.

“Wow, this is yours?” He tried to cover up his staring.

“Yes, it is. I got this a while ago. I just never get a chance to drive it much because you know….being CEO and family. I did tell them that once I got my own place, I was driving more often, without a chauffeur. Only when I'm working would I possibly allow it.” Leaning back on it, the weight that he's been feeling for a long time is slowly starting to melt away.

“Can I touch it?” *I mean fuck, I'd like to touch you right now. You look too hot against that. Ohh, what I could do on and in that car. Shhhiiit, I know what I'm thinking about tonight.*

Mydei moved out of the way so Phainon could inspect it. The shape was beautiful. Pristine condition. “What kind of color is this? It isn’t a solid black.”

“No, it's a special chromium color. Custom-made. It is black for the most part, but then it shines shades of red to dark red in the light. Besides the specks of gold that are in the paint.”

Moving in just the right angle to catch the sun, he was able to see all the shades of the car.

“The reds are so beautiful, they match your hair.”

Inside, Mydei's system stopped, like a rock was thrown into the gears running a perfectly working clock. He's gotten compliments all his life,

been praised for everything. This one tiny sentence broke his brain. He couldn't find the reason why.

Clearing his throat, “Thank you. Are you ready to go then?”

Running pale fingers gently over the shape of the hood, seeing from his peripheral vision, amber eyes were watching his ministrations. Caressing the curves of the vehicle. Phainon stood up. “Yes, sir, I am.” He was definitely enjoying himself.

Opening the door, he got into the passenger seat. The insides shared some of the vibrant red that was shimmering in the paint. The seat was comfortable; his butt was cushioned so well. He could take a nap here. Very spacious with tons of leg room. It was new enough to have a computer system in the dashboard.

Mydei gets in beside him, turning the key.

“You know, sir…”

“Mydei,” He interrupted.

“Huh?? You're letting me call you by your shortened name. No one gets to do that.” Phainon was stunned that he was being given such a privilege.

“Well, for one, I'm not at work. So it's fine. And two, I would like to, or well I don't know if you'd allow me…….to consider you a friend?? We have known each other for ages. 8 years soon?” Phainon could feel the nervousness in his words. With his position, Mydei never really got close to anyone. Always making sure to keep the most professional attitude towards everyone. Everyone was on an equal level in his eyes. From just a simple dishwasher to members of the board and all in between. Everyone meant something to this place.

“I would be more than honored to be considered your friend ... Mydei.” Phainon savored the name coming off his lips. He was just permitted to do something so grandiose and secret. Like finding a treasure no one knew about.

The ride was quiet up to the house. Phainon kept his bag on his lap for many good reasons. Looking out the window, he pushed his lips together. He knew the reason. The major one was his excitement. His dick and heart. This whole day had been beyond his wildest fantasy, and those have happened a lot over the years. Probably more frequent going forward. The second was to try and keep his mind off being in a car with another person.

Phainon had been Mydei's admirer for years. Never getting any further than that. Always more than an arm's reach away was the beautiful Adonis statue behind a gated fence. No one was allowed entry.

Now?

Now things have changed. That distance feels much closer now. He wasn't sure how to handle it all.

In all his distraction, the car had stopped, and he was very much unaware.

Mydei grabbed his shoulder and shook him a little.

“Huh?? Sorry, I was lost deep in thought. Just enjoying the view.” *It's mostly you, though. Gawd, if you only knew how bad I want you. I HAVE to be a good boy. I can't screw this up.*

“Oh, sorry. I didn't mean to disturb your thoughts. We are sorta here. I did send you the print also to your phone so you can handle the technical aspect of it.” Mydei got out of the car, walking around to the gate.

“I could just sit here and watch that beautiful ass walk all day. Dammit, behave. He makes it so difficult, though.” Grabbing his tablet, he made his way over to his employer.

“I do want to have some type of security at the gate. Not sure. What would you suggest? There is a fence around the grounds. It was put in with nature in mind, I'm told.”

Pulling up the plans, Phainon could see all the details for the property. Doing a rough few sketches on it. A camera with a double security keypad

and a matching ‘key’ for the car. Perimeter sensors, with new features to detect animals from people.

“Easy enough. What do you think?” Handing the sketches to him.

Mydei looked it all over, not noticing Phainon was taking in the whole experience. The sun was just at the right height to illuminate all of Adonis’ features. He wanted to burn it into his memory. The way the sunset hair lay on the back of his neck. Muscles moved under the shirt as he cycled through things on the tablet. The sun makes everything on his face bewitching.

Phainon did know, though, that this outing had thoroughly ruined him. Seeing another side of Mydei was just heaven.

The tech wizard was content where he was at. Knowing that his position had moved up in Mydei's circle, now being called a friend. Maybe he could spend more time with the untouchable man.

“Looks good. Let's head to the house.”

Getting back in, they made it the rest of the way. Once parked by the front door, Phainon took note of visible and blind spots.

Not paying my attention while drawing, the door opened for him, and his bag was taken. When he finally looked up, he was so smitten and confused at the same time.

“You were so busy writing, I figured I'd help out by getting the door and your bag.”

“Sorry, I just get lost in my work sometimes.” Putting the pen back in its slot, he left the car. Once the door was shut, he took in the place. It was modern but had some old-world charm to it. A combination of future and Greek architecture. Very different. Seemed to fit the owner well.

“Once we get the tour and details set, can I make you something for all your troubles?” Putting the key in, he left Phainon standing by the car,

dumbfounded again.

Hurrying up to meet him in the foyer, “Wait, wait, wait!?!? Thee CEO of Evernight restaurants and heir to the Kremnos dynasty…wants to cook… for me!?!?”

Mydeu looked at him with a straight face, internally laughing at his minor hysterical moment. “Yes, I do. Why is that so hard to grasp? I've asked you to do a pretty large task and have you leave the office to do it. It's one of my ways of showing thanks.” Besides covering the equipment and installation costs.

“I mean it isn’t every day that THEE Deimos cooks for just ONE person, so I will humbly and graciously accept it.” Bowing to him like a prince.

“Come now, it isn't that special. I cook at the restaurants fairly often.”

“I know that. We get a lot more foot traffic when people know you're there on those nights. But thank you truly, it means so much.” Phainon is internally screaming right now. If he is sleeping, he doesn't want to wake up. This is all so perfect.

Setting the bags down at the entrance, they make their way through the rest of the house. Surveillance and locks for the garage. The pool area had a high enough wall, but cameras were there just in case, on the outside. A few other places he wanted security, and they were duly noted.

Walking down the hall, Phainon stopped, staring at the tablet. They were standing by the master bedroom. Mydei had halted a few feet in front of him.

“This should be the master suite. Would you mind if I looked around? Just to double-check the area.”

“No, please, you're the security expert. When you are finished, I'll meet you in the kitchen. I'll go get dinner started.” Phainon acted like he was working, in all actuality, watching the sexiest man in his world walk away.

It was starting to become one of his favorite things. Getting to do this more than once a day was the best dessert ever.

Ohhhh, he's gonna be the death of me. What I wouldn't give…..

Shaking his head and biting his lip, he entered a most special of spaces. The master bedroom was large. The bed was across from the door, against the wall. Balcony door to the left of the bed. Same length window matching on the right. A smaller fireplace than the living room adorned the wall opposite the bathroom. Not much was in the room right now, besides a bed and a nightstand.

Wandering around the room, he took in all the nooks and crannies. Taking note in his head.

The far end of the left side was the bathroom. It housed a marble shower with a seat. Impressive overhead shower head. A large step led into an equally big jacuzzi/ tub combination.

His mind was wandering, looking at everything. There were a few extra cameras he wanted to install that only he had access to. Others may occasionally guard the house. But the lead, he had other plans.

Smells from the kitchen drifted down the hall. Phainon was almost drooling, taking them all in. *I guess I'm done gawking now. Notes are taken. But dammit, that cooking is making me more hungry, so I guess it's time to eat.*

The kitchen was alive with flavor when he walked in, taking a seat at the kitchen island. With the flat top grill on the island, he got to watch a master at work. The meat and vegetables were handled with utmost care. Dancing in between utensils and sauces. He'd never seen something so amazing. Yes, some steak houses put on a show, but that's it. A SHOW. This was a show like no other. Magic, it felt like. Everything has such meticulous timing that it almost seemed like a dream.

The best part was the cook. Sleeves rolled up, hair in a tighter bun, no glasses, and complete concentration.

He wonders to himself, what would he have to do to get this more often? But maybe that is a thought for another time. Now it's time to enjoy the best meal he has ever had in his life.

They always say, A way to a man's heart is through his stomach.

Phainon wanted to return his heart on a gold platter.

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

Phainon was up bright and early to get started on his new project. The sooner he was done, the sooner he could enjoy the presence of the man of his dreams. But breakfast didn't turn out quite how he expected. Many revelations happened with the Prince's heart wide open.

With everything settled, it was time for the boss to go finish packing. But his biggest mistake, changing shirts in front of the man who is pinning for you so badly. With the boss now gone, what's a smitten, horny boy to do?

Ohhhh we know

Chapter Notes

no true beta read.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The next morning, Phainon was too eager to get up. So much of the day was ahead of him.

Sneaking a few pictures of the prince yesterday was just what he needed when arriving home. They were taken for all reasons, but the one last night: self-pleasure.

Before, he'd have to use pictures and clips saved from news articles. But now, these ones were candid. Showing Mydei in a different light than most see him. Yes, he was still regal and stunningly handsome, but these were him being most normal. A side no one gets to see.

But now he is.

And he knew the dirty truth. It was only going to get better for him. Was it illegal? Yes. But there was part of him he didn't let anyone see. There were things that gave him pleasure that most would think are wrong.

Now that there was a clear opportunity, he wasn't going to leave it. He was taking it full force.

Finishing trying to make himself presentable, he hurried down to the tech store for the order. After they were done eating last night, Phainon sent it in. Because of knowing the owner for so long and a repeat customer, it was available first thing after opening.

Installing a home security system was going to be a breeze. Much simpler than running a restaurant. A two story house, with specific rooms, would take no time at all to complete.

The drive back to the house felt the same as yesterday, just without a handsome man driving him there. Well, except for himself. Phainon knew the looks he carried. Many of both sexes have tried asking him out, but have been politely declined. Even if it wasn't going to happen, one man had a hold of his soul, and he was happy to leave the reins where they were. Even if they were never taken up, he didn't care.

Parking beside the black chromium car in the early morning light was just as beautiful as yesterday. The colors danced before him. That car was a piece of art, but oh, how he wanted to do things with it.

Gawd, what I wouldn't give to lay you over that hood, under me. The beautiful sunset hair was sprayed about. Holding onto my arms, begging for more. It's definitely going to need to be washed after we are done with it.

At least he knew the prince was still home. Phainon, bag in hand, made his way to the door.

Knock

….

…..

……

……

Is he still in bed?? Phainon was really confused.

Knock

…..

……

…….

Still, no sounds were heard. Going against his better judgment, he grabbed the handle and twisted. He was able to turn it the whole way and open the door.

Part of Phainon's heart sank. Did something happen to him after they parted?? Someone came in and murdered the heir?! So many things were running through his mind.

Setting the bags down, the door was shut without a sound. Walking down the hall to the left, listening. Nope, no sounds there. Checking all the available rooms, clear as well. He was going to do a downstairs check before going up. As he got closer to the kitchen, many sounds could be heard.

“Singing??” He wasn't sure, but was going to find out in 3 more steps forward.

The kitchen was brimming with smells and sounds. The first thing that hit his senses was freshly baked bread. It was all distinct. Fresh savory bread and ones that were sweet. He's never had the pleasure of being in a bakery first thing in the morning. He was salivating at all the smells.

The grill and stove were busy with all sorts of ingredients. Meats and vegetables were in bowls on separate sides. Sauces and spices lined each side as well. A personal phone was hooked up to a speaker, playing a random mix of songs. Mydei knew all the words to the songs in his playlist.

Goddamn, even his singing is beautiful. I almost want to cry how delightful this all is. It's like something out of a fan fiction for their favorite character. Yupp. That's it. I'm done. No one will ever match up to this man. He is just fucking perfect. He isn't some typical rich man. Right now, possibly forever, he has my heart and dick. If I can't be with him, then no one is getting me. I'll die before I sleep with someone else.

The focal point of the whole kitchen: One sexy prince, in tight, worn blue jeans and a simple black tight t-shirt. The bun wasn't as tight as last night, but he neglected to fix it before starting food.

I know I shouldn't, but when am I going to see his sexy ass in jeans again?? I'm already feasting, thank you.

A quiet picture was taken from the entryway. His mind wandered. What if this is going to become a new thing? Catching candid pictures of the prince. He thought it was a good time. All just for him.

Readjusting himself, he knocked on the wall to the room. “Good morning, sir.”

Mydei stopped mid flip of some vegetables, looking his way. The glasses were back adorning his face. Along with the messy bun…

Gawd, that looks like a face that needs to be ruined. It's just so beautiful. Dammit! Why did I have to fall for a man so far out of my league? I mean, hell, if he doesn't like either sex, then I guess I really don't have any chance.

“Good morning, Mr. Khas…”Mydei stopped himself mid-sentence, coughing to clear his throat. He reached up, taking the bun out and redoing it to look more presentable. “ Good morning, Phainon.”

Aww, why do you have to look sexier for me? I appreciate it.

Walking towards the seat he was at last night, he never took his eyes off the chef. Sitting down, he was finally able to start.

“Mydei, you don't have to call me…”

“No, I do. It is only fair. I would also like to try and be a semi-normal person when I'm at home. No reverence here. Isn't that what friends do?”

*‘**What friends do???’** He was very serious last night about it. He wants to try and be a normal person. Not just some untouchable leader. Why do you have to do more things to hurt my heart? Your kindness and caring, fuck. I'm not going to be able to handle being called by my first name. I shouldn't keep wasting his time.*

Before Phainon could say another word, his eyes were back on the chef. The strong, but delicate fingers were making intricate slices in the strawberries. Each cut was precise. The love and care that went into each slice was also slicing into his heart.

“Sir, not that I don't appreciate being taken care of. I do. I'm just not sure why me?”

Never looking up from his cuts, “Why not? Do you think because you are my employee, that I shouldn't be appreciative of what you are doing for me?”

Phainon couldn't help but rub the back of his head. “ Honestly, kinda.”

Setting the knife and fork down, the grill was turned off. Mydei started to strip the gloves off his hands, proceeding next with the apron.

Ohhhh shit??? Did I do something wrong? I did.

Mydei started to walk around the counter towards him.

Ohhh fuck. I did it now. Should I not have questioned him? I mean…..his family does have money and connections. ~his eyes widened internally~ *Is he going to off me?? Ohh shit. I guess that was my last meal yesterday.*

Mydei stopped beside him, pulling up a stool. Sitting down, he crossed his fingers. A deep sigh came from him.

“Phainon, look….” Looking over at the man, he could see wheels going 1000 miles an hour in all directions. Panicked in thought. Grabbing his shoulder lightly, he shook the man next to him. “When you come back, I'll continue.”

The wheels finally coming to a screeching halt, he then looked to see the most stunning amber eyes looking at him. Phainon could see a level of sadness in them. One emotion he didn't think the prince ever carried.

Why does he look amazing, even sad? This man is so fucking gorgeous up close. Dammit, the things I'd love to do to that face. Holding those luscious locks….

Taking a deep breath, Mydei sighed, “I guess it's my place to apologize then.”

“YOU?? Apologize for what??”

“ I assumed too much that we could be friends.”

Phainon's heart broke into a million pieces. Dread filled his entire core. “I…..I…I don't understand.”

“I was hoping maybe, just maybe, you would be different. Everyone around me has always put me on an untouchable pedestal. That I was something to revere and worship. Even as a child, I didn't have many friends. I did have one. When I was very young, maybe 5-ish. It was the maid's son. I only knew him for a short while. I saw him four times a week. Till I didn't. He stopped coming around.”

Phainon almost forgot how to breathe. He was getting to hear Mydei's life story. No one gets that. “Was something wrong?? Like, why did he stop?”

Tears were just hitting the side of his eyes. He was trying so hard to keep them in. For him, a proud lion doesn't show this level of weakness around

his pride. He had to be strong for those around him.

I want to touch him so badly. Wipe the tears. Hold him close. Coming to me for comfort. I wish you would need me like that. Use me for whatever you need.

“I only knew him for about two years.” His lips got pulled into his mouth, still trying to hold back. “It wasn't until I was almost 16 that my family's bodyguard let slip what happened. He said something, and I wouldn't let him not say it. I finally got it out of him that the boy had died.”

Phainon was about ready to cry, hearing it all.

“I have a feeling they were never going to tell me because they didn't want me to be sad. He had an illness that was making his life very short. His mother had mentioned her work to him, and that she took care of another boy his age. Clearing it with my parents, she brought him to come play with me, as HIS last wish. No one ever told me he was sick…….. because I'm too special. Sadness was apparently not something I should have known as an heir to a huge family.” His fists were tight, knuckles almost white. Anger and sadness were fighting to burst forth from the dam.

“I'm so sorry, that's horrible. Someone should have explained it. Said something.” Shoving all his feelings to the side, he was also upset that no one told him.

“Soooo that brings me to now.”

Phainon just sat quietly, listening.

“I see that I have offended you, and I'm sorry. I guess I was wrong to think you wouldn't have me on that pedestal as well. Even though I have all the money in the world at my disposal, friendship isn't something I can afford.” He couldn't stop them now; soft rivers were flowing down his face. His heart was broken reliving it all. “I'll just call someone to bring you lunch later. I have…”

Phainon grabbed his hand. Squeezing it tight, “Please…. Please don't cry. I didn't mean to spur any of this on. I just thought that being your employee, it would be seen as special treatment…..but nooo Mydei, I would be more than happy to be your friend and share things with you. AS FRIENDS. NO titles or positions. Just friends.”

“Are you sure you won't be offended?” The lion questioned.

“No, I won't be. Can I give you something? Probably not many have.” No words came, just a simple nod.

Fuck! I can't believe I get to do this. Stay calm. He's giving me permission. Shit.

Hoping down off the stool, he moves closer to Mydei. Steadied himself and then wrapped his arms around the sad prince. He felt the body jump a little at the surprise, but then relaxed. Mydei laid his head on the chest holding him, bringing a hand up to hold Phainon's arm in a small return hug.

Phainon so wanted to kiss his head and tell him it would be ok, but that was stretching it too far. For now, he just held him as tight as possible. If he was still crying, that was OK. He was probably always told to be strong and not show negative emotions. Phainon figured the only person who might have ‘hugged’ him was his mother. He always talked very highly of her. How much of a sweet and caring a person she is. Always standing up for injustice. He can see where Mydei gets it from.

Fuck, he smells divine too. The shampoo mixes well with all the baking. I want to fucking eat him. Take some of that sweet sauce and lick it off his whole body.

A couple of minutes passed, and hands came up to wipe the rivers away. “Sorry to get emotional like that. It's been a long time since I've talked about my childhood.”

Turning the seat to meet him, Phainon looked into the beautiful, sad eyes. ”No, you're good. Any time, I mean it. I do get maybe not at work. But any other time, I'm always good for one.”

“OK, I'll hold you to that. May I still be allowed to make you breakfast and lunch?”

Phainon finally took a good look around. Finally, taking the scope of the whole area. There were breads and sweets cooling on most of the counters. Tupperware containers full of all sorts of fruits and vegetables. It was almost feeding an army.

“Uhmm, yes, you may, but I need to ask. Why is there so much food? And when did you make all this? Have you slept??” Phainon couldn't believe all of it.

Mydei looked around the kitchen, finally taking note of all that was made. He was proud of his work. “Well, to answer all your questions: I am not going back to work till Wednesday morning. I will be here moving all my stuff in. If I didn't have to leave for food, I wasn't planning on it.” He got up off the stool, squeezing Phainon's arm. Telling him he'd be ok and thank you.

Gawd, I'm so in love with this man. I wish I could be more to you. I really do. You need someone of your own to be there for you, but you won't let it. Will you?

“ To answer the other two, yes, I have slept, but I'm sometimes a light sleeper when I know things need to be done. Getting moved in is going to be a big task. So I think after you left, I showered and went to bed not too soon after. I think I was up at three-thirty/ four o'clock-ish.”

Reaching over the counter, Phainon stole a strawberry that wasn't cut up yet. “And you have all this done?? Incredible.” He couldn't believe how sweet and juicy it was.

He got into the box of gloves and went back to cutting the fruit he was on. “Well, I have been doing stuff in the kitchen since I was 10.”

“That's amazing. Wait… wait!!! Wait!!! How??”

Grabbing a plate, Mydei started to assemble the breakfast platter. “I snuck into the kitchen one morning. The head chef was the only one there, and I asked him to teach me.”

Fruit was placed on the side. Strawberries, oranges, and bananas were all cut into varying shapes. They made a floral arrangement. “My parents didn't find out till much later, but my mother was the most encouraging about it. It was something I was passionate about. “

Tortilla shells were placed on it. Meat from the grill joined potatoes, cheese, and salsa.

“Not to interrupt. How much was store-bought and how much was you?” Everything was incredible.

He placed the plate and fork in front of Phainon. “Well, obviously, the ingredients, but the salsa is freshly made by me. The fruits were fresh from the stand. The bread I made. I didn't have time to make tortillas.”

Fuck. He does it all. What I wouldn't give to live here. He is the most amazing person I've ever met. I've seen so much more of him in the past 24 hours than the 8 years I've known him.. Also, I would make him cry, though, but for whole other reasons. I'd like to think my dick is that good. ~He feels a minor stirring. His thoughts are getting the better of him ~ *Shit!!! Not now. He hasn't left. Can't you get hard later, dammit?*

Readjusting in his seat to try and force his problems away, he started eating. When the first bite hit his tongue, his eyes shot open in surprise. There was so much flavor dancing in his mouth. It was incredible to be able to taste so many things in it. The freshness of the vegetables, all the spices used; his mouth was having issues processing it all.

“Phainon?? Are you alright?? Is there anything wrong with it? I can make you something else if you like.” He was grabbing containers to place everything in the fridge.

“Nooo, noooo god heavens, no!!! This is the most amazing breakfast I've had.” Excitement was running high. The food he had was better than any

place he's ever been. The bar was now being set really high for everyone else.

Looking up at the cook, his heart stopped. He wished it wouldn't be inappropriate to take pictures right now.

A smile.

The actual true smile of this man was more beautiful than a painting. He had so many feelings stirring inside. Phainon could tell the compliment really must have touched him. His opinion was valued.

“ Since this is all taken care of and you are fed, I can get partially cleaned up and head back to the manor. The sooner the rest gets packed, the better. Plus, I can leave you to your work.” Opening the large restaurant-sized refrigerator, he showed Phainon where his stuff was for lunch.

“I mean this 100%. If you need a snack or what have you, please feel free to help yourself. It's always easy for me to make things. I want you to be taken care of for your hard work.” Closing the fridge, Phainon followed him through the house.

I mean, if I could have you, it would be better than perfect. That bed is big enough. On me, under me, maybe suspended from the ceiling…. I don't know. I just want all of you.

Phainon was lost in thought while following Mydei to realize where they were going. He was just following like a trained puppy. Always at his master's heels. When he finally stopped, he knew the doorway. It was the master bedroom.

Ohhh fuck no.. I can't…

Watching the prince, Mydei wasn't paying any mind to what Phainon was doing. Bending over, he was rummaging through the suitcase for something.

Ohh, that ass. Those jeans. I wanna slide between that so badly. It's hugging every part of that.~ Better judgment aside, he took a quick picture. *~I'm so glad I wore dark pants today. I hope it isn't showing. He can't know.*

His heart then made a full stop. He felt his erection throbbing in his pants.

Mydei was changing shirts to go home.

Everything in the moment was like time slowed down only for him. Watching each muscle appear as the shirt is lifted up. The sunset was disappearing in the darkness, then just fluttering back into place. The side view of his body was chiseled out of the finest marble.

I had no idea he was this ripped. Ohh, fucking hell. If I didn't have better control, he wouldn't be going home. I want to touch that so badly. I'm gonna have to take care of ***this*** *after he leaves. It hurts.*

The new shirt comes down over his head. Covering the muscles up, but still as beautiful in the eyes of a man consumed by lust at this point.

He knew he needed to focus.

“Since you are going, take the remote for the gate with you. It should all be functional when you get back. If you could do me a favor, can you send me a secure email as to what you'd like the pass codes to be?”

Standing back up, closing the suitcase, “I can't text it to you?”

“No, it isn't secure enough. I want to make sure anything relating to security is kept with the app and the encrypted folder I made for all this.”

“Fair point. Now, if you need anything while I'm gone or something I can pick up….” Mydei pulled out his phone, searching for the right thing. Once it was found, he turned the screen towards Phainon. It was a QR code for his personal contact information. “... please scan this and don't hesitate to call or text me about it.”

That sweet smile, even so little, was caught.

“Even just to say hi. I won't mind.”

Getting his phone back out, he quickly closed all other apps and went to the phone section. It was scanned, and Mydei's information was right there for him.

“If it wouldn't be any trouble, can you just call me when you get to your parents? So I can tell how close they are in case of an emergency. Just so I can tag a location. Also, the remote has tracking for the one in the car and on your keys.” He follows behind again, still just burning images into his mind.

“Wow, you have thought of everything. I assume you will be here when I get back?”

Teasing “Going to miss me that much?”

What?!?! What the fuc…kk, I think I just saw a blush on him.

“It is nice having company, I won't lie.” Grabbing the handle and heading to the car, “I will talk to you later.”

With a smile on his face and a wave of his hand, the car pulled out and down the driveway. Phainon's phone beeped. Looking at the notifications, it was the security app. Saying it was on the move.

“Well, shit. My stuff does work wonders.” Closing the door behind him, his eyes were focused on the phone, letting his feet guide him through the house.

Stopping in the doorway, he watched the icon move across the screen. “Shit, that car can move. He's on back roads, but that fast. I mean, he does have a lot to do….” His eyes shifted to the bed. “...so do I.”

The shirt that was just on Mydei's body was still lying on the bed. Phainon picked it up. His fingers were in heaven from the first touch. Some of the softest material he's ever felt. Bringing the shirt to his face, he could find

all the scents from the shower and the food that was just made. So distinctly the prince.

His eyes were closed, smelling the shirt. He sat on the edge of the bed. “I need to take one final look,” grabbing his phone from his increasingly tighter pants, the app showed the car quite a distance from the city. “Damn, he can move in that thing.”

Knowing he was in the clear, the phone was placed facing down. Protecting him if any calls came through.

“Now where was I? Ohh, that's right!” Lust was all that was on his mind. “I need to take care of an issue my prince gave me. “

Draping Mydei’s shirt over his shoulder, all the buttons came undone on his dark blue shirt. He forwent an undershirt for the later work. For now, it gave him access to his own body. He took the shirt in his hand, letting his own skin feel the softness, brushing it across his chest.

It's already dirty, why not make it worse?

His body jolted when the softness brushed over his fully erect nipples. The silken touch on him caused his length to throb harder.

Remember, no evidence. Don't cum on the shirt.

Lying down on the bed from the side. He took a pillow under his head. “It smells like him, even better.” With the angle he was at now, he lifted his ass off the bed, zipping down his pants. His hand brushed past the aching need on the way down. He wanted to thrust into something now.

With his pants just below his ass, his boxers were all that was keeping him from the pleasure that was needed. With the lightest touch, fingers danced over the front of the fabric. It was already so wet.

Giving it a good squeeze, his breath caught. It felt so good and was so painful. Lying the shirt across his chest, Phainon shimmied the boxes down as slowly as he could. He wanted to tease himself.

The band of the fabric slid down the shaft, forcing a moan out of his body. Bringing it back up a little more than down again, then pushed it all past his balls.

His left hand was brought back up to the shirt, keeping it close to his face. The fabric gently moves across his chest again.

His right was ready to handle the straining issue. With his dick standing up, Phainon was able to slide his fingers across the slit. His juices covered the fingertips. They swirled and danced around the aching head, smearing his cum all over the skin.

Taking a deep breath of the fabric, he moaned into it. “Uhmmm…yessss… Mydei. Touch me just like that.” Phainon’s mind gave in to the illusion that it was the prince pleasing him.

“My dick……it aches for you… wants you…” Finally, grabbing on to it, a louder moan left him.

No one was here.

He didn't care.

The veins strained under the touch, pulsing with excitement. A strong hand slid down the shaft and back up. Occasionally, on an up thrust, swirling fingers over the head to get more lube. Squeezing the head, before coming back down, Phainon was in heaven.

“Let me ….let….me…” Phainon propped his feet up to help thrust harder into his hand.

“Come for you… “ His moaning hasn't stopped. He's only gotten louder. The bed is squeaking a little under his body.

Phainon knew he had to get all the enjoyment he could now. This would probably never ever happen again.

His hand was made in a fist just tight enough for his length to fit in. Not moving. Hips taking over. Fucking his hand with abandon.

His snow white hair was spread across the dark pillow. Face turned into it, smelling the shampoo from earlier. The shirt was just over his nipples, rubbing them through the fabric, pinching the erect skin.

The prince's scent was on him.

Phainon felt like he couldn't thrust any harder. He wanted to feel the tightness of the hole. Squeezing all his life force out.

“Please….” His voice was becoming hoarse. “Mydei….. please… let me cum… I've ….I've …been a good boy..” His grip got tighter on both body parts. He enjoyed the pain. Made him feel more alive. His shaft was becoming raw from only stroking it and not the head as well. The lube was wearing off.

“Please.. let me cum…” tears welled up in his eyes. He was edging himself so hard. Just when it was almost there, he'd change pace. Phainon wanted this moment to last.

“Pl….e…a….” With a final plea, the gods must have heard his prayers. The phone rang. It was a special ringtone set for the prince. Knowing it was him, he squeezed the head. It was all it took.

His vision was painted white.

So was his stomach.

Phainon could do nothing but breathe heavily. Trying to catch his breath. It was the best hand job he's ever had. Even though it's only ever been him.

A good five minutes passed before he was able to move again. Getting to his feet, the bed was replaced as it was found, like nothing happened at all. Or so he muttered to himself, fixing everything. His visual memory was just a photograph.

The bathroom light was switched on. Shrugging off his shirt, it was placed off to the side. With both his hands on the sink, he stared at his reflection.

The only thing staring back was a depraved man with his own dried cum on his stomach.

The water turned on, but his face didn't look elated from what just happened. He just watched the water run.

Gawd, what kind of sick fuck am I? I was invited to his home. Served 2 delicious meals, with one waiting. I got to experience a minor breakdown about his sad childhood and dead friend… and what did I do in return? Get off on his bed with his shirt. My brain hasn't been right since that accident.~ Phainon was now questioning himself; he knew his head wasn't screwed on tight. *~It wants things it shouldn't. I should be better than this, but part of me doesn't care. At least with the cameras, I can't hurt or touch him. If I'm not near him, nothing will happen.*

His mind was in an inner turmoil for the love and sex of a man he could never have, but was just an arm's length away.

“I can love you from a distance, that's all I'm allowed. You can't ever love someone like me…….”

Chapter End Notes

> So many emotions are going through his head. Lust and depression are the worst enemies. Phainon got to experience something he never thought possible, but isn't happy about it. Demons will do that to you.
>
> Mydei on the other hand, has no idea about what's going on at home. Only that a certain white haired man is creeping into his thoughts a lot more.

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

> Mydei returns home to finish his packing. Having quick chats with his mom and Keratos(their family's personal guard), it was time to get to work on the rest of his stuff. the sooner it was done, the sooner he could be at home and see Pha...Oddly, he isn't sure why the white haired wizard is on his mind. some things were very infectious.
>
> Back at the house though, Phainon was busy finishing the house instillations, including the special ones. Unfortunately for him, the scars he feels at the base of his skull bring back a lot of bad memories, ones he can never escape.

Chapter Notes

> No true beta read.
>
> WARNING: this chapter is very emotional. It deals with child hood trauma, self deprecation, and talks of voyeurism

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Waiting outside a grand mansion, a tall man with dark grey hair. One of his eyes is very cloudy due to combat experience. He stands tall, waiting for the car to park.

Mydei leaves the car, going to the man. Embracing him in a strong hug.

“It's good to see you, young master. It's been since the last holiday I saw you.” Patting him on the shoulder. He had recently been on military training.

Smiling at him, “Likewise, Krateros. You're looking well.”

“I could say more for you. So today is finally the day? It's going to be hard not seeing your face every evening, even more so now than when you got the apartment to prepare for this.” He was a bit saddened by the future departure, but knew it was time. “You need your own space. Can't have your parents over you for the rest of your life.”

Laughing, the two walked into the mansion. “Tell me about it. Even just my first night there, a weight has slowly begun to lift from my shoulders.”

“I'll leave you to it then. Your mother is currently in the living room; she's been waiting. Should you need anything, let me know.” With a bow, the older man left his side. He knew his mother was happy, but like any parent was sad to see him go.

Reaching the threshold of the room, she heard his footsteps. Even wearing sneakers, a mothers ears always pick up on her children. “You know, my son, I swear you get more handsome every time I see you. “ She gets up from the chair faster than one would think for her age. In no time, her son was in a warm embrace.

This is the one hug that Mydei always wants. The one person who has fully supported him throughout his life. Gorgo, he knew, was the one person he meant the most to.

“Is father not home?” Walking by her side through the long marble hallway. Everything here reminded you of a grandiose Greek temple to the gods. The air of ancient life filled the whole place.

“No, unfortunately, he has had a business trip that he's been on for the past two weeks. Maybe not even due back till the start of next month.” She was happy with or without him there. She was a very strong, independent woman who knew what she wanted from life and the world. Mydei, her only heir, was just like her. He wants to walk his own path.

“I just think he didn't want to see me officially move out. A cover story.” They both were laughing at the thought. It was probably true.

“Some of your big items have already been moved into the truck. It is all your personal items that haven't already been packed. So much was already packed when you moved to the apartment two years ago.” When her son took up more management responsibilities and frequent help at the local restaurant, moving was kind of necessary. Squeezing his arm and a kiss on his cheek, she headed to the door. “By the way, my son.”

Looking over his room to where he wanted to start, “Yes, mother?”

“Has something happened recently? You seem happier than usual.” Her motherly instincts were telling her there was something affecting him. It is all a matter of whether he would tell her.

“You know, I'm really not sure. Maybe after I get my stuff moved and settled, I can give you an answer then.” Walking over to his wall, all sorts of books lined it. From history to pure fantasy. They all helped him become the well rounded person he is right now.

“I will hold you to that, my son. I'll leave you to it. Should you need anything, please call.” She gave him a warm smile as she shut the door behind her.

Coming back from his thoughts, he finally remembered that he had a task to do once he arrived here. Getting his phone out and selecting contacts. There at the top of the page was the man he was looking for.

Clicking on the link, all the information was there before him. Including a picture of the man in question.

“Phainon Khaslana. There is something special about you, sir. I just don't know what yet. Maybe it's the infectious personality or the smile you always carry.” Sitting down on his desk chair, one of the few bits of furniture that wasn't packed yet, he got lost in the cerulean eyes looking back at him.

I don't know what I'm feeling. Regardless of what it is, I can't jeopardize either of our works. ~Looking at the rest of the room, he took in what all

was left to do~ *I still don't know why I shared all that with him. I never talk about myself to anyone, let alone break down like that.*

Closing his eyes, Mydei could still feel the warmth of that hug lingering on his body. Was it because he wasn't family? Or he wasn't a very close friend, that he'd let himself be that vulnerable. None of it made any sense to him.

"I need to send that phone call for him to have the information here." Pressing the receiver icon, it started to dial. Mydei let it go a few times before hanging up. His only instructions were to just call. So he left it at just that.

Somewhere deep inside, he wanted to talk to him more. *Is this what having a friend is like? Wanting to spend time with or hear their voice. Ohh shit, I need to do that email as well.*

Making quick work of the email, he hit send. Now with those important things out of the way, he needed to finish everything in here. So much was already put in the truck to be transported. Depending on how things looked when everything arrived at the house, he may have to rethink going back on Wednesday.

Getting settled in now and fast was a priority.

"I can lock in and get this done."

~~~~~~~

Phainon finished up in the bathroom, cleaning any mess that may have remained. Buttoning up his shirt, he finally retrieved the phone.

Upon opening it, he was greeted with a beautiful picture of the lion cooking for the icon. A small smile found its way to the corner of his lips. With all the happiness he had for spending time with his prince, part of him felt bad for what happened, but the deeper part of his mind was excited by it. He was so torn.
~~~~~~~

Since he brought the private box with him, Phainon made quick work of installing special cameras in the bedroom and bathroom. They were of higher quality and a different security system than will be on the rest of the house.

I need to make sure nothing untoward happens here, too. Just in case someone breaks in and skips over all the other ones. ~He tried very hard to convince himself of that.

Pulling up the new app, he sank these two into the device. Sure enough, when the connection was established, he could see himself. They were working just fine. With no lights on the device and so well hidden in both places, it couldn't be easily found. Testing the sound and zoom, everything was in working order and would give him what he wanted.

His own personal videos of the prince, in his most private times. Something made him pause. “Even if I don't get to see anything special, I can still watch over him. I won't lose someone special again.”

Running his hand through his hair, back at the base of his skull, where it meets the spine, a scar could be felt. Going down his back, there were a few more, faded into his skin due to time. He knew they were all there.

Satisfied with his work here and everything was replaced as is, he went to work on the other camera. The gate he could take care of after lunch.

With hands skillfully at work, a smile left his normal, jovial face. Memories or visions of the past seeped in.

•••••

I remember we were all going to the fair a few cities over. The weather was nice, and everyone was so excited to go. Mom….Dad.. my sister. We were both so young. Full of energy. Because it would be at least an hour to get there, I brought my favorite colored pencils and paper to draw. Sis was learning all things with yarn and thread. She had made me a bracelet with braided thread a week prior, and I loved it.

Even though I was so young and my drawings weren't ‘any good’, my parents loved my passion. I had drawn a bunch of animals getting a drink at night. There… there was a lion…and an oryx, I thought they were friends. Even though nature would have you believe otherwise. Not to a child's mind, though.

I wanted to show my father, who was driving. Keeping the lap belt on, I slipped out of the shoulder one to show him with my little arms, paper in hand.

My first two mistakes.

My third, distracting my mother as well. She wanted to see.

Then everything was dark for what felt like an eternity….

When I was finally able to see again, I wasn't at the fair. I was staring at a white ceiling. A man appeared above me, and I didn't know who he was. Looked elated that I was awake. More people then showed up. It wasn't till the bed got raised that I realized where I was.

A hospital.

Alone.

Looking down at my body, I had a lot of patches on me. My back hurt a lot. I couldn't remember much then. My mind was still foggy, but the nurses always mentioned I had a smile on my face. Like a ray of sunshine in a dark time. And it was very dark.

I had overheard some nurses talking outside my room one day, so I feigned sleep to listen. I could gather there was a crash, a hit from the front. The car was a mess. They had issues getting people out. Only one survived.

I knew then…

It was me…..

I caused that wreck….

Me and my dumb picture. They couldn't watch the road. I got my family killed. I had no one then. There was no close family on either side. Grandparents on both sides were gone not too soon after my sister and I were born.

I had no one….

I was alone……

Once I was more functional, I asked what all happened to me. They said I was in a wreck. My body was flung forward against the seat in front of me, and because there was a hit also from behind, the glass shattered the back window. Many chunks were embedded in my skin. Large and small pieces. There was a big one that had pierced the back of my neck they were most worried about. Because I was having full conversations with them and no impairments, they were sure I was going to be ok.

How wrong they were.

I was placed in an orphanage because I had no family. I always thought for the longest time that no one wanted me because I killed everyone in the car.

Till one day, a kindly older couple came to the home. I was a quiet but very polite boy. I stood out because of my white hair. I don't know if I've always had it or not. I don't remember. They were the nicest people in the world. They must have felt bad for my whole situation; they were probably told. They wanted to make me a part of their family. Just the two of them and a very big, fluffy white dog.

I guess to separate me from the past, when I got adopted, I got a new name. Phainon Khaslana. I liked it. It was different, felt special. My childhood was good, all up until I hit puberty. The influx of hormones wasn't a good thing for me. Having my own computer at the time, a private browser was always on adult sites. I was a little too good at fooling systems. I wasn't a hacker, per se. I just wanted to consume adult content. A strong sexual fixation. Even in one so young.

My tech abilities….were there to cover my addiction. There was something about it that hit me differently. Not trying to insert myself into the situation, just watching. Being an outsider. Consuming from the shadows of my own room. I knew too well about watching people outside my room.

I wanted to watch in the real world, but feared the unknown. Repercussions.

Women were pretty, but something about the male body excited me more. I guess it was then that I realized I like men. It was weird, though. I liked looking at them, but no one really excited me.

One day at breakfast, that all changed. My father had mentioned they were opening a new restaurant in town. Many were very ecstatic. It was one from the Kremnos family. They were highly known in other regions for their exquisite food, service, and price. They knew how to take care of their customers.

The changing point in my life.

The picture in the paper.

It was of a tall man and woman standing outside the new building, but it was the boy beside her.

Their son.

Mydeimos Kremnos.

He was the most beautiful thing I'd ever laid my eyes on. Thankfully for it being a color paper, I was able to see what a black and white would have lost. The most gorgeous strawberry-blond hair. It came down to red tips. A braid of the same color hung behind his right ear. His eyes were of a golden color. The gods must have made him because he was a work of art.

Not till I got my computer later did I find out the better truth.

Amber

Bright golden amber eyes. They were piercing like a cat. I felt they had touched my soul.

Over the years, my skills grew, and finishing college with a master's in computer tech made me a necessity for a lot of businesses. I was way too good at my job. It was great to help others, but it only helped my problem. I had too much access now to the internet as a whole. I could see whatever I wanted. The more hidden the camera was for the scene, the better. It was like being hidden in the shadows, where that side always was.

The shadows.

But my fascination with that beautiful prince never stopped. I had a secure folder for him for any pictures or articles I could find. I didn't seek him out for anything; I wasn't a stalker. I just had an obsession. He was the most perfect man in the world in my eyes. No one could match him. So, every person who wanted to get close, I wouldn't let them. I wanted something I couldn't have. He was from a wealthy family. Some tech nerd was probably way below his standards. I didn't have the means to even touch that upper level of society.

Until luck must have loved or hated me. I was good enough that the Telesaltes Technology Company noticed me and my skills. I was wanted. I had a secure job. Moving up in the company was no issue. I was a breeze with everything. The tech and business aspects of the company were easy for me. Soon, I was one of the highest lead managers. I had many managers under me.

Why was fate cruel to me? One day, a business had applied for our service.

Normal?

Far from normal.

It was Thee Evernight Restaurants. The same one the prince was from. He was a prince to me from the first time I saw a live interview with them. He carried himself like one I'd ever seen, but very kind and understanding. My

heart was set. I wanted no person in this life but him. Would I have to then stay single all my life? Yes, but I didn't care. No one was Mydeimos.

Because of my standing in the company, I was given first dibs on the job. I couldn't say yes any faster. I would get to see the man of my fantasies.

That was almost 8 years ago now. I work on his office floor. I get to 'see' him often, but I know now, as an employee, I still have no chance. Rumors have been around for a long time; he is single and plans to keep it that way. Many have tried and failed spectacularly. I have seen some high-class people come to court him. The women left crying, and the men were erratic. They couldn't take his polite rejection. It was funny to me. I knew better than to try. So I just took cellphone pictures when I could snap them with no one knowing. I got off a lot more now than before.

I had more access to the thing that fueled my desire. I knew better than to ever touch. I forbade myself. Their family was almost like a mafia. I didn't want to die because I touched the heir. That never stopped me from lusting after him.

But what wouldn't give to watch him in an intimate moment…

Ohh wait… I'm there now. I can do it. I know I shouldn't. He trusts me, but I don't trust myself. Putting them in for HIS security is just trying to convince myself it's all for virtue's purposes. I don't even know if he likes anything. He may be asexual for all I know. I may never get to see him do anything, but on the off chance I'm wrong…

Ohh, fuck, is it gonna be so right.

I mean, hell, he took off his shirt in front of me. I almost died right there. It was so beautiful….stunning.. breathing… fuck that man will be the death of me somehow.

•••••

<BeepBeep>

“Shit, would you look at the time? It's twelve-thirty… I need to get lunch.” Phainon was so lost in thought when he worked, time was put to the wind. Everything in the house was set up. The gate still needs to be done. All the installations were about done. Food could wait. Then he could spend time in the app getting it all connected and making sure it was right. That all would probably take him till the master of the house came home.

There was a gentle breeze going through the trees as he made his way down to the entrance. It was calming his turbulent mind. This was going to be a little more involved installation. The stone had to be drilled into.

Just as he was about to put the drill to stone, his pocket vibrated. Setting the drill down, removing his gloves, he fished the phone from his pocket.

It was Mydei. A text from him.

▪▪▪▪

My Prince:

Hi. I just wanted to check to see how things were going. You're probably too busy for a call right now. Nothing important…

▪▪▪▪▪

Phainon was never too busy for him. He quickly hit the call button as the dots for text were working on the bottom of the screen. *Please pick up*

“Phainon?”

“Ohh, good, I caught you, and never am I ever too busy for you.” *I'd like to get busy WITH you, but that's a dream. I get to at least talk and be around you more. That's more than I ever could have asked.*

“Thank you, I appreciate that.” A huge sigh came from the other end. “I have been packing since I got here. Haven't taken a break or eaten since this morning with you.”

“Ohhh, come now. You're telling me at that big mansion, NO ONE bugged you to eat. You're their prince after all. If I were even a sliver of a good cook like you, I WOULD have made you food.”

A small cough could be heard on the other end. *Did I embarrass him?? Was he blushing??*

“Actually, no, to answer your question. Most have just left me to my work. Once I'm deep within something, I don't stop until it's completed." Mydei offered up honestly.

Fuck, you can't say that to me. That just brings up fantasies of hours of sex with you. Never stopping till we are both wrung dry. Why is it so easy for him to get me excited?? Ohhh yeah.. Because I am easy for him.

“Well, at least you are taking a break. I'm glad you called. It's kinda lonely up here without you to talk to.” Phainon sounded forlorn on the other end.

“I…thank you. It's kinda nice to be wanted for more than my money or family status. I do want to apologize again for this morning. I wasn't sure what came over me.”

I just want you for you. I would love to have the whole person now. Before, it was just your looks; now, seeing the Heir stripped away, it is a beautiful and lonely man who just needs to be loved. I wish it could be me.

“It's perfectly ok. You probably needed it. You even made it clear that you never felt like you could be a normal person. If you can be that with me and have no worries, then I can be here as much as you need me. Everyone needs someone close. I just don't want to push you to do anything you're not comfortable with.”

“Phainon, I really wish I had known you a long time ago. You are someone I wish I had in my life. You're not part of this circus. Someone normal that just treats me as myself, not the heir to….this..” Mydei waved his hands at the room before him, even though the man on the other end couldn’t see it.

“Well, I will gladly take their prince, make him my prince, and go outside and color. Or go jumping into a lake at midnight. Taking walks through the woods. Go to a fair……” His heart hurt a little saying that place, but he would tough it out for the man so desperately in need of a friend, “…. and ride all the rides till they kick us out. Anything you want that isn't what they want, I will do with you.” Phainon’s inner voice was adding more inappropriate things. He had to bite his tongue not to say any of them.

“Would you?? Would you really do that?? For me?” Mydei was dumbfounded and touched all at the same time. Someone is treating him like a normal person. Not some idol that couldn't be touched.

“Yes, I would be more than honored to. Hell, if it weren't weird and not such a total mess, I'd play in the mud with you. I didn't have anyone growing up either. So, to get to do the things that we would have done growing up, I'd drop everything to give you that world. “

“You know, I'll hold you to that. If you don't mind me changing the subject, how is the project coming along?" A rustling of books could be heard on the other end. He was still packing.

“Uhmm, good actually. Everything is installed in the house. I was just getting ready to put in the gate camera when you called. I just have to physically install this, and the hardest part is over. I just have to network everything together, making sure it's all running properly.’

“Well, that will take a few more hours, correct?” The sound of packing tape can be heard closing a box.

“Yeah, probably. Why do you ask?” Phainon was excited and curious as to what he wanted.

“Would you be willing to go out to eat with me when I return? After packing all day, I don't feel like standing to cook.”

Phainon's mind just broke. He did forget how to breathe. He was being asked out on a date. Maybe to Mydei it was just a meal, but to him, it was a

date. He can't take how much this man is winning. Just asking things of him like it's nothing, but it hits his heart in every way it can.

“Wellllllll, that all depends. Where are we going? I'm not exactly dressed to go out to eat. Plus, I'm about to drill into your driveway wall and get dusty as hell. I was only planning on installing everything, giving you the stuff for the security system, and then going home. “

“Ohh, I see, it's ok then. Maybe some other time…” Sadness can be heard in his tone. He wanted to spend the time together.

“Buttttttttt my dear prince, I said before I would drop anything for you. So how about this? I'll finish the physical part of this, run home and change…”

“You could just maybe…” The prince got suddenly became quiet.

“Maybe??” A white eyebrow raised at the interjection. There was something more.

“Grab some things and spend the night? The guys are dropping the truck off at the house. Since I did so much today, I probably won't be unpacking anything more. The living room furniture was already there before we arrived yesterday afternoon. I had already bought it. I just had it delivered before I signed the paperwork. I need to go buy other stuff, or I'd offer a guest room.”

“Mydei….are you asking me for a sleepover?”

A warm laugh is heard on the other side. Something Phainon would never get tired of hearing. “I guess I am. It's kinda funny. It will be my first one at almost 30.”

“Really? Huh, I guess that makes two of us. So I'll let you go, finish this, run home to get everything, and come back.” *Fuckkkkk I don't know if I can take this. I get to have a date and a sleepover. I AM getting a little hard thinking about it. Thank God no one is around.*

“You can use my bathrooms if you wish; it doesn't matter which one. Just so you don't feel like ‘work’ when we go out. Please take care. Be careful going to and fro.” Mydei was smiling from ear to ear, and he wasn't sure why. He was feeling things he had never felt. Is this what friendship was like? Being around people you liked gave those sorts of feelings. It was much more different than his family or servants.

“You as well. I'll see you when you get here.”

The call ended. He was more elated than he’s ever been. So many feelings at this moment, he knew he had to be on his best behavior tonight. The prince needed cheering up, and that was what he was there for.

To be a friend.

Chapter End Notes

Poor Phainon, he is a mess. So much going on in his head, he doesn't know where to throw these emotions. Now Mydei wants to take him out on a date(at least he thinks its a date), how will he handle himself?

thank you so much for reading and support.<3

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 4

Chapter Summary

With all the cameras installed, Phainon was more than proud of himself. What he wasn't expecting is for Mydei to want to take hm out to dinner. (You can call it 'I don't want to cook' all you want, it's kinda a date) Phainon's internals are not knowing what direction to go in. Besides his lust for one sexy boss, there was so many other emotions swirling. Is he going to handle a car ride, date and sleepover? Poor boy is a mess.

Chapter Notes

no true beta read. Hope you enjoy.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Everything seems to be in order. That installation went better than I thought. With that all done, I'll go get that stuff now and then finish the app stuff when I'm clean… clean…pppffttt as if.” Locking the door behind him with the code, it was a simple trip back.

“I still can't believe what has happened. If I'm dreaming, I don't ever want to wake up. This is just.. wonderful. Too bad it is only one-sided. I'm in love with him so much.” Phainon knew that's where everything stopped. It stopped at him. There was nothing beyond words. They were now co-workers AND friends. He couldn't risk Mydei's position. It was far more important than his own.

Once back at his small apartment, he gathered the necessary clothes and his laptop. If he was spending the night may as well use a bigger screen for work. “I HAVE to sleep on the couch. It's gonna be a very hard night if I don't.” Going back to his bedroom, he grabbed a pillow and his favorite blanket.

Shit, this is just like a sleepover. It's nice to do something…normal.

The blanket he was bringing with him was one his mother had made for him when he was young. Little suns and moons adorned the whole thing. However it was made, it never got dull in its softness. Even after all this time.

With everything packed, Phainon made the reverse trip back. Going back felt a little quicker than leaving. Maybe because he was speeding. Excitement was running through his veins.

He was just like a kid in a candy store. The eye candy was all his for the looking.

Once back inside, his bags and blankets were dropped off by the couch. Fresh clothes and necessities came with him to the spare bathroom. Now that the cameras were in place, he forbade himself from being in the master room. Too many dirty thoughts crept in, even in the vicinity of it now.

Stripping down, he noticed there was an odd door to the side of the mirror. Opening it revealed three long panel mirrors. “I guess to see yourself better.” His naked form stood in front of him, mirroring back everything. He had lean muscles all over. Everything was in the right proportions. Phainon knew he was good looking, but... running his hands over his chest muscles, squeezing them tight. Putting a hitch in his breath, “Would the prince like this? Would it please him to have someone to match his own physique?”

Lust then took a quick dive into sadness. Turning enough, his whole backside was visible to him. It had been a while since he had seen it. It never failed to ruin the mood. Most of the smaller scars were gone. But the larger ones from the glass extraction were still visible after all this time. Being on his back made it hard for them to heal properly. “Ohhhhh right…. The real reason why I can't have anyone. I can't hide these scars like my mental ones. It all makes me such an ugly person. I really hate lying to him. I'm not as wonderful as he makes me out to be.” His head hung low as he got into the shower.

“I'm just a monster.“

The water was turned on as cold as it could go; he needed to punish himself for deceiving such a beautiful soul. The prince was hurt, yes, but he didn't do anything wrong. Still doesn't. Still so innocent.

Phainon saw the hideous person HE was, but his brain never stopped its chaos. He just had to live with it all.

I wanted to get off before he came home, but I guess I'm my own cockblock.

4:45 pm

The beeps of the keypad filled the entryway. Mydei was finally home. To his home. Moving in can wait.

Looking over at the couch, he found: a bag, a pillow, and a blanket. *He really is seeing this as a sleepover. It's cute.*

The symbols on the blanket caught his eye. Going to it, he touched the fabric. The softest thing he's ever felt. He almost wanted one as well. You could get wrapped up in it, like a tiny feline and go right to sleep, with softness like that.

“Now, where is the owner?” Listening, he hears sounds from the kitchen. Mirroring what happened in the morning, he stopped at the threshold. Phainon was back on the same stool, toiling away at work. The music coming out of the speakers was so enjoyable. *I guess many things in life work better with classical music.*

“Good evening. Not working too hard, I hope.” Mydei watched the body jump in the seat. A small giggle and smile adorned the prince. Phainon caught his breath. Trying to calm himself amidst heart palpitations.

“God dang. Don't do that to a man.” Holding his hand over his heart, he starts laughing at himself.

“My apologies. Are you ready to go, or do you need a bit for what you're working on?” Mydei noticed the tea that was beside the laptop. There was a smell wafting in the air from the brewing. It was his favorite, pomegranate.

“Nooo noo, I'm good. I was just setting some other things up in the system.” Logging out and turning it off, he went over to stand before the prince of his heart. “How is it you've been packing ALL day and still look this good?”

It was there again, the smile and blush. Phainon knew he didn't see things.

Those lips look so inviting. I could see so many things in and on them.

“Probably genetics. I look like my mother, and no matter what she does, always flawless.” Turning, he left the kitchen area with his puppy right behind him. Phainon stopped at the bottom of the stairs. He knew Mydei was going to get changed completely. For his lust, he couldn't follow, but also wanted to test out the app on his phone.

“I'll wait here while you get changed. I know I'm hungry.” *For you, sexy.*

Mydei's voice came from the hallway upstairs, “Didn't you eat at lunch time? I left food for you.”

“Yeaaaa, but I only had a few bites. I wanted to save room for dinner and dessert.” *I'd love to cover you in some sauce and eat you for dessert.*

Mydei disappeared up the stairs.

The special app vibrated his phone. It was up and working properly, noticing a body in the room. Sitting on the chair by the stairs, he flipped it open. There was the prince, in full color, getting changed. His t-shirt was taken off, thrown into the hamper that he had neglected earlier. His heart and erection became active all at once, seeing the pants come down. His whole body was a Greek statue. Chiseled out of the finest marble.

Mydei, adjusting his skin-tight underwear, was making his erection stand at attention now. Pushing against his own clothing, Phainon knew it had to be gotten rid of before they left. From how the fabric hugged the skin, showing off every curve of his ass and package, Phainon was so hooked. Zooming in wasn't helping; he was feeding into his lust now.

He called upstairs, “Hey, take your time. I'm going to go to the bathroom before we leave.”

“Sure thing,” was all the reply that was needed. He casually walked down to the furthest room in the house, away from the stairs.

Phainon slipped into the bathroom, locking it behind him. Placing the phone down on the sink, he had to quickly pull himself out of its confinement. His ass made contact with the cold seat, but he didn't care. His left hand was given the phone, while his right was doing all the work.

Fuck…. Just…fuck…. I get to spend the night, and my camera is a success already. So good. How does he make me so hard so fast? That's right, caz I'm fucking easy for him.

The feed shifted to the bathroom. There was something sitting on the counter, but it was too far out of view. Mydei got out a washcloth and started to clean himself up to go out. The camera was adjusted to get a side shot. From this angle, everything could be seen.

Phainon's hand started pumping up and down fast on his aching member. He knew he didn't have much time. Squeezing it at the head, his juices helped speed along the process. Breathing was becoming faster.

The wash cloth got rinsed off, then Phainon's greatest wish came true. Mydei pulled his underwear down, stepping out of them to freshen up all over. Phainon bit his lip, staring at the glory before him. *God fuck is he beautiful, even that glory.*

Propping the phone up on its stand, both hands were needed. Linking his fingers, he made a ribbed hole to fuck into. Staring at the cock before him, he imagined the things they would do. “I’m… I’m.. such a bad boy… I need to be punished. I need you on me.” Watching how Mydei's hands were cleaning it, made him pump faster. Holding the dick in his hand, Phainon got the best view. He knew he wasn't going to last. To his surprise, the prince squeezed it.

That was all he needed to see to finish. Squeezing hard one last time. His eyes closed, and he quietly moaned the prince's name. He made sure that anything that came out was quickly disposed of. Once his heart finally slowed down, he needed to get cleaned up to go. The feed showed him in the room picking clothes. Time was almost up.

Flushing away the evidence and washing his hands of any wrongdoing, everything had to be in order. Looking at himself over, it was like nothing had happened. He exited the app and went back to the couch to wait.

I still can't believe I saw it. Also, the cameras work. I wonder what I'll see tonight.

Steps could be heard coming down the stairs. The site, when he looked up, sent his heart through so many loops. How he wished to take pictures of this man all the time. Mydei never failed to impress him with just how effortlessly stunning he was. Always put together.

Wearing black dress pants and an ombre shirt to match. The bottom part of the shirt was in a dark red, almost matching his own underwear. The top couple of buttons were undone, showing off his fine physique. *No money in the world can add up to how amazing he looks. God damn.*

“Soo dear prince, what do you have in mind?”

That blush crept back, and a light cough was had before he spoke again. “ You know, Phainon, you're such a silly man, but that's ok. Uhmm, there is a small Greek restaurant on the other side of town. The owner is a good friend of my family. Called ahead to get a table away from everyone to have some privacy. It's hard to go out sometimes. People are constantly flocking towards me.”

Laughing at himself, “I'll take ém on!! I'll fight them off. I'm tough.”

Ok… I can do this. Maybe if I keep myself distracted the whole time, I can make this trip without freaking out. Fuck… if anything happens to him…

Going to the car, Mydei stopped and stared at him. Phainon was worried, “Are you ok?? Is something wrong?? Do I have something on my face? Shit, did I put the wrong face on in the bathroom? Darn it. I should have chosen the dashing man, not the jester.”

“No no no… You're good.” Laughing, they both get into the car. “No, I'm just……happy. Doing something normal for once.” Grabbing his arm lightly, he squeezed. Phainon's insides were screaming at him. “I appreciate this more than you know. Thank you.”

Smiling back at him, his heart was being shot with Eros' arrow over and over. *I wish I could be honest with you, I truly do. It hurts so much. I wish I could just split myself to make it easier. Leave the self-loathing me at home and just send you out with the loveable goofball.*

The car pulled out of the driveway towards its destination. Stopping at the gate was its first test. The button was pushed, and they both watched the gears move. A success. ”Amazing job.”

“Thanks, that wall was a pain in my ass.”

“Well, the pain was well worth it. You did a great job with it.” Pulling away from the gate, they made their way through the long set of trees to the road. “Hey, since we are doing normal stuff. Can we talk?”

Shit, ohh fuck. It's never good when anyone says that. “ Sure thing. What's on your mind?”

“Well, it is a bit of a drive to get over there, and this is the first time we've spent a long period with each other. I just thought, maybe we could get to know each other better, but if that's uncomfortable, that's perfectly ok. I don't want to push you.” Stopping at the light, the highway was just after this turn. Phainon was in a war within. How does he handle this? He wants to know more and be honest. He knew he'd just have to take that leap. *Breathe, you can do this. You can ride in the car with others. It…it...Will be ok...fucking anxiety.*

“We can. Where would you like to start?”

Mydei never took his eyes off the road, and his sunglasses covered the top of his face, but his ears were telling a different story. They were red like his hair. He was embarrassed, nervous. “ Well, you have offered to spend a lot of time with me, which I appreciate. Am I interrupting any kind of relationship you may have?”

Fuuuucckkkk …..fuck.. why?? Why straight to that?? Not like your favorite color? Food?? But right to this… gawd… ok.. I got this. I CAN handle this.

“Uhmm, to be quite honest with you. I don't have anyone. I'm gladly giving all my free time to you.”

“Seriously??? You're not joking with me??”

“Yeaaaa… nope, I don't have anyone. It's all just me and my little apartment.”

Mydei's heart was all over the place. He couldn't fathom someone as sweet as him not having a person to share all his love with. On top of being a high manager at TTC and having a little apartment, there was something that troubled the lion. “Is there something I can do for you?? Do you need a raise?? And an extra bonus?? Anything?? For your position, only having a little space seems weird. Like someone above you isn't doing enough for you.” The thought crosses the back of his mind to offer one of the rooms in the house to him, but he hesitates.

“Mydei… It's ok. I don't mind my little space. It's just me, and I'm not the kind to show off. And yes, I do get paid well.. trust me.”

I mean, hell yes, I do. Dear lord, I didn't know when I started I could be making this many figures, but it doesn't really mean much, I'm sitting beside the most important thing to me.

Phainon didn't realize they were outside the restaurant when the car stopped. Looking up at it, it felt like a little old Greek family's place. Not a restaurant. His brain was still trying to process everything when his car door opened. Mydei's hand reached out, “Do you need a hand? I know you've been busy all day.”

Phainon was the one blushing now, but took the hand. It was soft but strong, one that had years in the kitchen. He could feel some of the divots in his hand. Probably from cuts or burns. Once out of the car, Mydei smiled at him. His heart was leaping again.

He really needs to stop that.

Mydei walked over to an older man at the doorway. Phainon watched a handshake and then a hug. He could hear that Mydei was in fact conversing with him in Greek. He really wondered if there was anything this prince couldn't do.

“Phainon, are you coming? My car can hold you up later.”

God damn, there is that smile again. He never smiles this much at the office. Maybe he does like my company? Ohhh Mydeimos, how I'd love to give you my heart right now. And sir… I came before we left. Thank you very much.

Upon entry, Phainon was just hit with a plethora of smells. It smelled like wine, olives, the ocean; all in a little, cozy tucked-away restaurant. Catching up to the sunset hair, they were led up a small flight of stairs to the back of the building.

The doors opened up to a small balcony overlooking the river. Flowers were in bloom everywhere. Luckily for them, the trees were so huge on either side that gave them privacy. Phainon's eyes couldn't get wide enough to take it all in. Soft “Wow” was all that could leave his lips.

“Sas efcharistó, thank you so much, Zeno.” Shaking his hand and bowing a bunch. The older man looked flattered by all the praise. He left menus, quickly heading inside to make the order when it came through.

Motioning to the seat, “So what do you think so far?”

“Shit, I haven't even eaten yet, and this place is amazing. How did you even find this place?”

“You know the chef at my parents' place? The one that taught me how to cook.” A silent nod. “This is his younger brother.”

“Wow, really?? That's amazing!! No wonder you were able to talk to him so well.”

“Yup, I actually eat here a lot. Not that I don't love Xerxes' cooking, but I hate having to go home for it.” They both open the menu full of tons of food, all with pictures and descriptions. “Please, order whatever you like.”

There was so much stuff, he didn't even know where to start. Everything looked mouthwatering. “Uhmmmmm, how about the Spanakopita? You pick the drink.”

When the waiter comes to them, Phainon just watches with the biggest puppy eyes; Mydei orders in Greek again. It was so sexy watching his lips.

Once the waiter leaves, Phainon feels like he could ask. “So, since I answered the question, can you answer it too? What about your love life?”

Cerulean eyes looked out over the sea of flowers that lined both sides of the bank. Not making eye contact with the man across from him. Phainon could tell it was a touchy subject. “Look, I'm sorry. You don't have to answer that. It's ok..” Just before Mydei was about to answer him, the waiter came back with appetizers.

He sighed very hard; it was a subject he didn't really like talking about. Mydei knew though, it was only fair. Phainon did answer his side of it. “Nooo, I do need to answer. It's only fair. The short answer is no. There is no one in my life.”

Well, at least that rumor is true and laid to rest now. I still don't have a chance in cold or warm hell.

“The long of it all, I've kinda put my work before everything else. The food, customers, employees… everything was put before my feelings. My father wishes for me to marry, but that's just the old style of talking. My mother

knows me better. When the time is right, and it's something I want, I'll go for it."

"No wonder so many have a fit at your rejections. I'm so sorry to hear that. With such a wonderful and caring person you are…." he wanted to bite his tongue and not say it, but he did, "anyone would be lucky to have you." He quietly mumbled, "I know I would," hoping it wasn't heard.

Their meals came out, piping hot and full of wonderful flavors. Since he did spend some time here, Mydei wanted to gush about what was on their plates. "The filo dough used in yours is homemade. The spinach is also locally grown. You picked a really good choice." Phainon cut into the triangles of flaky pastry, taking a first bite. His eyes grew wide at the flavors.

"This is amazing. How did you know how it was made?" Taking another big bite of it.

"I've worked here before. There have been a few times Zeno has needed help, and I offered my services. If they can get it locally, they will. Giving back. The Pasticcio I have, they source local goat's milk for cheese. I think beef as well." Taking a sip of his drink, he never noticed blue eyes watching every moment.

"It looks kinda like Lasagna."

"You could put it that way. Want a bite?" Without a thought more, Mydei got a chunk on his fork and held it over the table to his mouth, almost mimicking what lovers do. Phainon didn't want to give in, but when else in his life would he get to share a private moment like this AND have an indirect kiss from the prince's fork? He knew he had to do it.

Taking the bite, he could taste all the fresh flavors from the goat's milk to the beef used and the plethora of spices. "That is really, really good. I know next time I'm out, I should definitely get this. To be fair, it probably won't be as good as this."

The rest of the meal went a bit better than the beginning. No more questions on love, but simple, mundane things. Like hobbies, color, seasons….all the things you would learn from a friendship over the years of being together.

“Ohhh lordie….I so want to eat another bite, but I can't. That was all soooo good. I can't thank you enough for bringing me here. It's wonderful.“

That smile was back on his face again. Phainon thinks he needs a counter for how many times he's seen it recently. He made a mental note that it was a lot, all while wondering how much more could happen.

~~~~~~~~

With the windows down along the highway, the music was up, both men singing along to it. They both knew all the words. *Why does this feel so good? I wish I knew.*

“Shit, I didn't realize how late we were out. I know after the long day and that amazing meal, I'm tired.” Phainon leaned the car's backrest down; it was so comfortable he could sleep right there. Laying down also helped him not look at the road.

“I know how you feel. I'm just glad I can call this place my home and not have to go back to the stuffy mansion. I do like everyone there, but I was always watching what I did, how I did it. Just because of keeping face with the family, now don't have that worry now. To be quite honest, I didn't really want cameras anyway.”

Phainon was shocked at the admission. Was his work bad? Did something go wrong?

I offended him again. Why do I keep messing up? See, this is why I don't have friends.

“Phai….” Mydei wasn't sure if he could stop there or not, but he just tested the waters with the shortened name.“ Are you alright? You're thinking way too much again. Please stop worrying around me. You have done absolutely nothing wrong.”
~~~~~~~~

“I'm sorry, I tend to worry a lot about things.”

“No need. I may have only had a gate, but my father was insisting that I get a body guard for the house. I didn't want one either. So getting a camera was a compromise, but I told him I got to choose where it was from and who had access to it and did the installation.”

Sitting the seat back up, they were in front of said gate already. “And you chose me?”

“Yes. You do the most fantastic job with my restaurants. Also, you are a very wonderful person, I trust. So that's why I gave it to you.”

Ohh, my sweet prince, if you only knew. You may not say that. I just watched you wash up and caress your own body. I couldn't help but cum to that. I wanted more, but I can be good. Wait …. I'm not. I'm not the good boy you think I am. I'm just a pervert who wants to watch you from the shadows. I know I'm not worthy of you, but I can worship you from a distance.

“Well, hopefully that will give them peace of mind and let you have your freedom finally.”

Walking into the foyer, “Would you be opposed to turning in now? Let me make you one of my favorites in the morning.”

“That sounds like I'm just being spoiled at this point. I get all this delicious food made, I get to go to a Greek restaurant for dinner…” *It was totally a date”*….and breakfast. You are too good to me, Mydeimos. Thank you for everything.”

“Sleep well, Phai.” The smile was being hidden by his hair ascending the steps. He was happier than he's been in a long time. The new freedoms and things he will get to do on his own were just what he has been dreaming of since he was a child.

“You too,” *My sweet prince.*

Walking back to the bathroom from before, the phone was in his hand, watching every movement. The sick part of his mind was elated; it was all working. Being at someone else's house, especially his secret crush's, a simple dark blue t-shirt and black shorts over his boxers were chosen for bed.

Walking back over to the couch, he got comfy. Leaning back against it, part of him was already excited. Switching on the special feed, he was greeted with the man in question.

Mydei was standing in front of his bed starting to strip clothes. Luckily for the camera, he was facing its direction. Each button was undone, slowly putting it out of his dress pants.

It's my own private strip show, so thoughtful of you.

Once at the bottom, he let it slip down off his shoulders. Grabbing a hold of the clasp on his belt, he undid it. It was released from his waist with a snap of the leather.

Phainon felt that leather hit on every sensor he had. Reaching down, he teased the outside of his boxers. Wearing both silk briefs and nylon gym shorts, he was straining against them both. It was barely holding it back from standing the whole way up. Dancing fingers along the bulge, teasing himself.

Mydei had undone the top button of his pants. It was barely hanging on his hips. The very top of his underwear was showing.

Baby blue?? Well damn. They almost match my eyes. That's awfully sweet of him. That is what must have been on the sink I couldn't see.

The camera zoomed in a little more to catch all the details. Abs and chest were more defined. Even just flexing a little showed them all off.

Fuck he’s got leg lines… ohh, how I’d love to hold on and cum in those.

Phainon scooted the shorts down to let the silk of the briefs be between him and his throbbing erection. He can see it moving under the dark red fabric. An aching dick was begging for him to touch the skin.

Mydei did a full stretch. Then the zipper was grabbed, pulling it down. His fingers grabbed hold of the pants, pulling them down. He stepped out of them, gently tossing them into the basket. He was just there in a pair of lace boxers.

What??? Really?? Lace?? I never would have guessed. It looks so good on him, though. Very tight, just holding all that sweetness back. There is so much he's packing. It would feel good in my hand…. My mouth..

Mydei reached down to grab it, adjusting it in its confinement. Walking over to the suitcase, he bent over, giving the camera a full view of his backside. He was searching for something.

Being able to see the fabric pull tight against his ass, Phainon pulled his length out. He was so glad he grabbed tissues from the bathroom earlier, it was already leaking down the head. He knew he had a short period to get off. Never knowing if he would get caught. His hand made quick work of his erection. There was a spot right under the head that loved to be touched. Wrapping his fingers around that spot tighter, he watched. Even getting excited from just the prince's underwear alone. He dared not look away.

Mydei found his black silk pants. He stepped into them, adjusting the drawstring. He had a few bathroom things to do before crawling into bed. Part of the lion was almost too excited to sleep. The day he had after getting home was better than he expected. Morning couldn't come quickly enough, so he could share his favorite treat.

Once the prince entered the bathroom, Phainon didn't switch cameras. He needed to finish. Dropping the phone, his fingers found their way under his shirt. Nipples are already erect and need to be touched. Slowly, he swirled around it, then rubbed it between his fingers. Giving it a tug every so many swipes. He could feel that the dam was soon bursting.

Softly, he whispered into the night air, “ Ohh, my prince, how I'd love to give it all to you. My body will always be yours. Please make me cum…. Just… for… you.” His eyes closed, feeling the wave of pleasure course through his system. He grabbed the tissues to finish with. If he were alone, he'd have no qualms about making a mess on himself, like earlier. Phainon's desire was just upstairs; no one could find out.

How do you do this to me? What is this power you wield? I was just content watching online, but now I so desperately want to and not be a part of your life. I get to be your friend, and the benefit is all mine. I just get to watch you. It's so much more than I ever could have asked for. Just… just let me have this. I don't deserve more from you. A murderer and voyeur can never deserve someone like you. I only partially regret staying. This would have been so much easier if he had just signed for the job and not taken it further.

Let me go back to being a creep, not a man who's falling for you. My heart can't take it.

Chapter End Notes

Phainon's so conflicted. He wants to stay, be the friend that Mydei needs. But in the same turn is ashamed of what he is doing and Mydei has no idea about. What is a boy to do? be sad and go home....

thank you so much for reading and support.<3

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog

All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 5

Chapter Summary

> Anxiety is the worst. It interrupts at the worst times. Poor Phainon wanted to stay so badly, but feeling the guilt over his actions weighs on him alot. His perversion was only meant for his computer at home, this was to much.
>
> Mydei discovering it is also very hurt. He hopes a late night swim may clear his mind.
>
> But what Phainon catches on the home feed just breaks his mind... and hopefully not his chair.

Chapter Notes

> no true beta read. there is a phone call at the end.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The regret and guilt tormented him through the night. Any other time, he was fine with what he was doing. In the confines of his apartment, no one knew. He could do as he pleased. Watching sex through a different lens. Being as raunchy with himself as he'd like. He couldn't get caught.

But in this shiny new building, he'd just installed cameras in, the fear was there of being found out. It never excited Phainon to get caught doing explicit things. As long as no one saw what he was doing, he could enjoy them without repercussions. Here, his anxiety and need for pleasure battled it out in his mind.

In the end…

The anxiety won…

I feel so bad leaving...But I just can't anymore....It wouldn't be so bad if my heart didn't yearn for him. If he were just my boss and nothing else, getting off in his place wouldn't be an issue. He IS the man of my dreams…...and wayyyyy too good for me. I'll leave a note that I had to go and apologize for it. I can't even text him. This is too much.

Looking down at his watch, he scrolled over to the health app. Pressing the tab for his pulse. He took the reading, and the heart rate was high, but it wasn't due to previous actions

“I have to go now.”

Sifting through his bag, a notepad was found. He tried to write it as non-alarming as possible. Phainon tried too hard to keep his breathing normal. His insides were panicking.

Once he was satisfied, he placed it in the kitchen. There was a small part of him that was begging to stay, that things were going to be ok. The voice wasn't loud enough to fight anything else.

Grabbing all his things, he made sure, like anything he's ever done on the internet, DON'T leave a trail. Always clean up after yourself.

With the couch put back to how it was before, he left the house. Once inside his car, his nerves still weren't calm. He started the car, thankful that it was electric, not making much noise on startup. Knuckles grabbed the steering wheel so tightly that they were turning white.

At the gate, he accessed it via his phone, letting himself out. Once past the barrier and locking it again, he made his way faster down the road. Once he felt he was far enough away from the house, he pulled over and just stopped.

His head resting against the steering wheel, he finally let go of it. Color was slowly going back up his hands. Part of him was still shaking.

“Mydei… I’m soo sorry…. I just can't. I can't spend this kind of alone time with you. I can't fall this hard for you…. But I can tell myself all I want that

it's ok… but….. some beautiful angel like you doesn't need a devil clipping your wings.” Finally, after ten minutes of sitting his heart was back down to around a normal level.

The car started back up to finish the morose ride back home. He needed to really think about how he was going to deal with the future. It isn't some tech he can fix in an instant. The heart had a lot more pieces to deal with. All very delicate.

“I don't know if I can…… I just don't."

~~~~~~

Something was bugging his internals to get up now. Rolling over, Mydei picked up the phone to see what time it was. “Shiiit…..4:30. Come on. I'm off for a while, you can get some sleep.” He yelled at himself for not taking advantage of the off time.

Pulling his tired body out of bed, he made a trip to the bathroom.

His stance was barely there. He was lucky to get the pants and underwear down. His mind drifts between awake, sleep, and something else. Just couldn't put his finger on what was there.

“Maybe..” pulling a full yawn from his body”...maybe I can sneak down and make some pastries to go home with him.”

His mind half asleep, he neglected to put a shirt on, leaving the room. The house had a weird air to it. Once at the top of the steps, he looked to the couch to find nothing. His heart dropped. Something had happened. He descended the steps slowly; paranoia was setting in. All of the items that should have been there weren't.

Mydei scanned the area, and the shoes at the door were gone. “Fuck… really??” Sitting on the couch, his core felt hollow. “This… this is why I don't get close to anyone.” Tears were pushing their way forward. Everything was going great, but with no one home but him, he knew he was the issue.
~~~~~~

Something was off, though. He didn't remember leaving the kitchen light on. Shaking his head, running a hand through bedridden hair, he needed to shut it off before going back up to sulk.

Reaching the threshold, he reached for the switch and stopped.

There on the counter was a piece of paper folded in half, standing up. Curiosity got the better of him. Looking at the top, it was Phainon's handwriting.

¤¤¤¤¤¤

Mydei,

First off, I want to thank you for the most wonderful food I've ever had in my life. And I mean that. The stuff you made, that Zeno made….ohh my gawd, it was amazing. Nothing will ever compare.

Second, please don't be alarmed that I'm not here. I was a complete idiot when I packed my bags. I have blood pressure medicine at home that I normally take twice a day, and I left it there. I was sweating really badly, went to look for it and it wasn't there. I'll be ok, I promise.

Also, please don't think I just bailed on you. You are an uber wonderful person, and I'm so thankful for what we got to spend together. I just suck at taking care of myself sometimes. I didn't want to wake you, but either option sucked: the note or texting.

Make your house your priority. Take your time with it. You deserve a break. I'll see you when you get back.

~Phai

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

“Shit…. I had no idea. He always looked healthy to me. I guess looks can be deceiving.” He grabbed the note, carrying it to bed with him. He felt something about this silly piece of paper.

That ‘THING’ was still bugging him. He needed someone to talk to about it, but this early in the morning, not many options were open. *Maybe I'll text mother later and see what she thinks.*

Opening the back door, cool night air hit his torso. The openness of the outdoors may help him find a new perspective on things.

Darkness still enveloped the sky. Stars were doing their dance from millions of miles away. Acting like twinkling lights to the human eye. A detour was made. Right now, he was too awake and frazzled to go back to bed.

°°°°°°°

The frequent sound of an alert was blaring in his speakers. His monitoring system was at work, but this late? Phainon was very confused. With his cup of tea, he sat at his bigger desk to load the special security program for the prince's house.

The alert notification was for the outside.

Outside??? The fuck is going on?

Bringing up the screen, he saw the man in question.

“Wait… shit, are you kidding me? He doesn't have a shirt on. Damn.. those muscles again.”

In the confines of his own space, his anonymity was there. No one knew what happened on screen or in his space. He could relax and let the dirty side out. Feeding his lustful demon.

“So what are you doing outside?? Seems a bit odd…” his sentence was cut off as he watched the silk pants drop to the deck. Mydei was just there in

his underwear under a beautiful moon lit sky. Phainon's eyebrow went up. He was intrigued. No more thoughts could be had when the body dived into the pool.

That desire was pooling in his system again. Being safe meant everything was off the table. He messaged the front of his shorts again. Phainon was getting the impression that the more he saw of Mydei's private life, the more he was going to be turned on by not just sexual acts, but normal things.

°°°°°°°°

Feeling the rush of cold water past his face, he tried to clear his mind. There were so many things going on at once. The biggest thing was his feelings about one white haired man.

He dove down deep, then back up. Doing hard laps was helping him think. *This is bothering me way too much. I was really expecting him to be there. I wanted to make that surprise. Was it too much? I guess I suck at social cues.*

Getting close to the wall on the far end, he used the swimmers' turn around. Rolling himself forward, till his feet hit the wall, he pushed off it. Projecting himself back whence he came.

I really wonder if I heard him right. When he said anyone would be lucky to have me,did he really say ***'I would'****? That can't be right. Phainon doesn't even seem to interact with anyone in that manner. Then again, I have no clue about how to gauge what a person is into. I still swear I heard it.*

Once back to the house, reaching part of the deck, he stopped. His arms were resting on the side of the pool, his head lying on it. *I don't see why he would be into me. I am his boss. Most wouldn't….never mind.. he did want to be friends with me. Then why did it hurt hearing him say he just had a tiny apartment? I really was ready to offer him a place here. That would be way overstepping my bounds. Wouldn't it?*

Leaning his head back into the pool, Mydei tried to get the hair away from his face. Bracing both arms on the deck, they pushed enough for him to stand up out of it. His long lion mane sticks to his back and his underwear clung to his body like another skin. Everything was trying to hold in what was visible under the wet clothes.

ooooooo

The view was incredible. This wasn't just a wet dream. It was wet. Every muscle stood out. Eyes followed water trails, making rivers down his skin.

His erection twitched. The lace was doing nothing to hide the glory behind the fabric. It clung to him. Not even nude, it was revealing just how endowed the prince truly was. Not that he didn't already see it. It was just a different feeling seeing it like this.

This is the reason why I can't be there, sweet prince. My body wants you so badly. It can't take it when you do dirty stuff like this. I need release. You're too good of an eye candy not to.

He reached in, to feel how taut his dick was watching the lion swim. Being at home, he could take his time. Leaning back in his chair, he put a leg over the armrest. He was never beyond using all manner of things to get off. All of his fabric confines were moved to the side, pulling the throbbing appendage out of the leg hole. Phainon licked his finger, making sure it was nice and wet. The wetter the finger, the better-as he went to probe his opening.

A drawer of toys was always kept at the computer. Trying to work himself open, he used his free hand to carefully navigate the space, looking for the object he desired. Finding the box in question, it was placed on the desk.

A remote and plug.

His head leaned back, and a soft moan escaped his lips, pushing the digit in, working himself open. *Don't play too long, I want this to last.* Grabbing the plug, he lined up to his hole and pushed it in. Pain was sometimes a part of

his sexual pleasure. Experimenting with a lot of things, he knew what got his mind and body to places.

“Ohhh fuck that's so good…” once it was implace, the remote was tuned on to the first setting, just to have a low rumble in his insides. He put his hand back on the shaft, feeling every bulging vein standing up just for the wet lion.

“God… fuck… uhmmm right there…” getting the head on the up stroke, it was squeezed. Hand then sliding back down. His eyes closed, feeling how good it was to take his time getting there. No rush, just pure slow bliss.

¤¤¤¤¤¤

Ringing his hair out just a little, he prepared to dive again. The cold air plus the temperature of the water was helping him relax. There was so much he didn't understand.

Maybe I was never meant to. I can't…. Do I?? It can't be.. I'm just overthinking things.

Water hit his body again, clashing with the cold it felt from the night air.

Don't be stupid, he can't like you. No one can. You're a Kremnos. It's not something people want because of who you are. Just your wealth and status. My family is practically seen as a mafia, without being one. No one wants that. Why though,does he want to be friends with me? Is he not afraid of me, my position… my power?? He's so much different than anyone I've known.

The second lap was done. Pushing himself up out of the water, he lay back on the deck, keeping his legs still in. Gazing at the stars, Mydei tried to clear his mind and relax, but it was still a whirlwind of emotions. A lot of things needed to be done. “Maybe I will take a week off. I don't want to rush this. Plus, it has been a while since I last had a break. I'll text Cass in the morning to play around with my schedule. I think I do need some extra time off.”

Trying not to think of anything, Mydei just needed to calm himself, focusing on just his breathing. Eyes closing, his chest slowly moved up and down.

¤¤¤¤¤

Phainon opened his eyes to a most glorious sight. Mydei lay out on the deck, feet still in water. His dick was shaped so well by the wet lace. He could almost make out the head and any bulging veins.

His excitement couldn't contain itself. He grabbed the remote, turning the vibration up. His free hand reached down, pushing the plug up more inside him, hoping to find that sweet spot. Breathing was becoming more ragged at this point; everything was as it should be. Watching from the shadows, like he always had, but this time it was no paid service. No hack to access the content he wanted.

Free content….

From a camera HE put in…

A program HE made…

Years of tech knowledge are finally coming into fruition. His sick desire was finally sated. Mydei didn't even have to touch himself for Phanion to feel the pleasure from the video. Just lying on his deck, bathed in moonlight, hair clinging to his body, and the topping on everything, his cock wet and visible through baby blue wet lace underwear.

He pushed in just far enough to hit the spot. Hips were seeking pleasure. He wanted to close his eyes and finish, but he dared not look away. It was all so good. ”Fuck… your body is so perfect. I want …. Uhmmmmm.” Phainon ran his fingers over the slit, playing with the juices. “...to…lick those thighs….” he grabbed that spot he loves “ …fuck those thighs…. Aww god.. there.. right there…” his breath was going faster watching him just lay there.

Almost not blinking, the feed watched Mydei's hand come down, touching the outline of his dick. “Ohh fuck.. are you?? Will you??.. let me… please.. fuck please…” He was fucking himself with the plug now, constantly teasing that spot. “ …let the moon light bask..in …your …glory….touch your cock... please… more……” His movements were torn between finishing and to keep edging himself. He was ready to come so many times for his prince.

His wish came true.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

Mydei grabbed onto himself through the wet fabric, slowly moving his hand up and down. When his hand pulled down, the underwear just barely showed the top of the head. *Maybe...maybe I just need to clear my mind...not think. Dammit, that lace feels good against it.*

He wasn't in any hurry. Being so early in the morning, the world wasn't even ready to get up yet, but he was. His legs spread a little more to widen the area of fingers around him. He closed his eyes finally. Just letting his body feel. No stress. No worries. Just letting elation flow over his being.

Unconsciously, his hips were slowly moving to the slow strokes through the fabric. *Maybe I need this. It has been a while, but why… Why am I thinking of him?*

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

Nooo fucking wayy… is he?? Someone must love me.. because this is too perfect.

Phainon slowed his hands and changed the speed to a slow pulse. He wanted to imagine the prince was the one getting him off. Every movement mirrored on his own length. He was only the slightest bit sad his mind didn't come equipped with a record button. To play this or any other sensual moment over again.

But the computer does.

“So good..My..dei..I’m ..good..boy..for you… “ he was already making a mess all over his stomach. His shirt was pulled up, and all the fabric on his hips was moved to the side, but it didn't matter. All was covered in his juices. His left hand grabbed the arm of the chair, bracing himself. He had edged himself too long. He knew his climax was right around the corner. It wasn't going to last. “Uhmm fuck.. yesss.. touch it there.”

Moments like this, he was happy the room was sound proof. No one knew what kind of sexual deviant he was. It was fine in his book. He was left alone to his devices…which were in two drawers. One each at the computer and bedside.

A whine was spilling from his lips. ”pl..e….a..s..e.. let m….e…wan…t.. to…c…u..mmm…” His length was very red from stroking it so long, and the insides were screaming at the slow vibrations from inside. The end was soon approaching.

¤¤¤¤

Something inside Mydei wanted more. Bracing his feet on the deck, he thrust into his hand faster. He wasn't sure why. Like the gods were spurring him on to finish harder. Faster.

His house being nestled out in the woods and with no neighbors, moans of pleasure were on his lips. No one knew but the moonlight. The friction of fabric on skin was getting too much, on a stroke upwards, he grabbed the head. Squeezing just enough, spasming his hips.

It was enough..

“Ohhhh….fu…..uhmmmm.” Mydei was there, panting. He felt his own fluid all over his abs. His chest was trying to find some semblance of breath. It all felt so good. Being at home or in the apartment in the city, sessions like this never happened. They were mostly confined to the shower. Where no one could hear him. No one may have captured his interest, but he still got urges. He was just very cautious when he sated them.

Now with his own place, it was his time. He could do it anywhere. He could ALMOST walk around naked if he wanted.

God.. that was …so good. Maybe I needed this. I've been so stressed as of late. Buying this house, packing, running the business, helping out when the one head chefs fell ill…. Planning the yearly party. So much. Thanks to Phainon…..Phainon…. Why?? I saw him while I was…I mean ... .not that gender really matters, but no one has ever been on my mind before while releasing. Why him? Why do I want to do so much for him? Why in the past day have I WANTED to be around him?

"I need to get this cleaned up. Go back and finish my cat nap. Then get to work. I have a long week ahead of me." Picking up his pants, Mydei wandered back into the house to clean up. His brain was all over the place, trying to figure out his feelings.

¤¤¤¤¤

Heavy breathing was all that could be heard in the room, besides the quiet running of the fan on the tower. When he finished, Phainon had no idea his canine had punctured his lip. A small trail of blood was down his chin.

When his breathing got to an almost normal level, his heart settling, he glanced down at his mess. He came all over himself." That was the most intense orgasm I've ever had. I do hope all of them are going to be this good. Fuck… just fuck"

Unhooking himself from the chair, he tried to sit up… "aaahhhhhh fuckkkk… uhhh...I...ohh damn." Forgetting the plug was still inside and turned on, it pushed right against his prostate. Hips pushed back down on it again. Phainon's body was searching for that release again. Licking his lips, trying to ease up their dryness, he pushed down onto the chair. He was assaulting that sweet spot over and over. "Uhhhhh I…. Yeah.. again….please.. just ….th.ee..rrr…" desperately grabbing the remote, it was accidentally turned up to 3. The vibration was intense. It was felt all over his body. Legs were shaking so hard. If he were standing, he would have fallen. "Mmyyyy….dddd..ee..iiii…" was all that left his lips before the

wave of pleasure crashed over him. Like a tsunami wrecking the beach of his mind. He was lost in a sea of pleasure.

His head was lying on the desk. Shaking fingers turned the vibration off. He was a mess. *I never….never.. do it this much.. or hard. What did he do to me? You know what.. I don't care at this point. I get to have my wish come true and then some. Hopefully, life will leave it at this. Let me bask in his light from the shadows.*

Nothing more.

~~~~~~~

10:10am

《Ring, Ring》

Cass:

Good morning, sir.

I wasn't planning on hearing from you till mid-week.

Is something wrong?

Mydei:

How is it you've always

know things before I even ask?

Cass :
~~~~~~~

**giggling* Well I would be a horrible secretary and personal assistant if I didn't.*

Plus, it's Sunday. There has to be a reason to call on the weekend.

Did things not go well with the security installation?

Mydei:

No, they actually went swimmingly.

He got it all done while I was at the house finishing packing.

Caz, I was tired of standing, I didn't want to cook

, so I took him out to Zeno's.

Cass:

Ohhh, that's sweet. I haven't been out for a while.

Their food is so wonderful. Did Mr. Khaslana like it?

Mydei:

Actually, more than.

I floored him by speaking fluently in

Greek and then telling

him I have occasionally worked there.

Cass:

That's wonderful to hear.

From what I hear from the people over in his office,

he needs to get out more.

Mydei:

What do you mean?

He doesn't go out?

Cass:

From what I am to gather, no.

Even the yearly party you started doing after you took over?

You know, to thank everyone for their hard work.

Even helping cook some of the meals yourself.

He's never gone. I do have logs of everyone who attended.

typing can be heard on the other end

Since everyone has to register to get in the door,

his name has never appeared.

Even though their company has been under contract and

as your employees since it was set up, not once.

(Mydei was absolutely dumbfounded at this information. Something he set up, to help everyone feel more like a family, Phainon never attended.)

Mydei:

What about the rest of the people in his office?

There are what, 5 or 6 others with him?

Cass:

Yes, sir. All attended every one of the parties, but him.

*(*The admission hurt. He didn't know if he just wasn't a people person or where the issue was. That didn't feel right. Phainon was always so cheery around everyone.)

Is everything ok? You sound very concerned about that.

Mydei:

I know we have known each other for years,

so I can talk to you about stuff.

I kinda broke down in front of him and

told him about my childhood and Hephaestion.

Cass:

Ohhh….sir. I'm so sorry.

I know how much that hurts to talk about.

Mydei:

He told me that he could be

my friend and not have me up

on a pedestal like so many others do.

He even said we could do

things that I didn't get

a chance to do when I was a child.

My heart felt a little lighter.

I even asked him to spend the night……

but I woke up with a weird, bad feeling.

And unfortunately it was right……...

……...

……..

He left.

Cass:

Ohhh Mydei. I'm so sorry. Is there a reason why??

It sounds like you two were having a good time.

Mydei:

That's what I thought. He left me a note.

takes a picture and sends it to her

Something just feels off about this.

I think he was just trying to be nice and not hurt my feelings.

I'm really not sure how much he wanted to be here with me.

He did tell me before it felt like special treatment

because I'm his employer.

Cass:

reads the note

Well, to be fair, I have seen him come in a few

times looking very rough. Like he was battling a severe cold.

So that may be the truth.

Mydei:

I just don't know why he is on my mind so much.

Like I want to do things with him.

Be a normal person for once.

Cass:

*******Has a feeling about things, but isn't going to say anything yet**

Maybe you both are very awkward around people.

Not knowing how to act ***normal****.*

And that's ok.

I know for you, anyway, that personal relationships are hard.

Possibly your excitement was a lot for him as well.

You both were probably overloaded with emotions

and had a hard time processing.

Mydei:

I understand. You may be right.

I'll give him some time.

Plus, I have a lot of stuff to do.

Which is also, I did want to ask you,

Can you rearrange my schedule?

I want to take the whole week.

Just so I don't overdo it.

And I do have a lot of stuff to go through.

Cass:

***giggling to herself ***

Mydei:

What did you do?

Cass:

I kind of already accounted for it and took care

of everything when you left Friday afternoon.

Also, your mother asked that I make sure you

have ample time to move in.

She was concerned for your health.

Mydei:

You two always try and take care of me.

Thank you so much.

Cass:

Any time. I'll leave you to it. You have a lot to do.

Please take care of yourself.

I'll check in later in the week to see how you're doing.

Mydei:

I will and thank you.

¤¤¤¤¤¤

Hitting the call end button, Mydei felt a little better about the situation. Not in the fact that he didn't discuss the things he was ‘**feeling’** about the white haired man. What he needed to do now was get his stuff in order and start moving his stuff in.

Part of him wasn't sure if moving in was going to be a distraction enough from his intrusive thoughts.

~~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

Poor boys. So much in either of your lives makes stuff so difficult.

So Monday morning rolls around and the tech wizard has a late night at the office with new installs. A certain, lovely lady scares the shit out him(he didn't know any one was still in the building). The special feed was just about to be checked and he was feed blocked, so rude.

thank you so much for reading and support.<3

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.
~~~~~~~~

Chapter 6

Chapter Summary

Wednesday had rolled around for the Tech Wizard and there was an install that needed to happen with a live technician. Phainon thought he was alone.. he wasn't. Miss Castorice stopped by to make sure he was ok and drop off a message from the boss.

Phainon just can't escape him.

Maybe stopping for a take out on the way home wont be such a bad thing, will it? It may be when the manager on duty tells your boss about it.

Chapter Notes

Soft beta read.

Authors note: to clear up some confusion about Phainon using sex toys. For the story, he has been lonely for almost 30 years, thinking no one would want him. He had watched a bunch of adult things to find what he liked. And has also used a bucnh of sex toys to find what he liked as well. A top using a plug isn't only for a top to do. It is the same as sexuality.. it isnt cut and dry one can't do this and others can. A friend of mine said he read a story where the top had one in when they were doing the bottom.

So, when writing it I did not see it as an issue. Anyone can like toys. But trust me. This is top phainon/bottom mydei. The tags have been fixed, i hope that clears things up. Sorry about the confusion. I do know tags are important. So sorry again if it was not a clear thing.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The week had been relatively quiet in the office. Pahinon went back to work on Monday as usual. The week was flying by in a blink. Somehow, it was

Wednesday already.

Greeting Miss Castorice on the way in every day. Stopping at the lounge, he grabbed a black coffee before heading down the hall to the space that was given to the TTC for their work.

It was a small office space. There were six closed-off cubicles. Making sure everyone had a quiet space to do their work in. Only when any of those six doors were closed did you know the tech masters were hard at work. At the back of the space was his office. Pretty big size for all they do for security. Six large flat-screen TVs covered the one wall. One each for the respective restaurant and the last one for the office here. A locked-up secondary room for the servers was also housed in the room.

Phainon's desk had two monitors as well. Multitasking was a must for him. Always being able to keep an eye on what was important and getting security reports filed. Being one of the top managers for the company, he had to make sure everything was going as smoothly as possible. He wouldn't be in the position he was without meticulous work habits. Everything had to be done a certain way to ensure the security was at its peak.

It was 5:30 in the afternoon. The sun was hanging lower in the sky. The rest of the office had bid him farewell for the evening, a half hour to forty-five minutes ago. Phainon was still occupied in his office. The door wasn't shut; it was just cracked a little.

He was about ready to pull up the app for the prince when a soft knock came at his door. Phainon tried to play it cool, but wasn't expecting anyone in the office at this time. He's glad no one saw him jump a bit at his desk.

Who could it be? Hopefully, this doesn't take long. I have a prince to go look after.

“Come in?” He still couldn't fathom who could be here at this hour.

Beautiful lavender hair peeked its way into the door, and the lady holding that set of locks was just as lovely. “Excuse me, Mr. Khaslana. I didn't

realize you were trying to burn the candle at both ends today.” A slight giggle followed her sentence.

He stood up to greet her. “Ohhh, Miss Castorice? What do I owe the pleasure? I don't normally see you on this end of the building. Is something wrong?”

Walking in, she was surrounded by all sorts of technology, with no idea how any of it worked. She didn't come in very far. “Well, not per se. I was more concerned about you. The rest of your colleagues had already left, but I hadn't seen you depart the office yet. I just wanted to make sure everything was ok.”

Phainon took notice of her purse hanging off her shoulder. A bag was tucked under her arm. A tiny, purple dragon keychain was dangling from it. It was so her.

Phainon ran his hand through the snow white locks, laughing at the realization of his situation. “Ohhhh!! I'm so sorry to have worried you. I forgot to tell you on the way in this morning that I'd be staying late. There is a new security patch for the system that needs to be installed, but it has to be done here. Plus, there are other steps involved; it requires a live technician. I have nothing going on, so I told everyone I'd get it. It was no big deal. Plus, some had plans, and it worked out.”

Which was true. He wasn't lying to her. Many of them had families or friends waiting for clock-out time. Phainon, on the other hand, had his whole life free. There were no obligations on his table. It was all his choice, though. After his parents passed of old age a few years ago, he found no reason to go out anywhere anymore.

Over the years, he's gotten used to the loneliness. It saved anyone from being hurt by him. Even when the office would go out for drinking or to celebrate, he politely declined. People being happy with him involved was too much for his heart to take. Even after being adopted, he rarely went anywhere with his parents. Something deep inside was afraid of being in a vehicle with people he cared about.

They were used to it and never forced anything on him. He was content being at home. Playing in the wheat field behind the house with his dog. It was safe. It was all he needed.

He still wasn't sure why he agreed to ride in the car with Mydei. Twice no less.

Mydeimos had power over him, and his heart he didn't understand. The prince wasn't coming to slay the dragon that was hidden in the dark cave. Almost like he wanted to join it. Everyone knows that isn't how the story goes.

I can't let him get attached to me. I'm no good for his life. I'll ruin it… He's too perfect for that.

Castorice was watching his face intently. She was very good at reading people. Always has been. Something in his mannerisms was just off. Not alarmingly, just enough for her to notice. From her conversation with the boss over the weekend, she was watching him more closely. Something about him was different than most.

“Well, I don't want to keep you from it. I just wanted to check and make sure you were ok.”

“Yes, yes, I am fine. Thank you for your concern. I won't be very long. The maintenance had already started before you came in.” He was hoping she wasn't going to drill him for any other answers.

“Good to hear, I'll see you in the morning then?” She was just about out the door and stopped. “Ohh, and Mr. Kremnos sends his regards as well. He hasn't talked to you in a while and was hoping you were well. He was also very pleased with Saturday. I was just told to pass along the word. Have a good evening, sir.” With no more said, the door was closed, and she was gone. He was left alone with his thoughts - that was a very dangerous thing.

The app was loaded on the computer sitting in front of him.

It's sweet she cares, but why?? I've stayed late a million times before, but not till now does she check on me? And she talked to Mydei…..…ABOUT ME?....Shit dude ... .wait wait… hold the phone,yo. She said 'Saturday', not the installation…. The day??? Had fun?? That can't be right. I made him upset twice for sure.

The screen came alive, showing the feed of the house. The big truck from the mansion was parked with its back door to the house. A long ramp extends from it for easier access.

I wonder how far he's gotten. I've been trying not to look as much since I came home. This is just security after all. I don't need to get any more attached than I am.

Flipping through the screens, the house looks fuller now. The living room was so much more alive. With lots of furniture added, it was becoming lived in. A big white rug in front of the fireplace caught his eye. Waaayyy in the back of his imagination, thoughts were brewing. They were just going to have to stay there. He had more of the house to explore.

The kitchen was almost like he pulled it out of one of the restaurants. The equipment wasn't as industrial, but still huge for a normal kitchen. Even other fancy homes didn't have machines like this. Unless they were ridiculously wealthy. *When he said he wanted it restaurant grade, he wasn't kidding. Like…there is a lot, but not. It just looks like….I don't know...homey and work. It's odd. Feels like him, though.*

Phainon zoomed in the camera on the one counter. Fresh pastries adorned it. The quality of the camera was good enough to even catch the wisps of hot air leaving the flaky crust. From the looks of them, he gathered, they were just removed from the oven.

Switching over to the garage, the beautiful black iridescent car was parked in there. Something off in the corner caught his eye.

A bike!?!??! What nooo?!?! Are you kidding me.??? He knows how to ride…. Ohhh damn..I bet he does like something fast between his legs. Noooo, noooo, nooo don't start. You're still at work.

“I wonder if I'll ever get to see him ride it. No way in hell am I getting on that. That's worse than a car.” He did notice that there was a lot more in there than expected. Especially noting the gardening equipment in the back. Every image coming across his screen was always a surprise.

“Where is HE, though?” Just as the words left his mouth, a red dot appeared on the notifications. It was there, alerting him to a body presence. Clicking over to it, there he was. Hair pulled back in a tight bun. The same body defining jeans from the other night and a very form fitting tank top. Phainon knew he was drooling.

Mydei was the object of his obsession. Seeing him in anything other than a business suit was always a pleasant surprise. This particular outfit had to be one of his favorites. Making the untouchable heir look like a normal man.

Yeaaaa, well, normal enough. Most aren't as cut as he is. I still swear that the whole body was chiseled out of marble.

Phainon kept the feed on him, watching his every movement. He still couldn't ascertain what was in the 3 very odd shaped boxes that were being taken upstairs. The camera app switched to the special ones in the bedroom. Maybe he could get a better grasp of things following the prince.

All 3 boxes were laid out on the bed. He actually hadn't seen the bedroom since Saturday night. So anything in it now was all new to him. There was a rectangular, almost 3-meter-long box. A large square box. The final box on the bed was rather small. It didn't look like it fit with the other 2.

The middle box was open first. Phainon almost couldn't believe his eyes. He had to be dreaming. A large bronze shield was removed from the box. It had an ornate design. Still being visible, even with how old it looked. It had a circle going around the diameter. With large petal-looking strokes spaced apart. Circles adorned the spaces in between. And along the rim was a beautiful filigree design.

“Holy shit, that's gorgeous. Even for being old, it's almost in immaculate shape.” The shield was taken from the box and placed onto brackets on the

wall behind his bed. There was a little alcove made specifically for these items.

The top box was then opened. Hand-made red silk, adorned with golden flames, covered the item. Once moved, Phainon was even more shocked. It was a long red spear. An intricately made spike was at the end of it, flanked by 2 diamond-shaped cross guards. Adorning the larger end was a thick red metal tip. It was the reason why the width of the box had to be so large. To accommodate that amount of detail, it needed to be wide. The end looked like a twisted dragon's spine coming to a point. It too was placed in that alcove.

The red scarf, from the box, adorned the shelf below the ancient items. It looked like an exhibit from a museum. They were stunning to his eyes. He'd never seen something so magnificent before. Mydei was taking great care with these items; the years could be seen on the shield of any of the items.

The last box was the smallest. Pahinon couldn't imagine what kind of relic it housed. The same red silk lined the box. Even when moved aside, the camera couldn't see what was in it. Not until he reached in, pulling out a hefty item. It wasn't clear what was in his hands till it was put on a bust to the left of the bed. The bust had its own shelf in the wall. Mirroring what was under the weapons, silk was placed below it. Then a hefty gold necklace adorned it. The zoom couldn't get close enough to see all the details, but it could pick up the glitter of blue gems that were interspersed around it.

“Shit. That's all so amazing. I don't think I've ever seen antiques so old, but also in this good condition. I wonder if they are from within the family?”

Flipping back over to the maintenance, it was already over. He probably could have left fifteen minutes ago, but Phainon's gaze was elsewhere.

I still wish I could get over his charm. It's crazy. I'm not sure if I should distance myself from him or not. I don't want him to think I'm afraid of him. I’m….I’m just afraid of myself. So much in my life has gone wrong with people involved. But I couldn't bear to see him cry; it hurt so much.

Logging out of all the apps open, securing all files that were open, it was time to go home. Everything was put on its normal standby for the office. He and his team may sleep, but security is up 24/7. Once everything was back to the way it was, all items having a place, he shut off the lights-locking the door. His office also led to the server room; it always had to be secure.

Walking past all of the other cubicles, Phainon did a last check before leaving himself.

Maybe I'll swing by the restaurant and get something to take home. Maybe I can find something on the menu that would be like something he'd make. Desert as well. Good thing with being a top manager for the company, I can get in quickly for food. They know I always get take-out. Eating at Zeno's was the first time I've eaten in a place in god knows how long.

~~~~~~

“OK, so let's see. It's Wednesday. I'm most of the way through the truck. I have very little left and it's only six o'clock. I think the next two days, at least, I can finish and be done, done. Shit though… I'm starving. Maybe I'll text Phainon and see if he wants to come up to eat.”

Putting the last of the books on the shelf, Mydei took a step back to see his final work. It looked like a miniature library. He was more than happy about it.

Grabbing a stool at the counter, he pulled out his phone.

Right as he was about to text, a notification popped up.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

Kyros:

Hey, sir, just wanted to let you know,

your Sr. Tech is getting dinner.
~~~~~~

Want us to do anything?

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

“Ohhhh, well, I guess that's off the table. I can still do something nice for him at least.”

At least this way he can offer Phainon something to eat and check in on the restaurant. Mydei figures they must be busy if Kyros only texted and didn't call.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

Mydei:

Just send me the bill for it.

He did an install for me this past weekend.

I wanna thank him for it.

Give him an extra dessert.

If he didn't choose,

do the Choc. Pom Soufflé.

If he asks, just say it was paid for.

You don't have to tell him who.

Kyros:

You got it, boss.

He does show up

quite often to get take-out.

Never eats here.

Mydei:

Really?? Interesting.

What does he normally get?

If you happen to know.

Kyros:

Actually, most nights he orders,

I am the MOD.

So that's how I know he is here often.

Oddly, it's either stuff that is your personal recommendation

or meals that you have made the menu for.

Mydei:

I see, thanks so much for letting me know.

Are you guys doing OK tonight?

Did you have enough pasta?

Kyros:

Yes, we did. Tons actually.

Since you came down to

help before you took time off,

we were able to freeze a

bunch to have for other meals.

Thank you so much for your help.

***Mydei**:*

Any time. You know that.

If it were up to me,

I'd be in the kitchen every night with you,

but unfortunately, I have to run the place.

I'll let you go, since you're busy.

Have a good night, and thank you.

***Kyros**:*

Any time, boss.

Thank you. You as well.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

“Maybe this will help, though. Give him one less thing he has to worry about. I wonder if this will get him to text me. He's been awfully quiet. I do hope it wasn't me.”

Even though he was told it was fine, Mydei just had this nagging feeling that wouldn't quit. He did note that Phainon had always been kind of weird around people. Yes, he was very outgoing around those in the office, but only to a point. I still can't believe I talked him into coming with me. Especially now, knowing the information Cass told me. I probably overstepped something. I want to feel upset about it all, but he probably had his reasons.

Setting the phone down on the counter, he was searching his newly stocked refrigerator for something to eat. Using the bread that was freshly made on the weekend, he assembled a Monte Cristo without the egg wash fry. Right before it was all assembled, pomegranate jam was spread on top. A few berries were put on the plate for presentation.

He can't get away from the chef in his veins.

Just before he was about to sit down. The phone vibrated against the counter. Inside, he was hoping really hard, but he knows what they say about getting your hopes up.

Grabbing the phone, Mydei connected the call.

°°°°°°°°°°

***Phai**:*

Evening!

I hope I'm not interrupting anything.

I know you've been

VERY busy with moving in.

I did want to say thank you.

***Mydei**:*

No, actually.

I was just sitting down to eat.

I've been going all day

and really haven't stopped.

I think I'm done for the night.

…..

…..

…..

Thank me for what?

***Phai**:*

Dinner

(Mydei decided to purposefully play dumb just to see what kind of responses he'd get, considering the information he knew from Cass and now Kyros. She had also texted him again, letting him know about Phainon staying late in the office. Mydei wasn't sure if she was helping or up to something. One could never tell with her.)

***Mydei**:*

Ohhh, for Saturday,

you're more than welcome.

***Phai**:*

Well, yes, that.

No, I mean tonight.

***Mydei**:*

I've been here moving in and

I haven't spoken with

you since Saturday night.

***Phai**:*

Yeaaaa, about that..

I'm still really sorry.

***Mydei**:*

Look. I'm not upset.

I just feel like I did too much

and pushed you too hard.

I get it…

…..

I'm a lot. I'm not suited for friends.

You didn't have to try because of me.

I'm used to it.

And if you need anything extra

for me, causing a medical issue,

I have no trouble covering that.

We can just go back to how things were.

***Phai**:*

Mydei, please don't be hard on yourself.

You are an absolutely wonderful person.

I….I'm….Just a mess.

Too much to explain.

Maybe someday.

I do appreciate all you did

and bought me dinner,

again.

I just have a hard time with change.

***Mydei**:*

I get it.

Change is hard.

I just want to make sure you'll be ok.

***Phai**:*

Sweet of you to care,

but I'll be ok.

I kinda have to be.

(*I really wish he would stop worrying about me. I'm fine… ok.. in the loosest sense of the word fine. Stop making me fall for you.* Listening to his prince's voice was almost like one of those ASMR videos. Only it did every nice feeling, not just relaxation.)

***Mydei**:*

I'm sorry life has drawn you that hard lot

to make you feel that way.

I still believe you are worth it.

I would still like to try and

be friends with you.

If not, that is ok.

I respect your choice.

***Phai**:*

I really don't know what to say.

I remember what you said,

about putting your mind to a task.

Am I that important?

Like, not just as an employee.

***Mydei**:*

Honestly, yes.

I just feel something

has me drawn to you.

And for you,

I can do as much

or as little as you like.

Especially if things are hard.

(Phainon had to quietly laugh at that statement. When it comes to his prince, he was almost always at home in front of the computer and possibly hard. Now that he has more access to the man he's been pining over for years, his sex drive isn't doing him any favors.)

***Phai**:*

sighs

Ok, I can be alright with that.

But please,

if I decline anything you offer,

it isn't because of you.

I can try, though.

***Mydei**:*

Thank you, it means a lot.

I'll let you go so both of us can eat.

I do hope to see you Monday morning.

***Phai**:*

Yes, sir you will.

Have a good evening.

***Mydei**:*

Good. You too.

Enjoy your souffles.

《CLICK》

°°°°°°°°°

Popping a strawberry into his mouth, he was smiling. Mydei had a minor victory tonight. He knew that a lot of work lay ahead for them both. He had this feeling that friendship was an unknown territory, not just for himself, but also for the man who seemed like walking sunshine.

“This is a start.”

~~~~~~

“I knew it!!! He freaking cheated. I knew he took care of dinner. How else would he have known about the souffles?” He started laughing to himself, grabbing a few gnocchi with the fork. “This is what I get for falling for a Kremnos. In a battle, they will do anything to be the victor.”

After putting them in his mouth, he could taste so much more flavor. There was a hint of Parmesan and garlic. The cream sauce complemented it so well. Walking over to the desk, bowl in hand, a web browser was opened to the restaurant's web site. He wasn't aware that there was a pasta festival going on in the stores. He needed to find out what was so tasty in his mouth. Clicking the link, he found more information. Under each pasta, they had listed it and the chef who made this special version:

~Gnocchi al Sugo di Neve~

▪ Gnocchi Snow Sauce

▪Gnocchi made of garlic and parmesan, pan fried. Then tossed in a home made white sauce, topped with parsley and shredded parmesan.

▪ Chef: Mydeimos Kremnos; Chef de Cuisine
~~~~~~

“You have got to be fucking me? Really?? I just happened to pick HIS dish?? I just said Gnocchi… I…. Fuck, it still tastes good.”

Even though Phainon tried his best not to do anything associated with the prince, it always seemed to come back to him. Part of him now had to get used to his life officially changing the moment he agreed to put the system in. There was some force at play, pushing them together.

“I wonder what he's up to after dinner.” Cleaning up the rest of the pasta for later and putting the desserts in the fridge, he went to get changed before touching the feed. Thinking about the last time he watched, Phainon decided the fewer clothes the better. He'd take care of his suit later on. All parts of it were placed over a chair.

How easy do I want to make this on myself? If anything happens, pretty easy.

Reaching into his underwear drawer, he found a dark red cloth that was held together with a string on the sides. Easy access is all he was after.

Haha, maybe red is becoming my new favorite color. I mean… it does look so good on him. White would be better.

Wandering back out to the computer, the feed was brought up for the house. Looking all around, no prince could be found. The lights were off in the kitchen. Same for the living room. The pool was empty. There was only one other place to look.

The bedroom.

Switching over to the other app, Phainon just catches him coming back into the bedroom. Mydei's hair is wet, clinging to his back. A black towel adorned his waist.

Ohhh, he must have just gotten clean. Shit, I missed it. Wait! Wait, wait…. That blanket wasn't on his bed earlier in the day.

Phainon watched with an intensely inquisitive face. Not quite sure where it was going. He did happen to forget the prince was always full of surprises.

The towel was placed on the chest at the end of the bed. His whole body was laid bare to the camera. The camera zoomed in a bit more to catch all of his movements.

“Well, now this is a sight. What kind of desert do you have for me?? Sate my curiosity.“ Phainon was already half erect, watching the monitor. The night stand beside the bed was open, Mydei was looking for some things inside. When that something was found, it was placed on top by the lamp. With the half naked Adonis in front of the camera, he couldn't tell what was picked.

Getting a better angle on the bed, Phainon knew he needed both hands now. They may be separated, but for the man he's lusted after from the shadows, doing this together was becoming his new favorite thing.

“Wait a minute…. It's a sex blanket?? The virgin prince has one?? Well fuck me. God, this just keeps getting better.”

He watched Mydei get into the middle of his fairly large bed. The items from the night stand were put beside him. A shiny silver ring, a bottle of lube, and a silicone tube.

Phainon’s own strings were pulled, letting the fabric fall to the seat.

Mydei got a good amount of lube in his hand, stroking himself to a full erection. The ring was lubed up more and slid down the shaft to the base. It was just tight enough on it that the skin puffed above the metal.

Ohhh damn, a cockring just for me. You shouldn't have. Well, I can do that too, sexy.

Getting into his special drawer, Phainon found his own, sliding down his length. His breath hitched along the way. He could feel the skin becoming more sensitive to the touch.

Mydei started at his chest. Squeezing the strong muscles that he's been working on for a while. His nipples brushed against his palms with every squeeze. He then pinched each nub, pulling it slightly with each pass.

His erection was standing at full mast with every touch. The ring was forcing more blood flow to it, making the veins on it stand at attention. Begging to be touched. Mydei was purposely neglecting it. Teasing himself. With how sensitive his chest was, soft moans were filling the room.

Should I turn it on? Fuck I want to hear him. It's probably so nice.

Phainon hesitated, but only for a moment. His clean hand switched on the audio. Quickly, he plugged the headphones in. Pahinon wanted this right in his ears. Audio and physical sensors on his body were going to go crazy.

He wanted it all.

“Nnnhhh uhmmm.” Finally came through to his ears. The one sound he didn't know if he'd ever hear. Those soft moans he could listen to forever. Hearing Mydei enjoying himself made his dick twitch harder. Having the ring on his own, he could see just how red and sensitive it had become. It was occasionally brushing against his stomach because of slouching in the seat.

Giving them both a hard pull, Mydei's right hand reached down to run his fingers over the leaking head. His pre-cum was all over his fingers. Dancing around the head, he sucked in a breath harder, grabbing the aching tip.

“Uhhhhmmm gawd.. god dammit… I needed this… so fucking.. good… nnnhhh.” It was all the more that Mydei could get out, rubbing around the head.

Phainon just watched in pure bliss, seeing the man of his dreams pleasure himself fully, completely unaware of the man enjoying himself from the shadows. He was being a bit mean to himself by not touching it yet. Phainon knew the more his eyes consumed, that when it was time, it would be hard and fast.

Mydei took a few strokes down, trying desperately not to thrust into his hand. The bottle of lube was held above the head, letting the clear liquid flow down over it. Squeezing the shaft near the base, his hand guided back up to lube the whole shaft. Getting it nice and slick, the sleeve was grabbed, placing it right over the tip.

Just pushing in the tip, hips thrusted just enough for it.

“God, it's so tight… fucckk.” Mydei's hips are trying to buck up into the hole.

Yes, please… please fuck the hole. Let me see you pleasure yourself fully. Don't deny it anymore.

As if his wish was granted, Mydei pushes his length the whole way inside. A long moan filled the room.

Phainon could feel his length twitch harder; it felt so full. There was a possibility he might cum without being touched. Letting his brain do all the work.

Pinching the nipple harder made Mydei's hip seek the sheath more; it needed to be enveloped by the ribbed inners more. He wants to feel that pleasure coursing through his body. “Ohh fuck.. there.. riggggghhhhht… there…” he bit his lip, feeling the one spot that was more sensitive - right under the crown.

Phainon’s heart was picking up; he was getting so close. Juices were all-over his abs and down the length. He could tell how hard Mydei was thrusting; he was close.

Damn.. I wanna touch myself.... Can I? Can I come with you, my prince?

“Yessss…God….. yessss…” Mydei's hands and hips almost couldn't take any more.

Phainon swears some magic must be at play. Someone was sending his prayers to be answered. Once his own fingers wrapped around it, he was

thrusting at almost the same speed. Phainon was so sensitive from needing to be touched that it wasn't going to take much.

Mydei tossed the sleeve to the side; he needed a tighter grip. Sunset hair clung to sweaty skin. How sensitive the mic was, it picked up all his moaning and wet sounds. Phainon knew he would never hear Mydei sing this well, unless he was coming apart from pleasure.

As if the gods above knew what needed to be done, both men trusted hard into their hands, cuming at the same time. They perfectly mirrored each other. Seamen all over their torsos. Phainon got his slightly higher because of his posture in the chair.

It was several minutes of hard breathing till either man calmed down.

If my hand is this good, I wonder how good his is. It has to be my birthday. That was the best present ever.

Carefully, he slid the ring off, taking it with him to the bathroom. He was going to need a long shower after the show he just got.

Next time I see him in person, it's gonna be so difficult not to see anything other than what my camera's have shown me. My Prince, thank you for this wonderful dessert.

~~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

Those poor boys are just menaces to each other and neither is truly aware of it.

The boss finally comes back to work with some suprises in hand. Is it breaking and entering of you have the keys and its your building?

thank you so much for reading and support.<3
~~~~~~~~

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 7

Chapter Summary

Mydei is now all done moving his stuff in. Now he can finally enjoy HIS home. A thought struck him. I have a restaurant grade kitchen, might as well use it.
Much to Cass' suprise Monday morning comes equipped with a more cheerful boss and pastry presents.

But she wasn't the only one. He also had some for his IT manager. Being the head of the office, he had a skeleton key for all the doors. He really wishes that he could be here when Phainon gets in, just see the reaction, but taking off a week, meetings need taken care of.

Phainon is so going to have a hissy fit that someone was inside his office.

Chapter Notes

Soft beta read.

This is a sad emotional chapter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The weekend went by in a flash. The large moving truck was returned to its business, and the prince finally had all his stuff moved in. He could finally call it his home.

Even living in a studio apartment till now, didn't feel as weird as having a whole house to yourself. The room and privacy is what he really was after. Maids and body guards always made sure he was OK or needed anything. Parents are making him go to ‘events’ to mingle with people. None of that he really wants or needs.

Like he had told Kyros, the kitchen was more important to him. A business still had to be run, and Mydei knew it. But everything was by his rule and how he wanted it done. And from the business reports that have been coming in for the past few years, things have been turning a major profit.

All five restaurants under his leadership were doing amazing business. Customers were more than ecstatic to go. Raving about everything under the sun. They loved the food and the service, but the only thing they didn't like was the wait times. They knew why, though. The food was worth it.

For that, Mydei could be content with being CEO instead of Chef de Cuisine. He would rather be in the kitchen basking in the chaos there, helping make things, and just being on ground level. Yes, he was the heir to a big family business, but none of that mattered. Like his mother always said, He followed his heart.

If you ask most, that is what draws people in. Leading by his heart and trying to be fair with everyone isn't something you find a lot these days. When things were tough and needed to be taken care of, no one wanted to be on the receiving end of his wrath. There wasn't any screaming, but the words hit you like a dagger through the heart.

~~~~~

A basket of pastries was placed on the desk.

“Uhmm..Hi, sir!” Castorice was shocked by the huge vessel sitting on her desk.”What is all of this?? It smells amazing.”

“I was busy with my new kitchen. Made a few things.”

“Sir, that is way more than a ‘**few’** things. It's like you brought me the whole bakery, but I graciously accept them, though. Thank you so very much,” Castorice was beaming from ear to ear. She was so excited to receive such a gift.

“Question, My dear Castorice. Has Mr. Khaslana happened to come in yet?”
~~~~~

“No, actually, I don't believe he has yet. Is that a problem?”

A smile sneaks into the corner of his mouth. He turned to go down the hall to the IT branch of the office. “Absolutely not at all. I'll be back.”

Walking into the office, no one was in yet. Which was a total convenience for him. His steps stopped at the door situated at the end of the six mini offices. Mydei reached into his pocket, getting a stack of keys. Since he was head of the office, the ring housed the master keys to all the doors. He had them all in case of an emergency, like the power going out. Finding the right one, he put it in slowly, letting himself into the office. He had actually never been in Phainon's office before. Most meetings are held in his own. He couldn't believe the amount of technology in the room.

“Wow, there is so much here. It's crazy. Hopefully, he enjoys the present.” He places the basket on the desk, hand lingering on it for a time. Lost in thought. There was that mysterious force again calling him.

“I should get going, I have a lot of stuff to get to, I've been out for a week.” Locking the door behind him, Mydei walked through the halls of the office back to his own. Still drifting off in thought. *What is it about one white haired man that has me so distracted? I don't get it.*

Once back at the entrance, he passes the front desk. ”Ohh, Cass, I got the itinerary. I'll be out of the office in meetings for most of the day. So if anything happens to come through, can you handle it for me?”

“Yes, sir, I can. Don't forget to eat lunch, too.”

He is gone for the shortest amount of time. Enough to get his work laptop and documents for the meetings, he was ready to go. “I won't. I know you'll hound me later about what I ate.”

“Ohh, too. The house looks very nice from the pics you sent me. I'm so happy you have a place to call your own now. You do seem much happier than before you bought it.”

The smile came back to his face, adjusting the glasses that adorned it. “Thanks, I'll have to take you up sometime.” With a smile and nod, he boarded the elevator and left for the day.

As the clock switched over to eight-thirty, the IT department started filling in. Castorice greeted them all as they passed her desk. There was one person she was waiting for. Knowing what their boss was up to, the reaction was imminent. Just to what degree was to be seen.

~~~~~

The Monday morning trek into work was always terrible. Not so bad now after he's had a ‘personal’ workout and eye candy all week. The boss was fulfilling so many of his desires. Phainon couldn't ask for more.

The elevator clicked with a loud ding, signaling he was at the desired floor. The forecast was calling for rain today, making stepping out onto the office floor not so bright. Even being up as high as they were, the first thing in the morning is a lot for eyes that normally stare at computer screens all day.

“Morning, Miss Castorice. I hope your weekend went well.” Even though his body was ‘tired’ from all the work he put it through, Phainon was still able to keep a smile on his face.

“Good morning, Mr. Khaslana. Yes, it went well, thank you. I hope yours did as well.”

Just rounding her desk, he stopped to see her. “Yes, it did. Hey, question, is the boss in?”

Phainon wasn't sure why he was asking. He did A LOT of seeing the boss in the past week - With and without clothes. Even though there was a hiccup with going out and spending time together, the cameras were now his new favorite thing.

“Actually, no. Since he was out for a week, all of his meetings from last week got pushed to today. He is going to the meetings instead of them coming here. Mr. Kremnos felt bad about having to reschedule. Did you
~~~~~

need a meeting with him?” She knew something was up, but didn't press anything. Probably within the hour, she'd see him again over the basket.

“No, no.. I'm good. Just wondered. Well, I got a system to make sure things went well overnight. I'll see you later, Ma'am.” With his back to her, strolling down the hall, he waved.

Why did I want to know? It isn't like I NEED to see him. I need to stop wanting this. I know I agreed to be friends on my terms, but I don't need to push it. I can't have him finding out about my past or what I do now. I'd be ruined if he did.

Opening the door to their section of the office, he can hear the chatter of everyone going over their weekends. Walking past the rooms, greeting everyone with a smile, coffee in hand. No one made conversation with him first thing in the morning. Phainon just didn't like getting up, and Monday mornings were always the worst. They normally waited about 10-15 minutes before popping their head in to personally do a morning greeting.

Key pad numbers were pressed on the door, turning the handle. His hand went in first to pop the lights. Stepping inside his heart was in turmoil and panic. There was a basket on his desk. Someone had entered his office when he wasn't there. Cleaning always came before they left for the day. Scanning the area, his visual memory was running down how the office looked when he was last here on Friday night. It was really odd that nothing was touched.

What IS going on? I don't like this.

Slowly walking around the desk, the basket never left his sight. There was a red cover over top of the contents with a note placed above.

Once in front, the basket was inspected for any misgivings. Nothing seemed off. There was a card placed on top.

¤¤¤¤¤

Phainon

I hope you don't mind me dropping off a present for you. I feel like some unsaid things may have happened between us that have made things weird. I deeply apologize. I do hope you'll accept my apology. I wanted to give this to you the morning you fell ill. Please take care of yourself. I don't want to lose a dear friend.

Mydei

P.S. I do hope the gnocchi were good.

¤¤¤¤¤

“I can't believe him. He broke into my office just to give me presents. At least he admitted to buying me dinner, brat.” A warmth was felt within him. Phainon didn't know where it was coming from. It has been a long time since someone has put forth so much effort for him. The last people that did were his parents. They respected his boundaries but still tried to show their affection when possible.

Phainon knew they loved him.

They put forth so much love. He was adopted because his ‘mother’ couldn't convince, and both still wanted to be parents. Phainon would always be grateful for them. They were the only people in his life who made him feel loved, despite the demons he harbored against himself.

Now there was someone else who was trying.

That someone was his boss.

Heir to a huge family.

Who just wanted to be normal

And have friends.

Him.

Seeing his reflection in the blank monitor, there was a smile on his face. Small, but there. Something in how much Mydei cares and is trying, weaving its way into his heart. It was looking for a space in the darkness to call its own. As much as he wanted to fight it, that little portion just couldn't be patched back over. Phainon was allowing the prince in.

Sometimes he didn't understand himself at all.

Ohh fuck, stupid. You still didn't see your present. I mean...he was my present, but we don't need to talk about that. God, it was soooo good.

Lifting up the red cloth with the same ornate flame design on it as was with the antiques, he was greeted with a plethora of sweets and breads. Phainon knew that they were all hand made in that new kitchen of his. Already having Mydei's cooking, he knew they were going to be amazing.

He took out a small cupcake-looking pastry. The sides were folded in and covered with sugar, and a big dollop of cream cheese sat at the center. Like a Danish, but bite-sized. The bite he took was the perfect amount of sweet to contrast his bitter black coffee. First thing in the morning, it was the only drink that ever woke him up. He'd tried other things, but the first thing in the day to help was this. Once he was awake and fully ready to take on the world, there were other beverages that could be had.

Finishing off the mini Danish, he licked his fingers clean. The boss wanted to take care of him. It was so weird. They hardly interacted over the 8 years he’s been in this office. Searching his memory, he couldn't find any reason why Mydei would single him out to want to be friends with.

Unfortunately, I think I'm fucked in that department. I mean, I'm more of a top anyway… maybe. I mean, I've never had sex… and I don't feel toys count. I do want to see him under me, though…

His admission kinda shocked him. He’s used to just watching from the shadows, never wanting any more than. Something about the sunset was drawing him in. Almost had him wanting to wade out into the ocean and just drown in it.

“I need to go ask Castorice what she knows about this.”

She tried to hold in her smile; him coming back was a sign that what the boss did worked. She was way too good at feigning ignorance.

“Yes, Mr. Khaslana?? What can I do for you?” She smiled up at him, stopping mid-type.

“Just out of curiosity, when did Mr. Kremnos come in this morning? And did he have anything with him?”

Pulling up her log on the computer, it showed the clock-in times of everyone on the floor.

“Let's see. He was in around 7 am. There was a meeting he had to get to by 8:15 that was across town. The only thing with him was his phone. His briefcase and laptop were here. Why do you ask?” She had already hidden her basket before anyone else came into the building.

“Noo, noo. You're good. I was left some things by him. No biggie,” He was getting nervous, hoping that she couldn't tell. “I'll get back to my stuff, sorry to bother you, Ma'am.”

Castorice watched him walk away, rubbing the back of his neck. It was very red. She only felt a little bad for embarrassing him, but there was an energy she felt from him talking about Mydei. More than just co-workers or friends. She didn't want to push it, but was going to keep an eye on them both. A possible romance was brewing, and she was more than excited about it.

~~~~~~

“Yes, thank you. I can't wait to see how we can incorporate this product into our meals.”

After shaking hands with the clients, Mydei left the boardroom. He was partway down the hall when his phone vibrated. He stopped, leaning against
~~~~~~

the wall to take a break. Even though he had been sitting for a while, walking and reading just wasn't what his eyes needed.

The icons at the top showed texts, and the notification bar just showed ‘Messages’ so it was more than just one. Touching the bar, it took him to the list. One was from Castorice at the very top.

¤¤¤¤

Cass:

Hi, sir! Hope your meetings are going well. Just FYI, I feigned ignorance when your Security head came to ask about the basket. It was cute that he was very embarrassed about getting a present. Plus, he looked kinda sad you weren't here to talk to when he first came in. Thought I'd let you know. Have a good rest of the day. :)

¤¤¤¤

Mydei just laughed at the message. He has always known she was up to no good. It's the quiet ones you have to watch out for. He appreciated her help, though. Maybe Mydei can finally get some kind of friendship from Phainon with her help. The security head was more locked up with his emotions than the servers that were being watched over.

“Maybe one day, I will truly have a friend that I can openly share stuff with. There is just something about him. I can't put my finger on it, but I know he's special. Which, speaking of special…”

Below her text was one from the man in question. Part of him was excited to be able to talk to him. Mydei hurried his walk back to the car. He wanted privacy to read these texts.

Once in the car, he just sat. Didn't turn the car on, either. Leaning back in the seat, deep thoughts were running through his mind.

Maybe…I don't know… maybe I'm developing feelings for him. I don't really know what love is like outside of family...but going out to eat and

spending time in the car together… and hell, I had a breakdown in front of him. I don't do that. But I did, and he hugged me. It… it felt nice. Warm. If I weren't such a mess talking about my childhood, I could have had one longer...

He leaned the seat back a bit more. Checking the time, it was 10 am. The next meeting wasn't for another forty-five minutes. Maybe he could take some time to talk through his feelings.

“ Is that what love is beyond friendship? That deep level of caring. Getting a warm feeling around them or talking about them?? I'm gonna hold off on asking Cass about it till I feel a bit more ok with it all.”

He was stalling too much in his head; there was still another text to see.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

Phai:

I really don't know what to say.

Besides, I almost needed to get my heart checked.

How did you get into my office??

And then leave such a big present. :)

It all looks amazing.

I did have the one cupcake Danish thing.

It was really good.

I think I could eat like 10 of them.

But….

Thank you.

Mydei:

1: It's called a kouignette.

Yes, it's kinda like a Danish.

I happen to like cream cheese,

so I made some with it.

Also, I made a variant with pomegranate jam.

2: I'm glad you liked it

3: You forget I run the office.

I do have a master key, but don't worry.

I won’t abuse my power with it.

Phai:

Ohhh, uhmm hi.

I wasn't expecting you to respond.

Miss Castorice said you have meetings all day.

Mydei:

I do, but I'm in between ones right now.

I made time to talk.

Phai:

No no.. I don't want to interrupt.

Mydei:

I'd enjoy the distraction.

(Phainon felt a big thump in his chest. Swallowing hard, he wasn't sure if he was breathing. *Did I take my meds?* Something in the care that was given made his heart feel things he's never felt before. No one has ever given him these kinds of emotions. There were two sides to him. One was his happy side that everyone sees. Who was more than elated to receive gifts and be thought of. Then the other. The one Phainon feels is a monster and doesn't deserve anything. Least of all, the attention from his desire. He wishes so hard there was a middle ground between the two; trauma makes it all hard.)

Phai*:*

I don't know what to say.

Mydei:

I am sorry if I caused any issues.

I didn't think you'd let me give it to you in person.

I wanted to respect your boundaries,

but still wanted to leave you a gift for everything.

(*Deimos…. Your smile was enough for me. You are too kind and caring. I truly believe I'm falling in love with you, and I can't. You make it so hard not to. Everything is so infectious, and fighting it is so hard. I want it...I do. I can accept some things...I'll try...Please, I don't want more.* Phainon was having such an internal battle.*)*

Phai:

I…uhmm. Thank you.

Mydei:

It is totally up to you, and you can say no if you wish.

Would you be willing to come with me this weekend?

There is a place I'd love to show you.

Phai:

Let me think about it.

Plus, I don't know what's up for the weekend.

Mydei:

Fair enough. I have to get going.

My meeting is soon.

Have a good rest of your day.

Sorry again about scaring you.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

He closed his phone, holding it tight in his hand. Mydei was hoping with all his being that the offer would be accepted. It was something good from his childhood that he wanted to share. He wanted this feeling again. Something about talking to this one person made his heart beat in a way that was new and exciting. Like the walk through the woods, straying from the path. Not being afraid of the unknown, but feeling like the destination would be worth it.

Only time would tell.

~~~~~~

“I knew it… I guess it's a nice surprise, though. I don't get that often.”

Phainon sat back in the chair, just staring at the basket and what it meant. Mydei was putting forth so much effort into just him. It feels way different than his parents. They were there 24/7 with him growing up; they knew their son. But this is his boss, whom he only sees maybe once a week if need be. Sometimes not at all.

Now, Mydei wanted more with him.

Did he want to lie to get out of going?

YES

But the other half of him wants to be around this one man. The more Mydei does for him and around him, he yearns for it. Why is just sitting behind the computer screen his safe spot? He knows now he can't fully hide. The object of his desires is trying to be a part of his life, and is making him not know how to handle things.
~~~~~~

An email notification popped up at the bottom of his screen, pulling him out of his deep thoughts. Phainon hovered his mouse over the red dot to see what the subject of the email was.

《Evernight Restaurants Annual Employee Party》

“Ohhh shit. It's really that soon. I do hope Mydei doesn't bring it up in any of our chats. I never go to these events, even more so now that he's trying really hard to be my friend.”

Worse off is that I have cameras in his bedroom and catch a lot of stuff I SHOULDN'T, but do anyway.

He grumbles to himself about the whole situation. Being told about the party just made things worse. Phainon really wishes his mother were still alive. She always had a big heart and knew the right things to say. Since they have been gone for about five years now, he has had no one to turn to. There is no one he trusted with his life, and how messed up it was. She had no prejudices against him and loved him with no hesitation.

“Fucking hell, I miss her. Maybe I need to go see them. Clear my head a little. I've been so busy as of late, I just haven't had time.”

~~~~~

Looking at the clock, it was just going on four in the afternoon. Everything was done for the day, Phainon decided his work was done, and he was going to go see them.

Giving his office the once over, everything had its place, and he was making sure it did. His photographic memory for his office was always a big help.

Walking past the first office, he let them know he was out for the day. Just to double-check everything, making sure it was all off and locked up before heading out.
~~~~~

Almost all of his employees popped their heads out of the cubicles, hearing that the boss was leaving early. To them, that was unheard of. They figured it must be something important not to be staying after hours. Each of them looked at him strangely, noticing the basket he carried with the normal briefcase.

“Hey, Miss Castorice.”

She jumped a little in her seat. Busing working on her reports; his footsteps were never heard. “Ohhh, Mr. Khaslana?! Uhmm hi. Sorry, I was doing reports. What can I do for you?”

“I just wanted to let you know I'm heading out. There are some people I need to go see before heading home. Everyone knows I'm leaving. “

She was a little shocked by the statement. Phainon was never known to leave early. And go meet with PEOPLE. Most took him for a hermit. Her inner matchmaker was taking note to tell the boss. “Oh, sure thing. Please have a pleasant evening, and I'll see you in the morning.”

“Yes, Ma'am. You as well.”

Watching him get on the elevator and leave, she pulled out her phone sending a quick text to the boss letting him know what had just transpired.

“There is definitely something there between them. I just wonder what. I do know that they would be so cute together.” Humming happily to herself, she went back to her work after sending the text.

~~~~

Exiting the flower shop, two small bouquets were in hand. They had an important destination.

The drive over to the cemetery was a short one. Good business strategy on their part. People always wanted flowers and wreaths for their past loved ones. Why not be practically right across the street?
~~~~

Pulling into the lot, luck was on his side. Totally empty. He could have had his meeting in peace.

Going down the lane, it was very serene. Everyone is taking their eternal nap. Mother Nature is a soft blanket for them. Most found the cemetery a place they didn't want to come often, but it didn't bother him any.

He did scold himself for not coming more often. It had been a few months.

Stopping beside a huge cherry tree, the pink springtime petals were all gone by now. Summer was starting soon, and most had gone through their cycle already. He would have loved to come when they were all in bloom.

There, just beside the tree, was a joint head stone.

Squatting down, he placed flowers down for them both. Small tears were welling up in his eyes. He hugged his knees.

“Hi, guys. Sorry, I haven't been around as of late. Work has been busy. My mind has been all over the place. I wish you were here to talk to. I could really use your support. More now than ever before.”

His heart was so emotional right now that he never noticed that a light rain was falling. It's like the worldly mother saw his pain and wanted to embrace him the best she knew how. He then couldn't tell his tears from the rain. It didn't matter. Getting soaked was fine by him.

“Someone is trying to be friends with me, and I don't know how to handle it. He's so uber nice. You both would have loved him, but you know me. I've always kept to myself. Afraid of the unknown. Keeping my distance kept me safe. I didn't get attached. I didn't have to lose anyone ever again. Now this….”

He sat on the ground, not caring if he got messy. Hugging himself was the only way he knew to maybe stop crying. Everything hurts.

“Mother, he's too nice. You would have loved him the most. He's such a wonderful person, and I have done some bad things he doesn't know about.

I want to keep our distance, but something keeps pushing us together. It's just all too much.”

Time was lost to him now.

He didn't know what time it was when he actually stopped crying. When he came to, after having a talk with them, his whole body was drenched. It had rained enough to soak through all his clothes.

The light shower continued to come down on him. Phainon wasn't sure if talking to the dead would help his situation, but it just felt good to get it all out in the open. His problem was still there and just something he'd have to work on.

Finally getting up, he ran his fingers along the stone. Saying a silent goodbye for now to them.

The melancholy white hair made its way back from whence he came. Reaching into the back seat, he got towels to cover his sitting area. He was a mess. In more than one sense of the word. A long, hot shower was what he needed once he'd returned home.

Maybe nap too, his heart was still broken and wet.

~~~~

Popping the umbrella open, Mydei made his way to the car. The last meeting he had was coincidentally by the graveyard. His eyes caught sight of something very familiar. A dark blue car that belonged to his security officer.

What is it doing here?

Opening his phone, another text from Cass gave him the answer he was looking for. Following the path with his eyes, he found a lone body, drenched, standing beside a headstone.

Mydei felt his heart breaking watching what was before him.
~~~~

He knew then it was his parents.

Getting into the car, he headed over to the flower shop. Purchasing two flowers that had a soft red gradient. Dusted with blue glitter on the ends. Made them look wet.

Not wanting to get in the way, Mydei waited till the blue car was gone to go over. He followed the path Phainon walked down, stopping at the tree. The headstone read ‘Khaslana’.

Placing the two flowers with the ones already there, he thanked them for having such a wonderful son. Mydei felt he was lucky to have met him and hoped that they could provide him *with* the help he was looking for.

“Please look after him. Phainon is an amazing person. I would like to try and make him happy. He deserves it.”

Bowing at the two of them, he walks back to the car. It was quiet in his head. It is as if the spirits of the cemetery were walking him to the gates. A silent ‘*thank you’* left his lips as he got into the car.

After a quick trip to the office, it would be time to go home. It's been a long day physically and emotionally. He just wanted a long soak in the tub to unwind.

I do hope he's ok.

~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

> Poor baby, you just want to hug him. So much makes him feel like he isn't worth it, but to one CEO, he is worth more than an employee. He wants that friendship.
>
> A text conversation is leading to what many would, most definitely call a date. Will Phainon ageee to the request or not?
> ~~~~~~•
> Thank you for reading. Uber appreciate it!
~~~~~~

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy

Chapter 8

Chapter Summary

> Phainon still couldn't understand it all. Did the universe think it was fun to pick on him? First, he had a crush on a boy from the news. Then, he got a nice cushy job, only to then be manager at the place where that boy, now a man, owns and operates a business. Now, that crush wants to spend a whole weekend with him. It's like the universe was poking him every step of the way. Even the silent gravestones of his parents would probably say the same thing : just try.
>
> Will one phone call happen to change his mind?
> (Again universe doing its poking)

Chapter Notes

> No official beta read. First off, sorry this took so long, been battling a head cold this past week and that + work has kicked my butt. I do thank you for keepinh up with their tale of romance unspoken.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Even though Phainon had access to the one thing that gave him the deepest pleasure in the world, after visiting his parents, it was hard to watch.

All the perversion that came from the camera installation took a back burner to the turmoil of his own feelings. Saying how he felt, out in the open, put a lot of his life into perspective. He knew, though in the end, no matter how he was feeling about Mydei, it couldn't go any further. He would have to try to fight it. As much as his parents would want him to find someone who could love and be there for him, his sins outweighed the positive.

There were a few videos during the week that were saved to watch later, his heart, or well, his drive, wasn't in it.

Before Phainon knew it, Friday was already here. Deciding to take another trip to see them might help him make a decision on how he wanted to handle the weekend. Knowing full well that Mydei wanted to take him somewhere. It was the fight between being a hermit or trying to be friends with the man that had clenched his soul.

Since Monday, everything had been fairly normal, but quiet. Not once did he see or interact with the boss. He felt maybe Mydei was giving him space. Not trying to push things.

Life on his terms.

The same trip back to the cemetery felt like the one earlier in the week, minus the rain. Going down the same flower path, something caught his eye. Finally getting back to the headstone, he found the anomaly. There were 2 single flowers put in each bouquet. They were each varying shades of red that were dusted with blue glitter.

“They are so pretty. But who? I wanted them buried here so I could visit them more often. Our home was far from here. My parents didn't have any friends that I know of. So who would leave them such a simple but poignant gift?”

Just as the last words left his lips, his pocket vibrated. Leaning against the tree, he fished the phone out.

Mydei?

Part of him forgot what today was. The day before the weekend. Meaning he had all the free time in the world.

¤¤¤¤

Mydei:

Hey, sorry to bother you.

Just wanted to see how you were doing.

Cass had said you've looked a bit down.

If there is any way I can help, let me know.

Please don't trouble yourself with the thing I had mentioned.

Maybe some other time.

Phai:

No, you're fine.

Just a lot has been on

my mind as of late.

…..

……

……..

Uhmmm, I would probably have enjoyed whatever you had planned,

but I don't do long car rides very well.

I'm not sure how I did

those trips with you, honestly.

Mydei:

I assume it's something more than motion sickness?

As I said, it's ok.

I understand.

You don't have to push anything on my account.

I won't bother you as much

if it gives you the space you need.

I can be content with just this.

Just someone to talk to.

Phai:

Mydei.. I..

Mydei:

It's ok.

I don't mind.

Really.

I was headed there anyway.

I'll bring you back some….

Phai:

Noooo, wait!

I do want to go,

but if it's a long trip,

I have to do something

to mitigate my anxiety.

Mydei:

Are you sure?

I don't want to be too much.

Phai:

No…. No, you're not.

I'll figure myself out.

You take care of the trip.

How do you want to do this?

Mydei*:*

Well, it is a longer car ride.

I was thinking, if ok with you,

we'd stay the weekend.

I can pick you up early tomorrow morning, drive us there,

show you the surprise,

and then come home Sunday night.

Since we both have work on Monday morning.

(Wait!?! Shit!?! Alone with Mydei?? ALL WEEKEND! I can do this. I can't promise I won't fall more madly in love with him. But if I go, I can't run away. If it gets too much, I won't be at home, where I can hide. Just remember to bring more meds. Phainon was excited, but that anxiety was creeping in again.*)*

Phai:

Ok. That's fine.

If I need a few for myself,

is that gonna be an issue??

I don't want to ruin your surprise.

Mydei:

Not at all. I'll make sure we have separate rooms so that you can have your privacy.

So if you're ok with it all,

I'll pick you up around 5:30am.

Just so we can get on the road before things get busy.

Just remember to bring your meds with you.

I can get you to a hospital if need be,

but it would be a bit difficult where we'll be.

Phai:

Trust me,

I won't be forgetting them.

Wait….

How about just picking me up at work?

Mydei:

Sounds like a plan.

Thank you.

I do hope you have a good time.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

“Shit.. what did I just agree to? Well, I'd better head home and get packed. Get my meds in order.” Reaching down, he placed a hand on the headstone. “I'm trying… for you guys. I hope I'll be ok.”

~~~~~

5:15 am, Saturday

Phainon had arrived fifteen minutes early to try and prepare his nerves. The medicine for his blood pressure and anxiety was already taken, but this was way too early in the morning for him. The excitement of it all made Phainon restless. His extra pillow and blanket, which his mom made, were on the trip. Maybe having her comfort would ease his troubled mind.

The cameras at the house sent a notification that the boss was on the move. With a speedy car like his, he'd be here in no time.

Just breathe, you got this.

Five-thirty on the dot, the sleek black iridescent car pulled in beside him. It was time for Phainon to face his fears. It is a trial; he was hoping that failure wasn't an option. He wanted to try so hard. Try to do maybe one thing positive with his life.

Once parked, the driver exited. Sunset hair pulled up in a little bun at the back, letting the rest hang down. Mydei's signature braid was worn with the tightest of folds. Donning his black spectacles made the young CEO look so much more alluring. A black short-sleeved button down was over a dark red tank top. Nothing was buttoned but the ones at the bottom, tucked into his pants. The under shirt was tight enough that Phainon could make out his pecs and possibly his abs. Mydei even wore his favorite ripped jeans.

The whole image was to die for.

“Since it's so early, would you want to sleep most of the way there? Might mitigate having to look at the road.” Phainon was stunned by how
~~~~~

thoughtful everything was. “Honestly, I already put the chair back to lie down in, and there is a small cooler in the back seat with water in case you need it.” Mydei added.

Walking to the back of the car, strong fingers that have seen many cuts and burns glossed over a part of the trunk. It popped. Phainon had never seen a trunk so fancy before. Must be the perks of choosing how your car is made. “If you want, anything you don't want to leave upfront, throw it back here in the trunk.”

Making sure everything was out of his car was important. Phainon grabbed the bags first. Taking over to the trunk, he was in awe of how much space it had, considering how small the car looks. “Damn, this car is so nice, like everything on it, in it. It's all beautiful.”

That smile Phainon loved came back to Mydei's face. “My mother would love to hear you say that. She went with me to get this. Helped pick out all it would have.”

“She has such good taste. Like, I'm not a CAR guy, but I know nice when I see it.” Closing his back doors, he gets in his passenger side, taking out the pillow and blanket. The whole situation still felt a bit weird to him, but he remembered that he promised to try.

Mydei opened the door for him to get in, placing his stuff on the seat. “Are you sure you're ok? I don't want to push you.” The worry and concern were written all over his face.

“Yes, we are good. This thing is important enough for you to want to share it with me, of all people.” Taking a big deep breath, Phainon steeled his nerves. Trying to be open was a big step for him. Especially considering that someone wasn't family.

“Well, I do consider you someone special. And you've already been partially exposed to it. So I figured, why not take it to the next level?” Mydei was as vague as possible.That smile was still on his face. Even though the sun wasn't out at this time of morning, the driver was the

brightest thing here. Lighting up not only the area, but a dark part of his being.

Wait?!?! Next level!?!? What is he talking about?? Nooo!..No...no...no and no…we are not dating. Not happening.

A voice broke his panicked thoughts, “Are you just gonna stand there in your head or are you gonna get in to go back to bed?”

“Ohh shit, sorry.” Giving his car the once over, it was beeped. Keys shoved in his pocket. Getting into the plush passenger side was like heaven on his butt. He still couldn't get over how comfortable the seats were. Putting the belt across his lap, he lay back on the seat.

“Shit…” a yawn pulled from his body “...this seat is.. com..fy.. “ it was almost as if being hugged by the cushions was just enough pressure and support to make him feel sleepy. He didn't last long. Mydei waited till his passenger was fast asleep to pull out of the parking lot.

Being that it was a newer car, it rode very smoothly. When any kind of bumps or divots in the road happened, all the wheels acted like it was nothing. Mydei had some soft classical playing at a low volume, not to disturb Phainon's sleep.

I really wonder if car rides are that bad for him? Did something happen in his past? Hopefully, I can get him there ok.

Some time had passed on the road.

Glancing at the clock, Mydei noted they were making great time. Everything was going ok until he heard the blanket shift a bit. Then a lot. Because of being on the highway and no one being around, Mydei set it to cruise control.

Looking over at his passenger, Phainon had the most pained look on his face, and his body was shaking.

Shit, he's having a nightmare.

*K*eeping his eyes on the road, left hand on the steering wheel, Mydei reaches over to the sleeping passenger. Gently grabbing his hand to try and ease whatever turmoil his mind is playing. Phainon's hand squeezes a bunch. All with varying levels of tightness.

What's going on inside his mind must be the reason why he is so distant from people. That's so horrible. For someone so nice to experience this, it isn't fair.

Suddenly, the grip loosens. It's not clinging on as if its life depends on it. Just gently holding on to the only thing that is keeping him stable in his own mind.

Mydei was more than happy to help.

He probably hasn't had any kind of support all his life from any nightmares. Hopefully, this works. Even if it is just a little bit.

He keeps the grip until they are almost at their destination. Phainon's rest must have gotten better. There were no more pained looks or tight squeezes.

"Phai," a hand is placed on his arm, and gently shakes. " Hey Sleeping Beauty, we are just about there."

THUMP

Phainon opens his eyes slowly, partially staring at the man beside him. The cerulean eyes look so much brighter after his nap.

Mydei felt something in his chest looking at the ocean staring back at him. He could get lost in them. Being this close, all the different shades of blue can be seen.

*Just like a master piece….. wait, what?? I….*Mydei thought looking at his sleepy companion

A big stretch came from the passenger, followed by a yawn, "Shit.. are we almost there??" Sitting his seat back up, Phainon was greeted with the most beautiful countryside. Trees are all out in full bloom. They carry varying

shades of white to oranges and reds. Just swaying in the early summer breeze.

But surrounding them in the distance…

“FUCK!! IS THAT CASTRUM KREMNOS??” He couldn't believe his eyes. It rose above the trees and mountain ranges. The tall towers almost touched the clouds. It had been abandoned for centuries, but the Kremnos family still had all the rights to the land. When his parents eventually pass, Mydei would inherit it. Not just the land, but the ruins as well.

The car drove down a path to the orchard. He parked along the side of the road, pomegranate trees just a short walk from where they were. They got out to see the foliage much better.

“Shit, that almost makes you a prince.”

Mydei got very quiet. Looking off into the distance, Phainon felt he had said something wrong.

“Oh my god!! I'm so sorry. Did I say something wrong?” *Fuck, did I already ruin the trip?* Even though he may have a lot wrong with his mind, he never wants to hurt anyone with his actions or words. And the one person Phainon is getting attached to(much to his dismay), he feels like he's already screwed up so much.

A hand comes over and grabs his arm. He then looks up at the most beautiful amber eyes he'd ever seen. They were sad, but not hurt.

“Phainon, you get in your head way too much. I'm fine. It just hurts a little because I haven't been called that since I was little. You remember the boy who passed? He used to call me that. Because of my family having -*waving his hand towards the distance* - all this, he saw me as a prince. Also, because I was so nice to him, he told me I was just like the princes from his storybooks.”

Ohhhh that… I.. ohhhh. Well, the kid wasn't wrong. Mydei is so a prince.

“If I can be honest. He wasn't wrong.”

THUMP

Mydei tried very hard to hide his blush with his hair. That feeling was creeping back into his heart and mind. Less and less he was understanding how one IT person could make him feel like this.

“I uhmm…. Thanks..” Without another word, he started walking towards the trees. Hoping to hide the red his face was showing.

Waiiiiit….did I embarrass him?? Why does he have to be so beautiful all the time? It's not fair.

Running towards the prince, he caught up. Walking along beside him, something just felt good. Right. Something both men couldn't explain. Like a question that needed answered out loud, but both their hearts knew. The odd twist of fate was pushing them together. Neither man knew how the other felt outright. There were little things each was picking up on, but they were too subtle to count as something more than just friends.

“So, can I ask you something?"

“Depends on what it is.” That sunset hair was beaming again against that smile.

“What did you mean by taking it to the next level?” *Pleaaaasssee don't ask for anything more than this.*

“Ohhh that. Since you have already had my family's wine and juice, why not take you to where it is made? You can try it right from the source.”

“And you grew up here!?”

Reaching up to a hanging bush, Mydei grabbed a fruit that was hanging low enough. He got it into his back pocket, fetching a pocket knife. With chef-like precision, the fruit was splayed open, showing the contents inside.

Phainon couldn't deny he loved watching the master at work.

Damn, what that man can do with his hands. I mean…. I've seen both good...and bad good. Those fingers can do a lot.

"Yes, I did. Both of my parents frequently came out here for meetings. I got dragged along because they didn't want me to be lonely at home. Which.." His eyes just lingered on the fruit, thinking of a lot of things from his past.

"You were lonely even WITH people at home? I'm sorry. We both have had very different childhoods, but I can totally get how you feel."

Pulling a section out of the fruit, picking out the white parts, Phainon sank his teeth into the fruit. All the fresh juices flowed out of each pod. Sweet and bitter at the same time.

Mydei just stood stunned, watching the man before him consume the fruit. It was like watching something dirty, but he couldn't take his eyes off it. That feeling of embarrassment hit him again. Mydei was trying so hard to hide it all. Good thing Phainon's face was too busy to notice.

"Holy shit, these are so good. They don't taste like normal ones. Like, yeah the tang is there, but the sweetness is amazing. No wonder your family makes wine out of it." Looking up at his prince, he noticed Mydei was trying to hold back laughter. "What?? What's wrong??"

Mydei reached into his back pocket, grabbing a rag he took specifically for this. Not realizing that the fruits were worthy of being made love to, apparently. "Your face is an absolute mess. You look like a wild animal." Without prompting, he starts to clean up the mess on Phainon's face.

Phainon's insides froze, feeling the soft hands holding on to his chin.

Ohhhh shit… ohh gawd.. wait.. what color pants did I wear… ????? Ohhh, yeaaa black.. this isn't good. My heart and erection can't take him. Part of me would love to kiss him… I can't.. Why does he have this effect on me?? I just don't get it. Shit, people like me don't deserve love.

“There...all clean. You don't have to eat it like an animal. Some foxes may be offended by you eating dirtier than them.” Leaving the rag in his hand, Mydei walked on, picking pods out and eating them like popcorn.

Almost just like a dog, he cocked his head to the side, watching the nicest ass he'd ever seen walk away. Everything about him, Phainon felt, belonged in a museum, but his own personal one. He didn't want to share.

“Hey, slowpoke, you coming?? Or are you making a mess again?”

Haha, in my pants. I just about did. Dammit.

Running to catch up again, he stopped beside Mydei. They were both overlooking a long way down. Blue eyes followed the valley up, trying to find more land. Then it came into view. They were near the gates of the city. Still shining with all its brightness hundreds of years later. Pieces may be missing, or huge chunks lying on the ground, but a lot of it was still intact.

“God damn. It's…. Just.. I've seen it in history books, but never in my wildest dreams did I figure I'd be standing before it.”

“ What about in it??” His feet began to take him towards the bridge.

“Wait, Wait, Wait!!! We can't just waltz in there.” Catching up beside Mydei, he was getting nervous.

“And why not?” Said with a smug look on his face.

“This is historical land. PLUS, it's falling apart. We don't have permi….”

“Phainon, what is my last name?” While the snow hair stopped in its spot, the sunset continued on, getting to the opening of the bridge.

The caretakers of the castle part of their land knew the heir was going to pay a visit. Everything was in place for him to give a quiet tour with no one around. They were told by the Madam of the family to give him time and not to go back to their duties until he left the premises.

Over the years, due to foot traffic, the bridge was repaired often. Especially for the family it belonged to, the caretakers do an amazing job with the grounds. They maintain the whole ‘old’ look of the place. If something had collapsed, it was taken care of with the utmost pride and safe keeping. If nature and time seeking, it was allowed to take its course, but should it be a danger, the team took care of it right away. Making it less of a threat.

Mydei took his strides with precision. Just knowing how fast and far to step. Waiting until Phainon's brain caught up with him, and then his feet soon followed. The prince was about 40 feet from the start of the bridge before someone finally yelled at him.

‘HEY!! HEY!!! MYDEIMOS!!!” Phainon’s feet were trying to carry him as fast as they could. He was no runner, but all his years of staying in shape helped him get to his prince faster. “Holy shit!! God dang.. why.. you.. I….” Finding his breath was harder than getting fruit in the orchard.

Continuing to walk at a slower pace now that his guest had finally decided to catch up, a smile and laugh adorned his face. In the midday sun, Phainon couldn't help but stare. He knew full well now, it wasn't just desire. Watching the yellows and reds flow in the breeze, his heart skipped so many beats. He knew right then and there, on Mydei's homeland, he was in love. Searching his thoughts more(which always got him in trouble) told him it could never happen between them. The one-sided love and desire were all he had. *I guess just spending time is enough. A partner doesn't seem to be on his agenda. Definitely not for a pervert like me.*

Phainon had to get out of his own head somehow. “So, growing up here, I assume you know more history than what the books say. I wouldn't be surprised if you've been all over this place.”

“I do. I got my love of history from here, from how my culture used to do things. Not that I agree with war, but I know that's how things went back in the day.”

Their walk in the ruins felt like they were there forever, until Mydei stopped. Large chains separated them from the next big structure. Phainon

had to ask, “Uhmmm, not to be an ass, but how are we gonna get over?? They didn't seem to make any alternative paths further in.”

His prince looked at him with the most serious face. “We take the chains, of course.”

Phainon’s whole soul dropped out of his body. “You can't be serious? They look so damn old that even a bird might collapse them.”

The strawberry-blond hair donned a large smirk, starting his way across the chains.

“DUDE!! If something happens to you, they will murder me!”

“Are you scared?” Mydei kept pressing onwards.

“Nooooo….” Internally, he was torn. Yes, he was totally scared. Everything here looked as if it could break with just a breath on it. Phainon's other half wanted to show his prince he was able to stand side by side with him.

Biting his lip, almost drawing blood, he let his feet take him where his heart was afraid. Just about when he was near Mydei, a hand reached back for him. His brain didn't have time to react. Phainon grabbed the hand in front of him, squeezing it tight. Something about it felt so familiar. He wasn't sure why. It was reassuring and calming, just something he needed.

"I'm going to let you in on a secret. My mother used to bring me this far in. I was even walking the chains by myself. I had to learn to steel my mind and not be afraid of the unknown. Yes, things could happen at any time, like things giving out, but you never know until you try.” A squeeze of the hand, he hoped to show Phainon, “It's ok to be afraid. I was when I started, but I always had support. So I'm here for you now.”

“Your mother sounds like an amazing woman.”

“She is, I think she wears the pants more than my father does. She raised me more than both of them. He was always busy.” A small laugh left his

lips. “To be fair, I still like her better. Her big heart, strong mind, sense of justice….. I wanted to grow up to be just like her.”

“I think you have. Everyone looks up to you. The respect given is unreal. I think, from your description, you're just like her. “

“Phainon??”

“Uhmm, yea??”

“We are at the top of the chain.”

He looked back and saw they were. Mydei's storytelling had distracted him enough not to notice they had reached the top. His eyes peered over the ledge to a huge drop-off. “Shit”

“Good job, it only gets easier from here.”

“You're funny. WE have to go back down it.” A slight panic tinged his voice.

“WE are going to be fine. I want to show you the furthest place in here, and then we can go eat.”

Dude. I am so glad I took my meds this morning, or I'd be a total wreck right now. I'm so all over the place. Why does this have to be so high? Work doesn't count. It's closed in. This… yea we could die.. I'm ok..

Mydei squeezed his hand a little tighter, bringing his thoughts back to the man before him. Phainon took some deep breaths, shaking his head yes, so that they could continue on. Being inside the building made him feel a little better, that is, until they came to another door that led outside.

Stepping out onto the old stone, both could feel the powerful history below their feet. Just how many people traveled this path in the past? To battle, to worship, and maybe to marry. So many things could be felt in the air.

“Come, we are almost there.”

Traveling down the steps led to another bridge. Phainon was starting to not like bridges anymore. They all looked like erosion would set in any second, and they would never be seen again.

This is hella better than those chains. God damn.. I felt my soul leave my body.

While in his head again, he never knew Mydei had stopped walking. Phainon ran right into him. For a split second, he could feel all the muscles beneath the clothes. Taking a step back, before he could speak, imaginations ran wild. Picturing his prince in full armor, one worthy enough for royalty. Cutting down those before him, always coming out the victor.

Yeah, he is definitely from here.

“Shit, I’m so sorry. I wasn't watching where I was going. Here I really should.”

A soft laugh could be heard. “No, you're fine. I got lost in thought, too. When I was here a long time ago, I never got to experience things by myself. I always had to have someone with me. I couldn't ‘Explore’, but with you I can. I have time. “

“Hey, I'm the one having hissy fits. You have no fear here. I'm glad I could visit and see this with you. I bet when they do tours here, it never goes this far.”

Standing in a large circle with a gap between the ‘stage’ and the seating, the large scale of it all really came into perspective. Festivals and combat challenges could be seen. Parts on the metal flooring show signs of strong slashes on them.

“There is a fairy tale about this place. Do you know it?”

“No, I'm not sure I do. Wanna have story time?”

Sitting down on a large boulder at the side of the area, Mydei motions for Phainon to come sit beside him. They have a long sit, Phainon hearing the

story of how a floating sword used to hang above the area and pass judgment on things. Always a symbol of the people. Ever there for their protection. No remains of a sword have ever been found, so most chalk it up to a fairy tale. Nothing more. They still use the imagery to show the might of the land, though.

With half the day away, both men were hungry. Making their way back to the car, Phainon was a bit more proud of himself for not needing help. Still wary, but made it.

“Hey”

Looking up into the beautiful amber eyes. “Yes’sum?”

“Are you doing ok? Like the car ride here, the walking…. The drop-offs.”

“Ohhh that… uhmmm, yeah I’m doing ok. Just hungry right now.”

“Well, how about we get lunch, go to the local museum, and then to the winery for dinner? The hotel knows we are coming. I texted the manager earlier. He just said, ‘Get here when you do.’ We don't need to worry about in or out time.”

“That sounds…. Wonderful. I don't know how it can repay you for this experience. This is all truly magnificent.” Phainon was almost at a loss for words. Trying to turn his brain off was a bit of a challenge. He managed, though.

“You're being my friend and giving me a chance to share it, is repayment enough.”

It was Phainon's turn to don the red face. Being that his hair was white, it couldn't be easily hidden. Hurrying up to get in the car. He was hoping that not being in the sun wouldn't show his embarrassment.

Cute. Is all Mydei could think of.

He felt that adorable was the only way to describe a lot of Phainon’s actions. Maybe this time around, he could have a friend. Maybe the fates

would be nice to him this go around.

~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

Well, he took the leap. Going on this trip is going to be quite an experience for them both. Besides Mydei sharing things from his child hood and family land, there are definitely budding feelings happening. How will the rest of their weekend fair, being alone together?

thank you so much for reading and support.<3

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.
~~~~~~~

Chapter 9

Chapter Summary

> After nearly(NOT) dieing in the ruins, the check in for the hotel was needed. After a quick stop there, food was needed. After some deliberation, seafood was chosen. And it just so happens that Mydei knows another old man that runs a restaurant who would love to see them.
>
> This 'date' is going well.

Chapter Notes

> No true beta read. Hopefully you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Back on the main road, it was a short way down to the hotel they were staying at. The building was as large and grandiose as the ruins they were just in. The building was so expansive and large that it housed almost anything you could want from a tourist destination. Multiple floors, entertainment, hot springs, regular dining/buffets, and shopping for souvenirs or items you have forgotten.

Being in the Kremnos region, hot springs and lava flows were abundant. The hotel utilized them when building the place. Using the lava flows was a clean heat source. Adding many public and private onsens was a pull to the area. The health benefits draw in a lot of people. Making it ‘Must Do’ while here.

Pulling up to the entrance, the car parked off to the side. Making sure it was over far enough not to block any traffic. Phainon was taking note of all the cars parked here. Many fancy ones, of course. There were also regular ones. He watched a fairly normal family get out of a van, gather their things, and head to the hotel.

Wow! For as big and fancy as this place looks, I didn't figure it was affordable. Only people with money came here. I was totally wrong. Then again, look at their prince. Nothing like what people would expect in private. I guess I am really lucky to see it.

Something Phainon did take note of is when they pulled in, the doorman was on his ear-com. He assumed it was about them. Not too soon after, another hotel employee came out with a lady in very fine attire.

“Wait here.”

What else was he to do? The car was still running, and he was in the passenger seat. All Phainon could do was watch the exchange. There was a lot of bowing on the hotel's side, but also from Mydei. A form of reverence and appreciation. From all the clues given, he assumed she was a manager. They have to have many for as big an establishment as this is. The trunk was popped, and bags were given to the staff. After another bow and handshake, Mydei got back in the car.

“Things go well?”

“Yes. That was one of the managers of the hotel. They were very happy to have our company. We could have stayed at the bed and breakfast near the winery. I like this place a little more.”

Pulling out from the entrance, they made their way back on the road leading into town. It had become a lot busier than the last time Mydei had visited. More stores have been opened. Newer tourist spots as well. The small town he knew as a boy was so much more lively now.

“So, since the last time we ate, I got to pick the food. How about you do it this time?”

“ME?! Are you sure?? I've never been here. So I don't know what's good or what would be ok to eat and then go to a museum.” His finger pointed at his stunned face.

“Yes, you. No one else is in the car but us. So come on. What is something you like to eat?”

Doing some thinking, he was reminded of home. The good seafood he hadn't had in a long time, not since he left home.”Uhmmm, how about seafood?”

“Good choice. I know exactly where to go.”

They finally reached downtown, and Phainon was just falling in love with the place. The architecture was amazing. It was so old-world, and many took that old, making it semi-modern. Part of him wanted to skip the food and go right to the museum,but he was having a hard time keeping the grumbles of his stomach quiet.

They pulled into a parking space. Mydei leaned way too much into his own space. Breath could be felt on his skin. Phainon was trying to keep himself calm. The sexy voice of his driver was right in his ear. All coming out as a whisper. “If you wanted to eat, I could have brought more fruit for us, silly puppy.”

No more words were said, the sunset exited the car. A slight laugh could be heard on the wind. He was just left in the passenger seat with way too many feelings. This was the second time today Phainon was glad he wore black pants. *Gawd shit! What that man's voice does to me. Did he HAVE to whisper?? Fuck..*

Composing himself finally, he exited the car to stand at its front beside Mydei.

<u>Dorado Petaloúda</u>

“Is that in the local dialect?

“Yea. Dorado is a type of fish that is caught here. It's very prevalent. No matter how much fishing they do, fish are always there. Petaloúda is for butterfly. More about how the fish is prepared, not the insect. The restaurant is called that because the owner got their start on that dish. It was very

popular.” Mydei explained happily. It made him feel things, being able to explain stuff about his home to someone who was finding a spot in the CEO's heart.

“Damn, you sure do know a lot about here.”

Lightly punching him in the arm, “I'd hope so. Didn't you ask if I grew up here? Even though I did spend too much time in the mansion, I did get to be here quite a bit, too.”

Mydei grabbed his hand for the second time today, sending all kinds of not-organ-shaped hearts through his system. Holding onto it, Phainon let himself be led to the restaurant.

Once at the door, Mydei let go and was talking to the staff at the door. He could tell they recognized the prince, making one of them run to the back. Not even a minute later, an older man from the back came out; he looked very elated to see the company. Came over to Mydei, giving him a big hug. Having a very quick chat in the language of the area.

“And who is this fine strapping young man?” The owner was talking about him, and Phainon's embarrassment level went through the roof.

“Cosmo, this is Phainon. He works for me as the head of security. A good friend of mine.”

Phainon THOUGHT he was going to shake the owner's hand. Nope, he was dead wrong. He got pulled into a big hug as well. He had never been in a place where the people were so personable, cheery even.

“Well, good. The young master needs some friends. He works to damn hard. He needs someone just to be normal with. You keep that up, lad.” Patting Phainon on the shoulder.

“Uh. It is an honor to meet you, sir, and I'll try.” *Sir, you have no idea how much I would love it to be more than friends.*

“Come this way, I'll get you guys a good table. Really good view of the water.” Cosmo was more than delighted to have the two boys as company. He was going to make sure this visit was extra special.

Phainon was trying his best not to be super embarrassed. It wasn't often that he ate at a place, always trying to keep social interactions to a minimum. He couldn't understand how Mydei knew so many ‘happy’ old men. *At least Zeno was a polite hi, not trying to make me part of some family. That hand is strong, too. I wonder if he still fishes.*

They followed the older man through a lot of tables. For a Saturday at lunch time, it was a pretty full diner. The path led outside to a sitting area overlooking the water. They were the only ones out here. Boats could be seen in the distance, fishing and floating around for leisure. The town may be small, but it was full of life. It felt lived in. Seeing all this around him, Phainon was getting a good sense of how Mydei grew up into the man he is now.

“So whatever you boys want, I will make for you personally. I haven't seen Deimos in some time, so I would be more than honored to make you anything.” The smile was beaming across his face. Cosmo was more than ready to hop into the kitchen and get cooking.

“I mean, I'd love to try the dish this place is named after. It sounds amazing.“ Phainon was so hungry, he'd eat almost anything.

“It is. I used to eat here a lot when I was young. How about making that two? And maybe 2 pomegranate creams?” Mydei felt right at home here. Part of him wished he could move back, but being close to the restaurants in case of an emergency was more of a priority.

The owner left the two men to go make them an amazing dish. You could see a spring in his step. He was more delighted to have them as company.

“Is he always that cheery?” Phainon questioned, laughing.

“Well, you know, I don't know. I haven't seen him for a few years. I do know he really likes me, though. So this probably made him extra happy.”

One of the staff brought them their drinks. Both were larger-sized cups with a creamy pink color beneath a large dollop of whipped cream.

Taking a sip, tons of flavor hit Phainon’s palate. His eyes grew wider. Part of him wants to drink the whole thing right there. He felt like a little kid again.

They talked about the area until Cosmo returned with 2 plates of the Dorado Petaloúda, lightly crusted with panko and served with homemade pitta and sauce. They started into their dishes. Mydei was more than happy to share his favorite childhood things with someone who was elated to be shown them.

“What do you think?”

Trying to look a bit more dignified, he put the fork down. “Holy shit. This is just amazing, and that word isn't even good enough. This has to be the best fish I've had in my life. Nothing back home even compares to this. It's so soft and tender. The flavor?? Shit, it's so good.” He kept praising the food for another five minutes. Mydei was more than happy to hear all the wonderful praise. Phainon’s excitement was infectious.

They finished their meal, ordering dessert after.

“I do hope you don't get tired of pomegranate-flavored things. It's kinda what this region is known for.”

“No, no, you're good. It's interesting to see what people can do with it. It can't be easy with such a tangy fruit.” Before he was just about done with his drink, a large bowl of pomegranate Gelato was brought out for them to share.

A very vibrant pink color, speckled with some of the seeds. They both enjoyed it immensely. Phainon left no flavors uneaten. He was in love with the food.

“Wait here, I’m gonna go pay for it.”

He disappeared inside. Phainon was full and happy. He was basking in the flavors still floating around in his mind. Making a note of where this was to definitely come back again.

“I take it everything was good?” The older man in glasses asked.

“More than. Did you catch that this morning?” Mydei fished out his wallet.

“Yes, I did. Those were the two biggest I caught. Something told me to save them, and I can see why. So, young master, can I ask, is he someone special?” Making a face like he's implying things.

“I thank you for saving them. And….” His ears were becoming a bit pink, the same as the gelato, from the question. “...uhmm no. Just a friend.”

“Awww, that's a pity. You two look good together. Well, enjoy the rest of your trip, and you need to come visit more often.” Cosmo knows what he said and meant it.

A cough was had to hide his embarrassment, but all in truth, he was developing feelings. Mydei just didn't want to act on them. Afraid of what would change, not sure where they really stood, since both had issues with relationships.

Mydei placed a very large bill in the older man's hand. Way out doing the price of their meal. “Please, keep it all. Give the staff a good tip from it.”

“You are so much your mother's son. She used to do the same thing. It was just like this. Just two of you. You have grown up into a fine man, sir.”

“I'll have to tell her you said hi. Also, from how Phainon was talking, you may also have a lifelong customer in him, too. He grew up in a place with seafood, and he could not stop raving about this meal. I do thank you for everything.” He walked back to get his companion so they could get on with the next part of their trip.

On the way out, Phainon had to stop and shake Cosmo's hand, telling him himself how good everything was. The old man was more than delighted to

hear all the praise.

“Bye, you two. Please, come back again. Have fun and a very safe trip home.”

Both men got in the car, starting to pull away from the restaurant. Old eyes watched them leave. *Yupp, totally, they should get together. Good luck, highness.*

~~~~~~

“Ohhhhh my god!!!!” Phainon leaned his seat back.

“You good?” Mydei asked, turning at the stoplight, the destination was just across town. It lies close to where the ruins can be seen.

“My god!! MORE THAN!!! That was so incredible. I guess going to culinary school, you know where to find the best food in town.” All the fish and fruit flavors were dancing around in his senses.

“Noo, it was before that. Remember Zeno and Xerxes? I've been around them since I was a child. And I've seen Cosmo just about every time we would come here. I always asked mom to stop, even if it was just for a soda and pita.” Stopping back here really did make Mydei's heart long to return permanently.

“Well, I can see why you love food so much. Those guys are amazing. They do some awe-inspiring work.” Phainon swears he could crash into a food coma with so many good things he's had today.

Before he knew it, they were parked outside a building that looked ripped out of time itself. It had used some of the old architecture for the front and then built the rest of the museum on the back, but keeping in tone with the aesthetics.

They walked inside, while Mydei greeted the people at the door, Phainon was looking around in wonder. Even the entrance had stuff dating back a few thousand years. A tap on Phainon's shoulder told him that they could go
~~~~~~

in. Stepping out into the rest of the building was just a sight to behold. Phainon's eyes couldn't be wide enough for everything. Sites were assaulting his vision from all sides; he didn't know where to start.

“Does every place here know you? See, I told you you're a prince.“ Giggling to himself, he wandered a bit forward, looking at the representation of the smelting machines they used for their weapons.

“Well, this is my family's land, and a good chunk of the stuff in here was donated over a long period of time. It had all been done by archaeologists hired by the family. Most things were even before my grandfather's time. They have been at it for quite a while.” The whole building felt like stepping through time. Mydei was proud of his heritage.

Amber eyes just watched his guest. Phainon walked around the place with childlike wonder. Asking every and any questions about the item or its history. If Mydei couldn't answer it for him, one of the guides was more than happy to come in and explain anything Phainon had questions about.

Otherwise, they were left alone in the exhibits.

They came to a back section dealing with the war aspect of the culture. So many items belonging to the infantry. Something caught his eye.

There was a display of all the heads of the Kremons family. Listing any information that could be found. Some were full of detailed information, others just a line or two because of how old and sparse the information was.

Phainon’s breath caught. *Holy shit… these weapons… They are exactly like the ones in his room. That's so crazy. There was an old spear and shield that looked exactly like his. I wonder if it's a family thing why he has them??*

A hand grabbed his shoulder, bringing him out of his thoughts. Secrets he carried that have more context to them now. “Are you ok?”

“Yea, I'm good. Just amazed by all your family history. It's incredible. Thank you for sharing all this with me.”

That smile came back across his face. Phainon’s insides were giddy to see more of it. “No, I should be the one thanking you. For one, I was kind of afraid you were going to turn me down, but if you did, I was just going to have to be ok with it.”

“Yeaaa…. I just…” A hand grabbed his arm, squeezing a little.

“You don't have to explain anything. I just appreciate that you trusted me this much to bring you here and show you a world not many see. I'm forever grateful." Mydei glanced down at his watch. They had actually been there a long time. Getting lost in history will do that to any one.

“Well, it's almost 6. We left Cosmo's at 1. Do you feel like having dinner now? Or would you like to explore more?” Mydei also couldn't believe how much time had passed.

“Wait, it's almost 6?!? Where did the time go?? Didn't we just get here?” Phainon was shocked that they had been here that long.

“I’m afraid not. We have been here for almost 5 hours. I figured that was going to happen. Considering, I get the feeling you love learning, and it was on full display." A small laugh could be heard from him. Mydei was happier than he's been in a long time. He's never been around one person who got him to laugh and smile so much. His insides had feelings that were new and weird. Maybe he would digest them over more food.

“Yea, I do. Well, I can't look at EVERYTHING right now. Then I won't have anything to look at next time we come. So, yea, let's go eat.” Phainon turns to walk back the way they came. Mydei was behind but at a slower pace. Words struck him hard.

Wait, did I hear right? Did he say ‘WE’?? Like he would do this again?? I have to be dreaming. I really never imagined this trip to go this well. Maybe I really have gained a friend finally.. ppfft at 30.. gawd. I just hope it's not too much.

A warm hand came down, lifting his chin up. That bright smile looked amazing against the snow white hair. “Hey, who's too much in their head

now? Are you good?”

“Yea, sorry, just had a moment. You've just been waiting to throw that back at me, weren't you?” Mydei was really starting to get attached to those lovely cerulean eyes.

Doing the classic sticking out of the tongue and winking, Phainon was laughing all the way, "Guilty as charged, my prince. However, shall I be punished?”

“I'm gonna take you to the winery and make you eat good food and wine.” The oh so scary threat was made.

Walking right alongside him, they both were laughing. “Ohh no! What shall I do?? Enjoy it?? Wooee is me.”

Once back at the entrance, Phainon thanked the staff for all their help and letting them explore at their own pace. He told them he was definitely coming back again, so he could see even more stuff. Phainon also got some souvenirs to bring home.

Once back in the car, they were all still smiling and laughing. Neither man has felt like that in a long time. If ever. With their work being so demanding and their personal lives being nonexistent, days like these were ones to treasure.

The road to the winery was back on the original one they were driving on near the orchard. When they got close enough, one could make out the brewing and bottling facility, the restaurant/tasting part, and the bed and breakfast.

“Like, ok, I see why now. The hotel has more rooms and more to offer. Plus, I bet the view is better there, too.”

“Quite. Like I said, not that this place is bad. I've been here before on my own, but the hotel feels more personable. This is more for the ritzy tourist. The food is great, though. Plus, getting to try the wines firsthand is always fun and gives you a better perspective on taste.”

It was odd for a Saturday night at the winery to be this busy; they parked a bit away from the building. Both were fine with a walk. It would help with digestion later.

A private room was booked for them on Friday. An exact time wasn't given but probably around dinner time. Their timing wasn't too far off. Before they could go eat, Phainon had to have a proper lesson in wine tasting. He was told that it was his choice of what they would have.

All the processes made sense, and within a half hour, a wine was chosen for the meal. After ordering their food, Phainon got lost in telling Mydei all the wonderful things he experienced.

It's just like he is a little kid coming home from a field trip. Has to tell me everything with such enthusiasm. God, it's infectious. He's….. he's….he's infectious. Those feelings were creeping back again in the back of Mydei's mind.

That smile was back again, not just for the storytelling, but for the storyteller.

Because of the music and atmosphere, neither man noticed that the weather had changed partway through the meal. It was coming down hard enough to get one drenched.

This time around, they both chose different desserts. Delicate and light, considering the heavy meat and vegetable meal they had just consumed.

On the way in, Mydei took care of the bill. Same as before, what he left was more than the cost of the meal. Tips that could be split for the whole house. Not just the front.

When done, they both thanked the staff for their time and food. Once at the entrance, both men stopped.

"Shit, when did it start raining??" They both almost said in unison. Looking out the window, Phainon couldn't tell how much was coming down.

A voice came from behind them. The hostess at the podium informed them it had started about forty-five minutes ago. Neither had any clue, being so lost in the good time they were having, that Mother Nature had other plans.

Fishing the keys out of his pocket, he taped Phainon on the shoulder. “Stay here, I'll go get the car and bring it over.”

“Hey!! Come on, I don't mind getting wet.” *Haha, as of late, that is a lot.*

“No, I won't hear of it. You're my guest. It's my job to take care of you.” Before any interjection could be had, Mydei was already out the door. Sprinting to the car, getting completely soaked.

The car was brought around, and he even got out with an umbrella to help his guest into the car. Not once caring if he looked like a drowned cat.

Escorting his guest was a priority. Phainon even made an 'Ohh you’ face at him, but didn't complain. He figured it was a losing battle. Which it would have been.

Once the passenger was in the car, not wet, he could go around to his side to get in.

Trying to ring his hair out before getting back in really didn't do him any favors. Giving up, all of the hair that clung to him was put up in a bun. Every bit of his clothes was sticking to his frame. A certain pair of cerulean eyes couldn't stop looking.

God damn, he looks gorgeous wet. Why does he look so good with and without clothes? How does he do it? I wish I didn't have better control right now. I'd love for him to pull off in the orchard and make love to him in that seat. -internally sighing- Just…fuck..

Mydei tried to stay as still as possible, driving back to the hotel. Besides getting the car wet, he knew his body was cold and reacting to it. Everything was frigid. Too much blood was flowing to try and warm him up and to the wrong places. He didn't want to be rude in front of his guest. Not that for a split second it didn't cross his mind.

“Are you good?? You look like a wet cat.” Phainon teased. His clothes were barely wet, except for the bottom of his pants.

“I feel like one. I know how it can fix that.” A smile crossed the wet cat's face.

Phainon’s mind was starting to overreact. Not that in his wildest fantasies he didn't engage in such pleasures. He couldn't do it for real. Also, he basically went out for his first date with the hottest single man in town. He had a ton of food, visited many places, and had a bit of alcohol in his system… anyone could take it as a date that was going to go places.

Mydei taped a few things on the screen, making the phone appear. The number was dialed for the hotel.

¤¤¤¤¤

***Hotel**:*

Yes, Master Kremnos. How can we be of service?

***Mydei**:*

Hey, I was wondering if there

were any private onsens available?

We kinda got caught in the rain coming down.

If not, that's ok, figured I’d ask.

***Hotel**:*

Let me take a quick check.

keys clicking

There is, but it is partially outdoors.

Has a garden and waterfall with it.

Would that be of interest?

***Mydei**:*

smiles to himself

Yes, that will be fine.

Is there a time limit for it?

***Hotel**:*

No, sir.

As you are one of our biggest patrons,

it is the least we could do.

I will make sure robes are supplied to both of your rooms by the time you get here.

If there is anything else you may require,

please don't hesitate to ask.

Mydei:

Thank you, I appreciate it a lot.

We will be there in about 10 minutes.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

“I guess if you stay often enough, they would do things like that.” Going on this trip has opened Phainon's eyes to a lot of things. The privilege you get from being in an upper-class family, but also the separation it causes. He

can see why Mydei has a very hard time making honest friends. Especially ones who don't want something from you.

I think this is different. He WANTS to show and share these things with me. Why me? I still don't know. It's crazy, too, how much everyone loves him. He has such a big heart for everyone. Like, and it isn't just the family name. Mydei did all this on his own. I can see why not learning about your friend passing till years later would make you want to shy away from people. Who's really gonna be honest with you?

By the time the hotel came into full view, the rain was lightening up. Much more scattered, indicating the storm was just about done passing through the area. Not that the area didn't look beautiful, covered in rain, but it was getting late for the two of them. Plus, Phainon had no clue as to when Mydei was up that morning.

The one benefit that Mydei did use was the garage VIP parking. It was covered so they didn't have to worry about getting wetter than needed. Well, more so in clothes. Exiting the garage, there was also a service desk there, and an attendant waiting for them. She handed him the keys and a towel to try and dry off on. Indicated to them that their room was on the 10th floor. Both luxury suites with balconies overlooking the area. Robes and extra towels were supplied for the onsen. Even though it was private, they still would prefer if sensitive areas were covered.

“The information I got said that the onsen is on the 6th floor. Ours will be in room 9.” He muffled, telling Phainon the information using the towel to get some of the water out of his hair.

Hahaha, time to be very mature… 6th floor room 9… hahaha nice. Yeaaa, I've dreamt about that too. Phainon knew he was a pervert.

They both step onto the elevator, pressing the button for the 10th floor. Being on an outside wall, nature could be seen all around them. It looked really beautiful at night with some of the street lamps catching the light rain just right against a lot of the flowers. Off in the distance, something caught Phainon’s eye.

“Hey, question, what is that over there?” Poking his finger against the glass.

Placing the towel around his shoulders, walking over beside him. Mydei could feel a warmth coming off the man beside him and didn't know if he was imagining it all day or not. And it looks like he wasn't. “That glow out there? Ohh, that's the lava flows I told you about. There are still a few active ones that come near the surface out by the ruins. Most are all underground now, used for heating and the onsens here.”

“WAIT?! We could have extra died at the ruins!?!?” Part of his anxiety was spiking. The time was coming soon for his evening medication. Phainon didn't like taking it, but because of being in the hospital so young, it affected a lot of things.

“No. We weren't even close to where those flow from. I just took you to where I always went. I told you before. I wouldn't let anything happen to you.” Mydei was staring right in his eyes as he spoke. The worry was written all over Phainon's face. He was hoping that he could provide some sort of relief for his guest.

《DING》

The bell to the 10th floor rang, breaking the spell that had come over the two of them. That smile came back, hitting Phainon right in the heart. That was one thing he'd never tire of. Mydei squeezed his arm, exiting the elevator.

Sexy wet kitty. Hot damn! How those jeans hug now…. Wait, wait…. Onsen….hot spring… she said towels… ohh god, oh no. I'm gonna have to get in first. There is no way I could go second and not stare and not already be turned on. Plus all my scars..

Following behind him, Phainon noticed there were twenty rooms on the top floor. Ten on each side. Not a lot of the overhead door lights were lit, denoting occupants. There was a flashing light above seven and eight. The only other dimmed light was down at the end of the hall at twenty. The whole floor was almost all theirs. Being on the beginning set of numbers, their rooms were on the front of the building overlooking the valley.

“Here is your key. You are in room seven. I'm in eight. All our luggage is here and items to go to the onsen. Just ring my phone when you are ready to go down.” Mydei smiled to himself, scanning the keycard.

Phainon just stood in the hallway, watching the door close. This was an experience he'd never forget.

~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

Oh, their first date is going swimmingly. All except for the fact that now they have to get practically naked around the other. How will either heart take it?

Thank you so much for reading. <3

Strawpage is there if you'd like to ask anything, say hi, or doodle ❤

AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.
~~~~~~~

Chapter 10

Chapter Summary

> It is now time for the ultimate test Phainon has ever put himself through: being around your crush almost naked. He knows the time frame is short for the water being around Mydei. Hopefully he's gonna be ok?
>
> Mydei on the other hand is not wresting with his growing fondness for his IT manager. Who better to discuss matters of the heart with, than your mother. Gorgo is just the best mom ever.(Even if her and Cass are in cahoots together)

Chapter Notes

> No true beta read. Hopefully you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The first thing Phainon did, getting into the room, was taking his medicine. Worrying about a lot of things was making his blood pressure go up. He couldn't afford to let it ruin this whole trip. He felt bad after bailing last time. Making up for it was a priority.

Sitting on the bed with water and pills in hand, he got himself distracted with all the pictures he'd taken since they got here. For once in his life is a mountain of good memories. Phainon knows his parents would be so proud of him for trying. It was tough, and his attraction to the prince wasn't helping matters.

No amount of IT work, building of security systems, or handling clients could compare to the trial he was about to face. His tech knowledge could save him in a lot of situations, but not with this. Dealing with being social, that was a whole section in a book he's never read. Even more so of how you act around someone you've been lusting after for years and now get to

watch them do personal things that are very sensual. Not to be seen by anyone but you do it anyway.

Looking at the time, he didn't want to leave Mydei waiting. Taking the pills, he started stripping down. Getting down to his underwear, he sat on the bed beside the items laid out by the staff. He'd never been to an onsen before, but had heard his coworkers talking about it a few years back. He knew the etiquette.

The robe was neatly laid on his bed with towels for their trip. Running his fingers along the fabric, it was thicker, but soft. Oddly, it was a nice shade of dark blue fading into an ombre white with gold trim. Matched a lot of his aesthetics. The only thing he was really required to wear down was his boxers. The dark purple pair with gold trim was one of his favorites.

“I got this. I CAN do this. I need to try for mom and dad. I can hide in the digital world. The real world is a totally different thing. Mydei is a totally different thing.” Closing his eyes, steadying his breathing, he tried to clear his thoughts. It wasn't every day that you were practically naked, except for a towel, around your boss. Who just so happens to be, and probably hotter, than the springs they were going into.

Stealing himself, he knew it was now or never. Phainon grabbed the robe and put it on. Once the linen was finally on him, he had to stop completely. The insides were so soft. Everything that touched his skin was like magic. If it wasn't bad etiquette or stealing, he would take this home. The softness enveloping his skin was enough to sleep in.

“OK, I'm good. Got changed. Got my slippers. Got my towels. Took my meds. Now just to ring him.” Picking up his phone, the home screen made his heart go places. One of the candid shots he got was the prince walking through the blossoms in the orchard. The wind had picked up just slightly to catch the sunset with it. Luckily for him, he was already taking pictures. This one was absolutely beautiful.

Pressing the call button, he murmured to himself, “Thank the gods for privacy screens.” He let it ring twice, then hung up. It was time.

Picking up the required towels and room key, he made sure all was good before exiting the room. The key slipped into his pocket. He tried to look like he wasn't ‘waiting’ to catch a glimpse of the prince as he emerged, but he was.

About a minute later, he heard noise on the other side of the door. The handle turned. It was just like how he knew was going to happen. His prince did look amazing. The loose, messy bun hanging above his exposed neck was doing things for him. The robe that Mydei wore matched his, but was black and red. Anyone looking at the two of them would think they complement each other perfectly.

Really?? Really?? I'm getting excited over just that!?! I've seen him naked for fucks sake. Why is he someone alluring WITH clothes on?? I mean, hell, I am in love with those ripped jeans he wears. God! What does this man do to me?!

“Are you good? Health ok to go in? They actually do have trained nurses on staff if anything happens. They took it as a precaution, since having so many ‘hot’ experiences happen here.” Pulling the door shut, both made their way back to the elevator. Neither man said much. Just enjoying the quiet company.

Back in the elevator, Phainon watched the world outside. The rain was barely a trickle at this point, and the blanket of nightfall was upon them. Most of the clouds that had come in for the storm had left as well. Leaving the moon and stars to shine brightly in the sky. He figured the more distracted he was, the better.

《DING 》

6TH FLOOR

He was so lost in thought that the sound didn't occur to him. It wasn't until Mydei grabbed his arm lightly that he came back to. “Hey, we can enjoy the stars from the bath. Come on.”

Taking a big deep breath, telling himself he CAN do it, he walked side by side with the prince. To him, this was different. They were headed to a place where clothes are very minimal or nonexistent. Phainon was biting the inside of his cheek to try to keep calm. The horrors of his past always follow him. Always afraid of them getting exposed.

Mydei scanned his key card, unlocking the door for them.

The inner area was all sectioned out for a possible party.

“Wow, this place is so big.” Phainon's never seen a bathroom/changing area so big in his life.

“Wait till we get outside. I have been to others like this; they do an amazing job with atmosphere. If you'd like, you can take your time getting ready. Using any of the changing areas is yours to pick from.” Phainon was more than thankful that he was given that privacy. Besides his own hangups, Mydei was still his boss. That aspect still made him feel a little weird.

“So, let me make sure I got this right. Wash off completely, and then the smaller towel gets wrapped around the waist to go in?” He wanted to hurry up and get in before Mydei was ready. The sooner the better.

“Yes, that's correct. There is also a cooler provided with drinks to stay hydrated. They only recommend staying in for as long as 30 minutes. If you start having medical issues, then please get out.” Phainon gave a smile and a salute, hurrying off into the one area.

Mydei just stood there thinking. The reality of what was going to happen is finally hitting him. They both were going to be practically naked in the same area. That unknown feeling was creeping back into his mind. Not that it felt bad. Just something he's never experienced before.

Going back to his own area, walking past a long mirror, he sees the smile that was on his face. There was nothing else more now it could be than the white-haired man a few cubicles down. They were both in their own private room; it was all enclosed. Total privacy. Which was a great thing because….

《Ring》

The pocket making a sound brought his mind back with everything else. The robe was already hung up, and he had to try to find which pocket it was in.

Sitting down on the bench, Mydei was finally able to see the screen. It was his mother. The person he needed right now for his feelings.

¤¤¤¤¤¤

Gorgo:

Evening dear.

How are things going?

Mydei:

Hi, mother.

I wasn't expecting you to call.

Things are going well.

We are at the hotel now.

Gorgo:

That's wonderful to hear.

You said ‘we’.

Did Mr. Khaslana go with you after all?

Mydei:

To my honest surprise, yes.

He's had a few not-so-good moments.

Gorgo:

Ohh no. Is he alright?

Is there anything you guys need?

I can send help?

Mydei:

smiling and laughing

Always the mother.

Well, I think he had some sort of

nightmare on the car ride this morning.

Oddly, just grabbing his hand helped.

Nothing was bad till we got to the ruins.

Gorgo:

Did you take him over the chains to the arena?

Mydei:

I did. His anxiety hit really hard.

I told him the story of when

I came here as a child,

and I held his hand going across.

He completely forgot about the height

till I told him we were at the top.

Gorgo:

It isn't easy for most to do.

I'm proud of you both.

You, for helping, and him for going up and down.

Kremnos’ ruins are not for the weak of heart.

Especially that far in.

Mydei:

Speaking of him,

I need to tell him to go ahead of me.

__typing can be heard against the screen__

Gorgo:

I take it you are at one of the hotel springs.

It is one of the best experiences there.

I know it's been a while since we were there.

Mydei:

Yes, all good.

Mother…

……

……

Can we talk?

Gorgo:

Of course, my son.

Is there something ailing you?

You know I'm always here for you.

Mydei:

I've just been having these

weird thoughts lately.

(She silently waited on the other end. Sitting down at her personal study desk. This was a matter of utmost importance. Her son hardly ever had issues, but when he did, they were very poignant in matters of the heart.)

So, you know how I had

him do my security setup?

Well, that morning,

I was trying to see

if I could make a friend

by calling him his first name.

We had a long talk, and I broke down.

……

……

……

He hugged me.

(Her eyes went wide with shock. It isn't every day her son lets anyone in that close. But to show full-on emotions AND let them physically console him. She could feel that this boy was special.)

I thought we were ok.

We even went out to Zeno's to eat.

Even convinced him to stay the night

…..but something felt off.

Went to check, and he was gone.

Left a note saying it was because he forgot medicine.

He apologized.

It still hurts.

……

……

A lot.

Felt like I did too much,

and he bailed on me.

I did buy him dinner Wednesday night.

Kyros told me he stopped after work.

Then I got called.

He wanted to know if it was me.

I played the fool till

it was time to hang up.

It was funny.

(Gorgo couldn't believe what she was hearing. *Oh my, I think this goes beyond friendship. Maybe… mother's intuition. Maybe.* She continued to make affirming sounds along the story. Just letting her son talk.)

Mydei:

So Monday rolled around, and I had a lot of meetings.

Didn't see much of him.

I made pastries for him and Cass.

Apparently, he had a cute hissy fit over it.

According to Cass.

Gorgo:

Hahaha, that sounds like my girl.

She's always been like that.

But please go on.

Mydei:

Mother, she doesn't need any encouragement.

Any way

So I suggested this trip.

I didn't think he would say yes because of what happened.

He said he'd let me know

…

but

….

(She heard some sadness in his voice. She can fully tell how much her son cares about this one person. Doing so much with all of his heart.)

I left the last meeting and saw his car nearby.

…..

……

At the local graveyard.

He went to see his parents.

I didn't realize they were in town.

When he left, I also stopped by to offer my condolences. And

……

……

That I would try to take care of him.

Gorgo:

You are so definitely my son.

Always wanting to look after those around you.

Keep going, I assume there is more?

Mydei:

So, back to now.

I helped him through the nightmare on the car ride.

Got to the orchard, had some fruit.

Then the stuff at the ruins.

Ate at Cosmo's.

He now has a lifelong new customer.

The museum. Then the winery for dinner.

Got caught in the rain coming back, and now we are here.

Gorgo:

It seems like you two have had a wonderful time.

So what is the issue?

What plagues your heart, my son?

Mydei:

Him. He's just different than most people I've met.

And…. It seems like he has had a very hard childhood.

I…. I want to be there for him.

Something about him keeps running around in my thoughts,

and I don't know why.

Mother, he gets me to smile. A lot.

The big issue is that, from talking to Cass, he doesn't socialize.

Not even with his own coworkers.

I don't know why he agreed to this.

….

…..

…..

I don't think he does either.

Gorgo:

Well, my son, from what I gather,

it may not be just friendship that you seek from him.

Possibly something deeper.

A stronger connection between you two.

(Mydei gets very silent on his end. Taking his mother's words in. Letting it stir inside. A smile wants to dawn on his face, but it got tucked away very quickly.)

Mydei:

I think I understand what you are getting at,

but I don't think that's possible.

I don't think either of us is suited for that.

We both have many personal hangups about ourselves and others.

Gorgo:

Well, if that's the case.

Just take the words I have said to heart.

Even if they are just in the back of your mind.

I would say the best you can do right now

is just try to have fun and be friends.

You never know what the future may bring.

Mydei:

Thank you, mother.

For always being here for me and

always providing answers from the heart.

Gorgo:

Any time my son.

Now go have fun.

Just try to make each other smile.

It always lights up the dark.

I send you all my love, my son.

Mydei:

Love you always.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

His heart felt a little lighter after talking to his mother. The other side of him now knows the answer to why Phainon was on his mind a lot. Knowing she was right, it had to be stored. There were too many unknowns.

Mydei decided to just take the here and now and run with it. He needed to finish his cleanup, so he wasn't leaving his guest waiting.

~~~~~~~~

Why does this towel feel like it's covering NOTHING? Like my dick is barely above the end. Do they not believe in bigger ones?? Geez. At least he's on the phone with his mother. Gave me plenty of time not to rush and get in. It does feel really good, though.

He sank down in the water, till it was just at neck level. Leaning his head back on the stone, Phainon could feel all the warmth around him. Loosening up all his tense muscles, which had accumulated over the whole day, particularly at the ruins. This is the most relaxed he's ever felt.

Getting lost in the feeling, he never heard the door open, then close. The body slipped into the water without him knowing. Mydei walked over to the waterfall. Letting his being be consumed by the heat from the world, flowing up through the water and over him.

The odd water sounds were what caused Phainon to open his eyes above anything else.

Lifting his head, he saw the most beautiful sight. His prince being covered from head down in cascading water. Running all over his chiseled body. Every muscle was outlined by the water. Phainon couldn't understand why, out of everything he had seen, this one thing was the image he wanted burned into the pages of his memories.

He felt maybe, just maybe, for this one instance, the gods took pity on his wretched being.
~~~~~~~~

It was still a cookie from the jar he may never have. The shelf was still too high.

But he got a look, though.

And that was enough.

“I’m so sorry, I didn't mean to disturb you. When I came out, you looked very relaxed. It seemed like it was needed.” Pushing all the hair out of the way, it all clung to his back. Everything with Mydei was always a feast for the eyes. Moving himself over to one side, there was a spout that had slow-moving water pouring out, just right for his tired muscles.

Mydei perched himself on the rock, like a giant lion. His arms folded over, resting the sunset on them. Water is making small rivers down his back.

Phainon tried very hard to compose himself before speaking. “No, you're good. How did the talk with your mother go?”

Not lifting his head, the response came from deep within. Mydei's voice dropped a few octaves with how good the water felt. “Yes, it went well. She's proud of you for going through the ruins. Not many make it that far. She hopes the two of us have a good time here.“

The deep voice hit so many parts of him; fighting not to get excited was very difficult. Running his wet fingers through his hair, he was finding it hard to breathe.

It wasn't the baths' doing.

It was the lions.

My lion. My Prince. It is so unfair what you do to me. Why do I feel this way? I am so unworthy of you, yet you keep me here. Feeding my desire… yearning….. lo….love for you.

Being in for a time longer than Mydei, he could feel his time coming to an end much faster. Due to his health and growing desire wasn't helping much.

“Hey, I'm going to go back to my room. Taking precautions because of my medication. I'll….. see you in the morning. Sleep well.” Before Mydei could turn around and respond. Phainon was gone. It was as if the snow had all melted, and he never got to enjoy it.

He tried not to get that feeling again. Mydei is fully aware of the medical condition and doesn't want anything to happen, but he couldn't help feeling like Phainon was running away from him again. That is the part that stung the most.

Staying for another ten minutes, his own limit was reached. His mind aside, the body was amply warmed up from the bath. It has been ages since he's felt that relaxed. Mydei knew he worked too hard. Hardly taking breaks. This was needed.

Exiting the pool left a small void in him. The void had a name. It was Phainon.

Cleaning up after himself, everything was retrieved to return to his room.

Coming down the hall, he stopped in front of door 7. Part of him so badly wanted to knock. Not knowing if he went to bed or not, his key card was scanned in his door. Letting himself in, so as not to disturb the room next door, Mydei tried to make his motions as quiet as possible.

Fishing through his bag, he found a pair of black sweatpants and a dark red tank top.

He was just about ready to sit on the bed when a sound was heard from the next room. Like a door being open, then closed. The odd thing was, it was on the outside of the building.

Walking over to the curtains, pulling them back slightly, told him his guest was very much awake. He found it so weird that they both had colors in their wardrobes that matched in the opposite way.

Phainon's pants were dark blue, and the top was white. Almost mirroring one another.

Phainon was leaning his arms on the railing, bathed in the stars and moonlight, making his white hair even brighter. Mydei could tell he was deep in thought. Something weighed heavily on his mind.

Resting back against the door frame, he just watched. Not knowing what to say or how to feel. The snow-haired man had his heart and mind all over the place. There was a part of him that wanted to jump over the balcony to hold him. To help melt all his fears away.

His heart wanted more.

Mydei knew the answer, though. Their friendship was on Phainon's time, not his own. Even getting him to be friends feels like it was never going to happen. He needed baby steps, if anything.

Mumbling to himself “Why does mother always have to be right? “

°°°°°°°°

The stars shone brightly after the rain had stopped. Being on the top floor of the hotel, Phainon could see them all so clearly. So much more than in the city. Each one has its own radiance.

They danced along in the night sky. Like they always had and forever will. Silently shining like gemstones placed above them.

Just in his sweats and t-shirt, the chilly night air felt nice. Occasional breezes flow past his face. He wanted the wind to take his mind with it. Some days, he would like his head to be silent. Not having so many things going through it. Besides all the tech knowledge he's accumulated over the years, the only other thing his mind has is chaos.

The turmoil is worse now than ever.

The wind picks up a little, fluttering his hair with it. When it settled, it felt like snow on his skin. It was light and soft. Only the most minor distraction.

I really don't know what to do now. I want him. I don't think I can doubt it now. Not just for pleasure. I do love being around him. He's beautiful,

sure….. But his mind…. God. So brilliant. So caring… He is just… perfect. And the care he's given me is just unheard of. He knows nothing of me and my horrid past, but still puts so much of himself out there for me.

But god damn is he gorgeous. He turned around, placing his butt on the railing. With his thoughts lingering way too long, he was forming a tent in his pants. The sunset always had a way with him without even trying. Phainon looked down, seeing the growing erection. When it came to his prince, he was easy. It was very difficult keeping it down in the onsen. Thankfully, Mydei never saw it.

“I should probably head in. I don't want a cold. Plus, if I'm quiet enough, I can take care of this.” Mumbling to himself. Setting his thoughts momentarily aside, he went back in. Grabbing water from the mini fridge. His body was warm, but not from the hot springs or a fever. He was yearning for the image he never wanted to let go of in his mind.

-Mydei is lying across the rock. Wet and naked-

It was so perfect in his mind. The long strawberry-blond hair stuck to his skin. The water's warmth makes all the muscles stick out. Everything needs to be consumed in his mind.

The thoughts were lingering way too long on it. Excitement was boiling inside him harder. The damn inside him was ready to burst. There were so many things he had seen in the past day that just teased his system nonstop.

I'm beginning to think I like seeing him wet. I mean, there was his pool. Then drenched by the rain…..now the onsen. Yeaaaa…. I …I don't know how thick the walls are… but I need it…… like now..

Rummaging through his luggage, in a tied-off silk bag, he found some toys he had brought. Just in case situations like this arose, his head. And his head

was already moist and leaking. Grabbing his plug and sleeve would be the best thing to leave no evidence.

Stripping off his clothes, he wandered over to the bathroom to get a towel. He didn't want to be that cruel to the hotel staff. Luckily for him, he did find one that was way bigger than necessary but could totally do the job.

Once in the right position, he didn't bother with prepping himself. The lubed plug was enough. He reminded himself of no higher speed than low. Any higher and his voice would tell on him. It was angled right and pushed in.

“Ohhhh… god… I've needed this….” Turning it on low, it rumbled just above his prostate. Barley touching it. Not enough to get him completely riled up. Phainon's breathing was already picking up.

°°°°°°°°

The curtain shut quickly. A full red flush danced all over his face. Mydei was hot all over.

“Ok….. fuck… did I??? DID I???....” His mind is going crazy. “I….he… ohhh god…”

Not that Mydei hadn't ever been exposed to mature adult things, far from it. BUT, it was a far different thing seeing it in person. OR on a person, he is coming to grips with the fact that he may like.

His own heart was beating faster. “I should not have seen that. I was invading a private time for him. I uhhhmm…ohhh fu ….ck.” He just then realized his own body was responding to what it saw. Mydei was already straining in his own pants.

Making the big mistake of trying to force it down with his hand only worsened the problem. Just the smallest amount of friction pulled a soft moan from his throat.

He closed his eyes, still leaning against the door frame.

The odd thing about the whole situation was that neither man saw anything fully of the other down in the hot springs, to his knowledge. What could have possibly gotten Phainon so excited? The question was bothering him in the back of his mind.

The front, though, was preoccupied with his hand messaging the erection in his pants. He couldn't deny how good it felt. The kneading kept pushing him for more. Sliding his sweats and underwear down past his ass, he was exposed to the coolness of the room. The AC made it a bit chilly, but with his skin on fire, it was welcome.

Glossed over eyes, couldn't believe how hard it was from just seeing someone else possibly excited. Wrapping his hand around it, fully pulled a moan from his lips. The drag up and down felt amazing. Leaning back fully against the frame, his hips got to work seeking a pleasure he didn't know he needed.

ooooooo

The sleeve was a mechanical one. Knowing private time could always be short, one that did all the work was necessary. Fully inserted, the silicone sleeve had just the right amount of ridges that surrounded his dick. The motor on it provided the up/down, along with suction to get him there faster.

Closing his eyes, he pictured Mydei's lips on him, gently stoking and sucking his whole cock.

“Uhhh.. fuckk.. My…dei.. there.. Just like that. Ple….ase.. let me fuck…. yo…ur uhmmmm god….beau…tiful face. “ His hips started to match the speed of the suction. Phainon couldn't get it in fast or far enough. Chasing that pleasure over an Adonis like Mydei drove him mad.

He bit that part of his lip again. It was getting used to bleeding. Holding back his moans was becoming commonplace out in public.

His free hand found his nipples already begging to be touched. Pinching, rolling it between his fingers, caused his hips to thrust faster. Everything

felt so good. “Fuuuu… fucking.. helll… eveythi….ng… is for you.. my prince…” a few more deep thrusts, and he emptied inside the device. He tried very hard to turn it off but kept missing the button.

Roaming around the buttons, he accidentally pushes the +, making it go faster. Rolling over on his side, his body started thrusting into it more. He wanted to pull off. Everything just felt too good. Being pent up the whole time they were on this trip wasn't helping any.

Chest heaving and overstimulated, his mind shut off completely. Both hands on the device, thrusting into it like it was air to breathe. The wet sounds from it were now audible due to how much he was milking himself.

He was lost in the pleasure of it all.

“Uhhhnnnnnn gawd.. there…. Fuck… ohh fuck… harder..hhmnnnnn please…..” The quiet levels of his voice were nonexistent. Hitting the loudness that he does in his private space back home. His body couldn't take any more. A loud moan tore from his throat, spilling a second time into the device.

Not fighting it a second time, he just pulled out completely. Throwing it on the towel beside his pleasure-wrecked body. Licking his lips, there was only one word leaving his lips, in an almost whisper....

Mydei

°°°°°°

Mydei's head shot up, hearing the sound from the other room. It WAS moaning. Phainon was pleasing himself at the same time he was. Something inside his mind flipped a switch. His length was turning red with friction.

My god, he is…fuck… god. Why does it sound so nice? I….I….wish I could see.

Mydei knew he had to keep it down. The pleasure was mounting so hard in his system. Balling up the end of his shirt, grabbing it hard with his teeth,

his moans were partially muffled.

Running fingers along the slit, playing with his own juices, caused his body to spasm with each touch.

His end was fast approaching.

It needed to end quickly; his knees were starting to give out. The free hand reached below the stoking, grabbed his balls, playing with them as well.

Another moan was heard from the other room. Phainon had finished for the second time. Hearing the ripples of lust through the air for the second time was just enough to get him there.

Spilling all in his hand and some on the rug, his knees gave out.

Slumping down the wall. He couldn't believe what had just happened. He had heard Phainon pleasuring himself and enjoyed it. He needed to see that high with him.

God damn.. that… was..so good. -smiling to himself- *That sounded so nice. Right now, I wish things were different. I want… Him. Yeaaa.. I do, but that will never happen. He doesn't like people or me like that. Probably just pent up and needed release. That's all.*

His eyes were closed, just listening to his own heartbeat. He hadn't moved from the position he came in, on the floor with his cum everywhere.

Mydei knew he had to try to get himself together to clean the mess. He didn't want to leave it for housekeeping.

I think that was the single hottest thing that's ever happened to me. Thank you, Phainon.Thank you for letting me share in your pleasure. It was all mine.

~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes
~~~~~~~

Dammit hot springs. Why do you have to go be so.... hot. Poor Phainon can't take the heat or the heat from his sexy boss. But now that thats over with.. it is time to go home. Feelslings have definitely grown between them, but neither are ready to admit it yet.

Thank you so much for reading. <3

Strawpage is there if you'd like to ask anything, say hi, or doodle ❤

AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 11

Chapter Summary

> Sunday morning was finally here for both men, and feelings were all over the place from the previous eveing. The onsen... both personal pleasures, with only a wall separating them. Everything was crazy.
>
> Unfortunately now they need to make the trek home and each are trying to bury their feelins for the other with out actually talking about it. Damn feelings.
>
> How are either going to act knowing the things they learned and experienced?

Chapter Notes

> No true beta read. Hopefully you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Special privileges happen when you visit a place often, even more so when your family owns the land the hotel is placed on.

There wasn't a wake-up or check out time. The dining area served food all day. If they really wanted something for breakfast, it could get made.

Mydei woke up the next morning with an explosion of emotions. His sleep was amazing. The good rest and soaking in the Onsen did wonders. The lingering thing was haunting him.

Through the wall, he heard Phainon pleasuring himself. All the while, he was doing the same thing. Mydei didn't know how to take it all in. There was a part of him, wayyyy in the back of his conscience, that WANTED to see it all.

He had already admitted to himself that Phainon was very attractive. But then to hear how much he was enjoying this mini-vacation, the joy and excitement in his voice, made him fall just a bit more for his white-haired companion. All those feelings needed to be locked away.

Mydei could tell there was a lot of internal history that hurt him. Letting anyone in that close would probably never happen, especially with being his boss. He finally realizes Phainon is his first crush and is let down. Feelings were there, but that fire kept burning out before him. He is even hoping for the smallest of sparks. When they do arrive home, it needs to be put out as quickly as it appears.

Pulling the pillow he was lying on closer. Part of him felt empty. Wanting more, but being held back. Like if he'd touch the fire, more than burns would happen, scorching more than any stove could ruin skin.

The only thing this chef can do now is just watch that spark from a distance. Knowing that no one else's warmth will ever match.

Swinging his legs over the bed, Mydei was shocked that he was naked. It never happened.

Dammit, I guess I was too tired after cleaning up to care. I'll get a shower, put some freaking clothes on, and THEN text him to see how things are going. What does he want to do? I know I don't want to be late getting either of us home. We both have work tomorrow.

~~~~~~~

Snow white hair lay across the dark pillows. Cerulean eyes opened to an empty bed. Like they always had. Part of him actually wanted to crawl into bed with Mydei, fall back into a blissful sleep, and just get up later.

“That's a dream that's never gonna happen. Why can't my brain just let me enjoy stuff? Why does it have to be this bad? Like that devil is on my shoulder, always telling me you're not worthy of anything. The angel tries so hard to let me feel happiness, but he just gets crushed.”
~~~~~~~

Rolling back around to face the nightstand, his phone was showing almost 10am. Phainon wasn't even sure when he passed out after the quick, clean-up shower he had. His body was so relaxed that it just crashed instantly.

Yawning “Ohhh godd dang… I never get to sleep this late. Stuff always needs to be done. I wonder if he is up yet?? I also severely hope he didn't hear me. It would make things so weird.”

As if right on cue, the screen lit up with a text from the lion prince.

▪▪▪▪▪

My prince:

Good morning, I hope you slept well. I am just getting myself together. It is 10am. We can get food on your time. When you're ready. Just come over and knock on my door.

Also, thank you again for agreeing to come with me. I am having the most wonderful time. It means the world.

▪▪▪▪▪▪

“God. Seee…. This is why I can't win with this man. Always doing anything and everything to show just how much he cares. Fuck, I am so lucky. Why couldn't I meet him in another life, where mine isn't so bad?”

Since they were going to eat first, then probably leave, all his bags were in order. Fishing around in his clothes, he found an outfit to look his best. Even though he had hangups about himself, Phainon always wanted to present the best side of himself. No one needed to see what's under the mask.

Donning a pair of black jeans and a sky blue t-shirt, he was still trying his best to process his life from the past 24 hrs. If he hadn't already fallen for the prince, it would have made things so much easier. They could have been friends. Feelings make this all so much more difficult.

I wish I could lock them like a server, maybe even take the password from me. Well, let's get to this.. I can finish this day… then I can go back to my little safe private room.

~~~~~~~

The rest of the day went rather quickly for them. Even though he had slept in, Phainon was tired by the time they were leaving in the evening. So for the long ride home, he got to take a nap.

Would he go to bed when he got back? Maybe. It would all depend.

The trip back was much more peaceful this time for him. Even knowing that he was taking the long ride, his mind wasn't everywhere, worrying about the car and its passengers. The dreams that came were rather peaceful. Relaxing. Being by a large ocean side at night, stars dancing in the night sky. Tiny organisms had their own competition with the stars every time a wave came up to the beach. Just to see who could shine brighter.

The driver was mostly OK. Only that small, tiny piece of information that was trying to get out of the little box it was in. Sometimes, looking at that snow white hair and cerulean eyes, Mydei's mind could only imagine what he was doing to make those sounds.

Mydei also berated himself for thinking about it. He was a respectable man. He didn't think any untoward things about anyone. Not even….. his…. IT manager.

Yea….

No….he….can't

It happens from time to time. He was thankful that, hopefully, Phainon never saw the blush adorning his face.

When he pulled into the office parking lot, his heart was torn. He wanted to offer for him to come back to the house, but a sleepover didn't go so well last time. His heart didn't want any more disappointment.
~~~~~~~

“Phai...”

Only soft breathing was heard.

“Phainon…” The name came out a little louder. He didn't want to scare anyone awake.

He hesitated, then reached his hand out to touch the blanket covering his arm.

He was, more than anything, glad it was dark out. The blush and heat ran across his whole body. *Mother, you need to stop insinuating* AND *being possibly correct.*

Phainon moved closer to the hand touching him, looking for more comfort. His face was covered in content.

Mydei couldn't let it go on. His poor heart couldn't take much more of this closeness.

“Phainon, we are home.”

“Huh…???? Whhhaaa??” Sleepy eyes looked up at him, softly illuminated by all the electronics on the dashboard. “ We are …home..*yawn* … already?? Shit, I feel like I just layed down.”

“Nope, we are home. Do you want to take a bit to get awake? I could drive you home and have someone get you in the morning, if you don't trust your alertness.” Mydei was getting way too used to looking at that face up close.

He didn't know how to explain it, not like his insides weren’t already in knots. More like excited and scared at the same time.

“Noo, I'm good.” Before sitting up in the seat, he grabbed a bottle of water from the cooler. Once the chair was back in the upright position, Phainon thought he saw a slight blush on his prince's face. Those thoughts were stirring something inside. Something embarrassing. *God, that face is so adorable.*

“I just need a few, then I'm good to go. I know we discussed this before, but I truly do not know how I can ever repay any of this kindness you've shown me. If words could express my gratitude, I'd try. They keep losing themselves on me, though.“

The blush was all over Mydei's face now, creeping down his neck. There was no hiding it. Phainon noticed his breathing was a slight bit faster than normal. Watching the heather grey t-shirt rise and fall a bit more with each breath. Never in a million years or more would he have ever imagined making anyone hot under the collar.

Not like he was just saying words, Phainon truly meant them all. Making his sunset prince blush and get all flustered was just an added bonus. *God, what I wouldn't give to just kiss him right now. I'm just a pawn in my prince's court.…… I know my place.*

It was Phainon's turn to grab Mydei's arm, bringing his thoughts back to the car. Just offering him a sweet smile, he grabbed the door handle, letting himself out. With his back to the car and his dream, the sigh out of him was long.

“I should hurry up and get my stuff. It's late, we both have work in the morning, and you have a bit more of a drive. I don't want to keep you.” Walking back to the trunk, his fingers ghosted along the sleek car. Once behind, he tapped on the trunk for it to be open.

Reaching to get his bags, his hands stopped on the straps. He felt so much hesitation, but knew it wasn't the time or place for feelings. Phainon needed to get home before he did something stupid.

Placing his bags in the back seat of his car, he went back over to the best ride of his life to get the rest of his things. Leaning in, he gave a warm smile to Mydei. He hadn't felt this loved or needed in a long time. “Drive safe, I'll see you in the morning?? “

A simple nod and smile was his answer. Both men would probably fail with words at this point.

He held close to him the rag from the orchard. It was never asked for, so he kept it. *My prince, you are too wonderful to me.*

Getting in his car, the trip home was short. Given that he lives in town, going to and from work was never a chore.

In his safe space at last, he could relax. Getting changed quickly and taking his meds, keeping an eye on Mydei till he got home, was a priority.

“Who knows, maybe I may get a show tonight?”

~~~~~~

Morning came around to the office, and another part of that storm was coming through the area. Ready to douse more of the land, making the only thing you can hear is the patter of rain hitting the ground. It made the exit out of the elevator not as bad. Castorice was always the first one in and then the boss. After 8am, is when the rest of the office came in for the day.

The IT crew was in at their normal 8:30am on the dot. The wait was now on for their leader.

Mydei didn't have any meetings today, so he could get some regular work done that he hadn't been able to since moving in. The door to his office was left propped open, letting in the sounds of the outside world. His doors were normally closed, due to talking about company topics and the like. His soundproof wall kept things private.

He was in the middle of signing some documents when he heard the door to the elevator ding. It could only be one man. The head of the IT department. Knowing how personable Phainon was with Castorice, he wanted to kinda listen in to how he really felt about their trip.

°°°°°°°°°

“Good morning, Miss Castorice.” He set a jar of pomegranate jam and honey on her desk.
~~~~~~

“Uhmmm, good morning to you too, Mr. Khaslana.” She was very taken aback by the presents. “ Are these for me?”

“Yes, ma’am, they are. I brought presents for everyone from my trip.”

“Ohhh, you went on a mini vacation???? That never happens. What's the occasion?? Where did you go?” Not that she didn't already know the answer, she just wanted to see how he'd present the information. She was well aware that Mydei was trying very hard to be friends with him. She was equally more surprised that Phainon agreed to anything, which was amazing. It must have been a wonderful time, considering his enthusiasm.

Also, getting gifts for everyone.

“Yea, I know. Weird right? I really don't have an answer for that. Some….. friends wanted me to take a break. It's the least I could do for their request.”Not admitting that he was trying for his parents. Who were just dirt boxes, under a pretty tree.

“Well, that's wonderful to hear. Sorry, please continue.”

ooooooo

Mydei's ears picked up the sound of a familiar voice. Putting his pen down, he pushed away from the desk enough for his legs to get out. Turning the chair to the side, it was wheeled to the end of the desk. Leaning back in it, he just listened.

oooooooo

“The boss invited me on a trip. I didn't know where, but it happened to be a place he spent a lot of time at as a child. I FREAKIN WENT TO CASTRUM KREMNOS!?!? Can you believe it? Like, of any places we could have gone, I had no idea it was there.” The excitement in his voice was infectious. Cass already found herself smiling.

“I didn't realize there was an orchard right outside the ruins. Went there first. Ohhh, that reminds me.” He got into his bag, pulling out another

present. “The boss said I could take as many as I wanted. So I got one for everyone in the office. They are so good. Not as tart as normal ones.”

She gladly took the fruit from him. Waiting for more of his story.

“Then we went IN the ruins. Like I mean IN. I got to places that normal tours don't show the public. Plus, to hell I can see why. We had to go up these scary-ass chains to get there. I didn't think my soul would take it, but I made it in and back. He said his mom would have been proud of me.”

“Yes, I have heard the most inner parts of the ruins can be quite perilous. It's amazing that the two of you went in unescorted.”

Running his fingers through the snow adorning his head, a long sigh came out.

“That's what I thought, but I guess it was just him and his mom back in the day. That's so crazy. It's so beautiful, though. Even though it's run down, there is so much majesty to it. Like the arena. I could just FEEL the history standing in that spot.”

“Where did you guys go next?”

“ Well, we left so early and really hadn't eaten, except for a few fruits in the orchard. He said I could pick, but I've never been out there. So I suggested fish. Dear lord. MISS Castorice!! You have to go to Cosmo's place. I felt like I was back home with how good it was.. hell, better.”

“I have heard wonderful things about them. He happens to be an old friend of his mother's. I was told she always tries to support one of her dear old friends.” She had had their stuff a few times before. The boss has had business meetings over there from time to time, bringing her to go meals. She wholeheartedly agreed that the food was wonderful.

“Then we went to the museum. My. God.”

She couldn't help but giggle at the excitement over taking his face. She was so happy to see him getting out and having a good time.

“The history in that place. So much detail. Like, from records on HOW the place was built to the food they prepared, everything. I've never been in a place that was so thorough with their records.” The rest of his bags were placed on the ground. He had been standing for a while, and the bags were making creases on his skin.

“The boss has talked about their land's history before. They wanted all generations to know their glory as a people as well.”

“That part was totally not skimped over. Ohhh, and the weapon room was incredible. All types of weapons you can think of. The boss's spear and shield would fit right at home there.”

ooooooo

Everything in Mydei's system stopped. Eyes going wide. Did he hear correctly?

My spear and shield??? No one but my family knows I have that. How is that even possible? He hasn't been to the house since I got everything moved in. I don't understand.

His mind was all over the place, looking for an answer, but nothing could solve this riddle. He didn't want to ask either. Things may get weird then.

He continues to listen but only with half of his mind. The other half was on this conundrum.

oooooooooo

With all the toiling he did in his mind, Mydei missed some of the story, but when he picked up , he could tell that it was almost over.

“And then we came home Sunday night. Like, it was an amazing trip. I don't travel much, but this was an experience. It definitely meant a lot.” Picking up the other bags, he was ready to head to his office.

“Well, I am glad the two of you had an amazing time. I think you both probably needed it. You and the boss work too hard. Never take any time

for yourselves, very much overdue, I think. I don't want to keep you, but thank you so much for thinking of me on this trip. I truly appreciate it.” Her smile was very infectious. Making him give her a bright one in return.

Picking up his bags, he left to go distribute the other gifts. Cass noticed a slight more emotion in his steps. Even if it was just the smallest amount, she could tell he was a little happier than he had been. She was more than happy to see they both had a good time.

I wonder if any new emotions were sparked between them? They would look so good as a pair and seem to have a very good time together. Who knows? Only time will tell.

~~~~~~~

The rest of the day was very quiet for him. Work got done, but his mind was distracted the whole time. Trying to figure out what it all meant, most of his lunch went uneaten.

He turned his chair around to the window, watching the rain fall softly behind the glass, reminding him of the weekend that they had just spent together. The things he had seen and heard were now etched into his mind. It was something he couldn't escape from. He almost didn't want to.

But Phainon, knowing about his relics, bothered him like no other. Pulling up his phone, he pulled up the finished drawing of the camera placement. Everyone was taken into account. He brought the special ones into the house in their boxes. Even in the weird off chance that Phainon DID check on him, there was no way for him to see the contents. It was the only thing he didn’t have access to.

I don't remember saying anything about my own when we were at the exhibits. I still don't understand.

A ding on his computer shifted his thoughts. Turning back around, the email program was loaded. And there at the top of the page was the man who was plaguing his thoughts.
~~~~~~~

▪▪▪▪▪▪▪▪

To: Mr. M.Kremnos

From: Mr. P. Khaslana

July 14th, 20xx 4:00pm

I would like to bring to your attention that there will be a large security update to the cameras installed at your home. It will take place at 5pm today and last for at least 2 ½hrs to possibly 3. Depending on how the system updates. The earliest possible is the 2 ½. If you are to be home during maintenance, the security for the gate will be the last thing updated. To still let you go in and out of the residence. The application for the camera will notify you to let you know it's been completed and everything is operational.

Sorry for any inconvenience.

Thank you

Mr. P. Khaslana

▪▪▪▪▪▪▪▪▪▪

“I think that has to be the most formal email I've ever received from him. Maybe I should head home early. Just to get it out of the way. I'm too distracted to finish work.”

Gathering up his things, he was done for the evening. Maybe going home would provide some answers, he was hoping.

4:30pm wasn't totally abnormal for him. It did happen, but not often. Bidding Cass a good night, he made his way home. No music was played

on the stereo. Everything was quiet except for his mind. Not that he was upset about the situation, he wasn't. Just couldn't understand how.

Pulling into the garage, it was 4:50pm, just in time before things would go down. He entered the door that led into the kitchen, in case there were groceries. He wasn't quite ready for dinner yet, so the mini pancakes with fruit in them were a good snack. Even cold.

Putting a few in a bowl, he needed to get out of the suit he was in. Since it was his own place, taking food to his room was something that happened often since moving in.

They were placed on the dresser while looking for clothes to wear. Just then, a soft beep was heard in the room. His amber eyes shot up, looking for that sound. Nothing was on. No music, no fireplace, and no TV. It was just him looking for clothes in the dresser. Another softer one went off. His eyes focused on the sound. It was coming from around the fireplace.

Walking over to it, he studied the wall space. Running his fingers over the molding, it all felt normal. Tilting his head a little more to the side, he ran his fingers back over the same places with just a bit more pressure.

A swipe over the molding, at the top section where the upper molding met the frame for the inlay for the wall - his fingers sank in some. The release made a click sound. Grabbing a hold of the small panel, it was pulled open.

“A …..camera???? Here in my room?? How.. when??”

Pushing it back shut, his lips pushed together in a tight hold. His thinking was hurting. Sitting down on the bed, he needed to go over what he knew.

“It had to have been him. No one else has been in my house. Especially my room.” Lying back on the bed, his sunset hair flared on the black comforter. Mydei was trying to put it all together. “ But why?? I don't understand. What could….. would…. There….be?”

The past few months, interactions flooded his mind. Phainon has been very tip-toey around him. He knows that there have been many blushes that were

caught. Mydei almost wanted to push them off as a figment of his imagination. The feelings that were brewing in his chest were all coming forth.

“Ohhhh, my god. Last night at the hotel….” His eyes went wide with the realization of it all. “.... Phainon…. Was…. He..” that blush was coming back, but not just on his face. His whole body. “ He was getting off to me. While I was unknowingly thinking of him. We finished together separately.” It then hit him harder that this camera was installed with the rest. Any of his private moments were probably and most likely seen.

“But why…?? I'm not anyone….”

“anyone would be lucky to have you.”

“I know I would”

The thump in his heart got louder. Mydei could hear it in his ears. The man he was trying to befriend…..cared for him. Wanted him. He still couldn't fathom why Phainon would pull away from him so hard. It felt like they had a connection. So many things they enjoyed together.

Did he figure that because I was his boss, he couldn't pursue anything with me? Like, yes, they are employed, but not directly. Is he afraid of me?? My family?? I don't understand. From the talk with Cass, he had a good time. Am I reading this wrong? Why the cameras? It does feel…. Does he like me sexually? I did feel his eyes on me a lot over the weekend. Probably being all wet from the rain, and then the Onsen probably didn't help him. Is that what caused him to do it in his room?

Part of him was kind of touched that he went so far as to put cameras in his room, but would never pursue things. It made him realize now that Phainon could only “like him from afar. Nothing more. That maybe wanting to keep him at a distance is why he gets ‘bailed’ on a lot.

Not that he wasn't attracted to him as well. He made a mess all over the rug for it. Talking to his mother helped him come to the determination that he did LIKE him.

“So what do I do with this information? I'm not really upset that he's more than likely seen ALOT. I don't think he's the kind of person that would share that across the internet. It was probably all just for him. Maybe… just maybe.”

Thoughts were brewing inside him. He wanted to test this theory just to see if it was correct. Mydei surmised that this camera, in particular, was not part of the ones for the main house. This one was special, so maybe it's part of a separate program that only he had access to.

So the camera will be down for almost three hours. He must get some kind of notification that I'm in the room. So maybe after some time, I could do a little something FOR him, to show my appreciation for the weekend. Then see how work goes tomorrow.

That is just what he did. After the allotted time for the maintenance, it was time to put on a show. Something about being watched, but only by Phainon, excited him. For the man, he knew, to really reject the outside life, to not engage in anything social, he had to be special to go to these lengths.

Standing in the doorway between the two rooms, he figures he couldn't be seen. Knowing that he was being watched by a man he now wanted back, excited him. It was now time to see just how round up the cameraman was going to get.

~~~~~~

《BEEP》

The computer had been constantly going off while he was in the kitchen. Bowl in hand, he walked over to see what the commotion was all about. Maintenance was done, so there shouldn't have been a problem. Everything went back up online, okay.
~~~~~~

It was the special cameras.

The bowl was immediately put down, and all of his focus was now on the computer and his prince. He couldn't believe what his eyes were seeing; besides the 2nd night in a row, his prince was pleasuring himself again.

“Dear lord. Fuck this is amazing. Someone must like me. I got to spend an amazing weekend with the man of my dreams. Dropped me off and he went home and had some private time. Now again?? God damn. ….wait…wait… wait… does he have a collar on?? I might just cum right now..this night is so perfect. “

The rest of his evening was spent in front of his monitor, being spent.

~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

> Soooooooo ohhhnoooo, Mydei knows about the camera's now. Realizing that he has been watched ever since the house was bought. Poor Phainon doesn't know what an equally as horny and lonely lion will do with that information.

> Thank you so much for reading. <3
>
> Strawpage is there if you'd like to ask anything, say hi, or doodle ❤
>
> AsuranDreamz
>
> Twitter
> AsuranDreamz
>
> Blogspot
> AsuranDreamz Blog
> All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.
~~~~~~

Chapter 12

Chapter Summary

> Phainon was having the time of his life this week. Going over all the videos he had saved from Mydei's nigjtly exploits was a dream come true. He had no idea that the Chef Prince was so dirty.
>
> What he wasn't expecting was an invitation to eat Saturday night. How is he able to thing straight with so many things going on inside his head.
>
> Poor boy is just a mess of emotions.

Chapter Notes

> No beta read.
>
> Note.. this is an emotional chapter. I made myself cry with it. If you get emotional from it, in any way, i guess i did a good job.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

By the time Friday rolled around, Phainon didn't know what to do with himself. Since coming home Sunday night, each night was like a blessing had been answered. Someone was letting him feel out his fantasies with the boss.

There was a little part of him that questioned whether it was too good to be true. Considering how much he's had to clean up his desk area proves otherwise.

“Ok… uhmmmm...” Clicking into his saved videos folder, he went into the deeper, secure one of private videos for the house. ”OK… so.. Sunday night was just hands in the shower. Monday was with a freaking collar and a vibrating plug. Tuesday.. oh god Tuesday. To see him on his hands and knees with his ass in full view with toys in it... “ He rolled his eyes shut and

shuddered. He could have seen himself in there. Every part of Mydei's body was perfect. And seeing a thing he would love to get into was just the best visual orgasm ever.

“Soo ahem… where was I..” He clicked into the next day. “ Wednesday was more shower stuff, but there were toys suctioned to the wall. What I wouldn't give to be that toy, either. That hair stuck to him was just so beautiful. And last night… nooo, last night was beyond what I ever thought he'd do. Edging himself for at least an hour if not more... clamps on those perky red nipples, chain between. Never letting himself reach that edge. Fuck, I know I was having issues. He was such a tease to me. I almost fell out of the chair with how hard I came. “

He did wonder what came over Mydei, though? To do it once a night this whole week. What could have possibly gotten him that excited?

The anxiety had been behaving itself, for the most part, all week. That nagging devil was back. Poking at him. Making him 2nd-guess everything. *He has someone now, doesn't he? I don't know what he does most of the day...and I really haven't seen him. Maybe this past weekend was just him testing the waters for someone else. Why am I jealous? He isn't yours to begin with. Your only… friends…. Just friends.*

Closing out the file system, his heart was all over the place. He was starting to question if he needed to see the doctors again about his anxiety. It had been all over the place as of late. The extremes really haven't been good on his system. He hadn't needed a psychologist for a long time. Whatever had happened recently, to have Mydei ‘SEE’ him was messing with his psyche. Like a god looking upon his world, deeming Phainon worthy to bask in his holy presence. It has since been the destruction of his soul. It was now lost forever.

His self-loathing was interrupted by a ringtone he hadn't heard in a while. There was a text message from his prince. No matter how much he hates himself, he wants to always be at Mydei's backing call. A loyal like a snow white puppy.

“Let's see, what does my prince want?”

▪▪▪▪▪▪▪▪

My prince:

I hope I'm not interrupting you for anything. I know your work always keeps you busy. If you happen to be free tomorrow night, would you want to come out to the house for dinner? I have some new things I want to try. See what you think? If not, that's ok. I understand things are on your time. I asked a lot of you last weekend. I don't want to push anything. If you do, come out to the house around 4:30. Just let yourself in. You don't need to respond. Just come if you wish.

▪▪▪▪▪▪▪

“Ohhh shit… Mydei. My Prince. You don't understand. I've been coming all week long, thanks to you…..maybe. Maybe I should. I already know his cooking is amazing. I'll try. What more can I do?”

To his odd surprise, the notification that the bedroom was busy didn't go off. Later in the evening, when what would be bedtime for most, he had to check it. And there he was, snuggled under the black comforter, sound asleep. Rolling the footage back, nothing happened: changed clothes like normal, prepared for bed, and then went that fast. Phainon could only assume Mydei was getting up early to make things.

The past few nights, his escapades have been till almost 1 in the morning. He couldn't believe that the boss was up anywhere between 6 and 6:30, still being able to come into work, looking immaculate as always. Maybe it was a Kremnoan thing. Always looking amazing. From the picture, a long time ago, his parents were very good-looking as well. Thinking back, the prince totally looked like his mother. Beautiful as the first rays of sunlight beaming across the land. No wonder he was so in love with her son. It is as if a goddess of beauty bestowed her blessing on him, that his would forever be eternal.

“It has me hooked. I guess I should go too. I want to be on time. Maybe I should bring something as a gift or a dinner thing. I'd love to take him

flowers, but with someone else probably in his life now, I don't want to cause issues.“

~~~~

4:30 on the dot, he was there. He was really starting to love this house, not just for what happened in it. The peace it offered back in the woods. Amenities that most would dream of. Like, yes, it was an expensive house, but it felt lived in. A home, not just a house.

He knew that's where it had to stay, just out of arm's reach. With his prince possibly having someone nobody knew anything about, the possibility hurt. He knew there was very little space for him. He still couldn't fathom when it may have happened. That Saturday at Zeno's, he said he didn't. And now all the perversion at night, it only led him to believe it was for someone. It was just something he'd have to accept.

He hoped that he wasn't overdressed for the occasion. He knew it was just dinner. He had on a white button down shirt with gold trim, and small suns adorned the cuffs. He had another shirt that matched, but was very noticeable. There was also a pair of pants that matched, but were very dressy. So just sticking with his black jeans was a more comfy choice.

Taking a deep breath, he let himself into the house. Immediately, he was caught up in a storm of smells. So many sweet and savory things all at once. If he was a food connoisseur, then maybe be able to place the flavors. The only thing he knew was that it all smelled wonderful.

Kicking his shoes off, the other shoes confused him. The dress shoes from Friday were there. He remembered them because of having the red soles on them. The pair of black boots thoroughly confused him. He'd never known Mydei to own that type of clothing. *Maybe it's the other person. Wait… those are men's boots. So he is gay?? Like for real? I mean, straight men can like anal…. I just… I didn't figure he liked anyone.*

Walking into the kitchen, his heart was doing circles. Those sexy jeans were back. Hanging dangerously low on his hips. The black compression shirt was so tight on his torso. It was hugging every muscle on his frame.
~~~~

Making sure Phainon saw each and every one. Plus, too, he gathered, all the moving around caused it to ride up.

Shirt up, pants down. Ohhh damn. I'm in trouble.

What also caught his eye was the white and gold-trimmed waistband sticking out from said low-riding pants. That belt wasn't helping much. All of his hair was done up in a singular braid, just lying over his shoulder. Phainon had taken notice that the glasses were worn more often now that he had his own place, never at work. At home, they always adorned the sunset hair.

Why does he have to be so effortlessly beautiful and handsome all the time?

“Evening. Hope I'm not interrupting.” Phainon had to giggle to himself, watching Mydei jump at his words. *I guess in chef mode, the rest of the world isn't there*.

“Hi, uhm noo.” The blush was on his face. Mydei was hoping all the cooking would hide it. “You are just on time. What.. what do you have?”

“Ohh, this?” Walking over to the counter, a covered vase was placed. Making a ting sound when it contacted the marble countertops. “I didn't want to be a rude guest, so I brought something. I knew sweets were out of the question because you make better. So I went with an edible arrangement. I hope that's ok.”

Leaning over the counter, Mydei pulled a strawberry from a stem. He unconsciously licked his lips before taking a bite. The berry was very much in season and juicy. Phainon tried so hard not to stare as the pink tongue came out to lick up the rest on his lips.

Shit.. noo.. dude…nooo. I can't get hard here in the kitchen. Not that I didn't have fantasies about licking sauce off that body, lying across this countertop, like my buffet. Every part is a treat. Just to hear him beg for more. I can't.

“These are really good. In season too. Thank you. That's so thoughtful. So are you hungry?”

The whisk slowly went around the rim of the pot he was over. Phainon could never walk away from here now and not see cooking -**no, specifically Mydei's cooking** - as sexual. It is some of the hottest stuff he'd seen. That wasn't adult material.

“Uhmm, yes, please. Starving. I can't wait to see what you're working on.” He was starving in more than one way, but had to hold back. Helping set the table, his eyes wandered back to the front door. That pair of boots was haunting him now, poking at the sadness in him.

Dinner went relatively smoothly. Each is making conversation about the food. Asking questions to further the dish-making process. Being at opposite ends of the table, his nerves felt a little better.

“Hey Phainon, while you're here, can we talk?”

Hearing those words, his blood and soul sank. He never found it good when people said that to him. It never ended well. He tried to play it cool.

“Yeah, sure. What's on your mind?”

Mydei sat himself more upright in his chair. Trying not to show his nerves. “Us”

Phainon's insides were screaming right now. He was trying so hard to hold back his feelings of flight. Letting the man who held his whole being speak was important.

“I’m not quite sure how to breach this. I've never had to do it before. Leading a restaurant is one thing. Trying to talk about inner feelings is another.” His voice was carrying hints of worry. Not knowing what to say or how to say it.

Phainon’s anxiety was winning right now. “If there is a problem. I can leave. As I said, I know I'm a lot.” *Yea and you are too good for me. Even*

as a friend.

The trepidation could be seen in his amber eyes. Not sure of where to go. “Noo, noo. You're good. Can I ask you a very serious question and get an honest answer?”

A simple nod.

“Do you like the show you've been getting privately?” Mydei was jumping headfirst into this ocean, this one he didn't know if he could swim or not.

Heat started building under his skin. Phainon's whole body was on fire. “I'm not sure what you're talking about.” He tried so hard to lie.

“Come now, don't be so coy about it. You saw the chains. Didn't you? And you've seen all the other things that have happened since I moved in?” There was no hate or malice in his voice. Just the soft question riding off his lips, sending Phainon's internals into a panic.

Fuck fuck fuck!!!! So not only does he have someone, but knows… about them all… god.. fuck.. nooo.. noooo I didn't want this. I went too far. He's gonna hate me. I took my lust to a place it should have never crossed.

“From the look on your face. I'm right.” Mydei watched his apple rise and fall with a hard swallow. A soft nod was all his body would allow.

His white hair hung in front of his eyes, trying to hide the windows of his soul. “How?” Was all he could manage.

“You mentioned to Cass about the museum visit. And told her my spear and shield would have looked great in there. No one knows I have those, but family. When you said the cameras were going down. The ones in my room made a noise. I just happened to be in there when it sounded.”

Phainon's eyes went wide with shock. He had no idea that would happen to the private ones as well. He tried very hard to speak. ”Why did you let me see those things, if you have someone?”

The words hit him oddly. Mydei was very confused. “Have anyone? What would give you that impression?”

“Those boots by the door, for one. And all the sexual things you did, it was for a lover, wasn’t it? I don't see why you would do any of those nice things for me if you actually had someone.”

A small laugh left his throat. “No, silly, they were for you, and those boots are mine."

“What!?! You have to be joking. None of that could be for me.”

“No, I'm actually quite serious. I was really hoping you would come to dinner. Phainon, I don't know how to say this… “

White hair got up from his chair in a flash, making his way to the door. He didn't want to hear anything. His world was falling to pieces. Tears were ready to fall. He couldn't let anyone see.

Phainon thought he was quick, but Mydei was just a tad bit quicker. Grabbing his arm halfway through the living room. Mydei knew he had to say it now or never. “I want to ask you out.”

Phainon froze. Those words have never been spoken to him by a person he cared about. Anyone else who had tried, he had no interest in. This was Mydei. His prince. It all hit him like a meteor crashing down upon him.

“I feel something with you that I have never felt with anyone else. I feel like a statue with others, but normal around you. I don't know how many times in the past month you've gotten a blush out of me, more than I have fingers to count. And I was shocked at first about the cameras, but I'm not upset at them. Part of me kind of liked being watched, but only by you. This past weekend, just helped me affirm how I felt. I would like to….”

His words got cut off. Phainon put his hand up to the one holding his arm, pushing it off. “I'm sorry you feel that way.” The lying hurt; his heart was tearing itself apart. “I can't accept anyone's affections. I appreciate the care you took with me, but for someone like me, I don't deserve it or you.

Mydeimos, you are too good for someone rotten like me.“ He walked over to the door, putting his shoes on. He dared not look at the man, stunned in the middle of the room.

With his back turned, holding onto the handle, he had to say it. “You don't deserve a monster like me.” Before any more could be said, the door opened and closed.

Mydei sat on the edge of the fireplace. The shock was slowly starting to fade, and the sadness took over. Now he was feeling the rejection that all others had felt from him. He was hoping so hard that Phainon liked him as well, that his line of thoughts weren't wrong.

They weren't just wrong, they were soul crushingly wrong. He was ready to try and put himself out more just to get burned by the fire instead.

~~~~~

Everything felt like a repeat of that night. Once again, knowing full well he had crushed Mydei's hope of anything normal. He pulled off to the side of the road, just like before, but this time he couldn't stop his tears. They hurt so bad. His ambition got the better of him. Now it was out in the open that he'd been spying on Mydei. Hoping to catch anything that would appeal to his corrupted soul.

“I can't now. I just can't. Everything is ruined. He knows about the secret camera and me watching. At least he didn't know he was falling for a murderer.” Everything he hated about himself was coming out. He couldn't stop being mad at himself for his messed-up life. “They would still be alive if it weren't for me. I get people hurt. I still can't believe my parents lived as long as they did. I figured I was a curse. Maybe that's why the gods took them from me. To save them from my corruption. So they could pass with a happy life. Now this… noo, I can't. He can't love me.“ His fists were banging on the steering wheel.

“You can't love the fallen; there is no saving us.”

Once his tears had dried somewhat, he made the trek home.
~~~~~

With the keys under his fingers, all of the cameras were deactivated, except for the main entrance and gate. The special ones had their systems set to fully deactivate, and the program to be erased in the next few hours.

The horrors of what he caused were eating at his soul. The folder with everything relating to Mydei was shoved in an extra secure folder and then hidden from view. He was going to try to erase his feelings. They crossed his own line. They hurt someone. He never wanted that ever. The only one needing punishment now was him.

His heart was broken in so many ways that he didn't know if it could ever be repaired.

~~~~~~~~

Within the next half hour, a red car pulled into the driveway. The driver got out as quickly as possible. What met Gorgo when she opened the door was her son, on the ledge of the fireplace, in tears. Her son had been hurt deeply. As per the fault of his father, showing tears was a sign of weakness. To survive in the business world, you can't show any signs of weakness.

So to see him now holding his legs to his chest, crying, hurt her like no other. She walked slowly over to him, once close enough, petting his head. The knees came down, arms wrapping around her waist, soaking up all of her son's tears.

A good ten minutes of tears finally settled down. His arms unhooked around her. She was finally able to squat down to see his face. The once proud lion of Kremnos was now a scared, soaked kitten.

“My son, please, can you tell me what has brought the mighty lion down. I've never seen you this upset.” Her thumb slides across his face, catching any tears that are still falling.

“ I …..I love him….but …I got rejected.” His body was trying so hard to fight it again. The one person, outside of the arms that hold him now, he wanted, coldly rejected him. “He also said that monsters like … him didn't deserve love.”
~~~~~~~~

Gorgo couldn't believe what she was hearing. From everything she's heard of this boy: he's sweet, polite, caring, adorable. The list went on. Never did she hear a bad thing about him.

“He wouldn't even… explain. Just left. Maybe just like him, I can't have…..love. Too many treat me like I'm on a pedestal. He didn't.”

Mydei wasn't going to tell his mother about the cameras; that was his own secret. What was the truth was that he wanted to have a relationship with Phainon. Their weekend together helped him realize that. *I'm too good for him??? He's rotten??? I don't understand.*

“Mother, there is a lot he didn't tell me. Can you help me find answers, at least? I at least want to understand why he said no.”

Sitting on the stool behind her, she pulled out her phone. A friend of hers, going a ways back, may provide her son with some answers. She fired off a quick message and went back to her grieving son.

“I know of someone who may be able to help. You met him a long time ago. I'm not sure if he works the weekends or not. He'll get back to me when he does. For now, I need to take care of you. MY heart hurts seeing you this upset.”

“Mother… you.. You don't need to. I just need to suck it up and…” The second time tonight, his words were cut off.

“Mydeimos Kremnos!” He sat straight up, hearing her commanding tone. It didn't happen often, but when it did, no one questioned anything. “I will NOT have you acting like your father. It is good to show emotions. It doesn't make you a wall. There is something special about that boy. To grab your attention this hard, he did something right. I want to know as well. So, I do not want to hear any more negative out of you, young man.”

There was no way, in all the fires of Kremnos, he would ever disobey her. Mydei has seen her wrath. It wasn't just because she was a mother. She was a force of nature to be reckoned with.

If there was a way answers could be found, he trusted her judgment. Mydei knew deep down that yes, she did ‘love’ his father, but she loved him more. Wants nothing but the best for him in any endeavor he pursues.

Now it was just a matter of waiting.

~~~~~~~

Gorgo stayed with him the rest of Saturday and all day Sunday. She didn't want to leave him alone while his heart was broken. Getting a hold of Castorice for him, she told her he is taking the day off tomorrow. Possibly two. Some things had come up. Cass sent all her love and support. From the sound on the line, things were bad.

~~~~~

Not till she came in for the morning did she know the full extent. Sitting down at her desk, pulling up the log of people coming in, her eyes went wide with shock.

“Phainon is here… already?? Since 6:30!?! Something definitely happened, and it was bad.”

She tried to stay at her desk all day to catch the snow-haired man. Maybe try to glean a little as to what happened.

Then, around 2:30, she heard a body coming down the hall from the tech office. Sure enough, it was him. Cass caught sight of him before he rounded the corner. She was in total shock. Phainon had to prepare himself to come past her, like he was putting on a mask to hide things.

Playing feign was starting to become a thing for her. She picked up the phone and had a fake conversation, in hopes that it was heard.

Phainon was coming towards the desk.

“Yes, can I take a message? Mr. Kremnos is currently out of the office for a few days due to medical reasons. I will be sure to pass the message along

when he comes back. Is that everything? Sure thing. Thank you for your concern. Have a good evening, bye.”

Phainon was shocked to hear the boss had never come in. Now was out on medical. He couldn't fathom what could have possibly happened. Was I the cause??

“Good afternoon, Mr. Khaslana. How can I help you?” She could see some kind of guilt hiding behind his eyes.

“I just wanted to let you know I was leaving for the day. The rest of the crew is fine. I put in a note for my bosses that I'm going to be out of the office the rest of the week. Taking some personal time.” Part of him was hesitant to ask about Mydei.

“I see.” Cass scribbled a note that he was going to be out, to put it in the system later.

“That's good to hear you are taking time. That doesn't happen often.”

“Uhm, I didn't mean to listen in, I kinda heard on my way over - but the boss is not here?” He was trying so hard to hide his heartbreak from the weekend.

“No, sadly, he isn't." There was something up. There was a feeling deep inside that he knew something. *I'm gonna play the card. I hope it works*. “Madam Gorgo got a hold of me last night to inform me that he wasn't well and she was staying with him. It must be quite serious for her to be involved. So honestly, I'm not entirely sure when he will be back.”

The shock hit him harder than expected. His mom was involved now. He knew now that things were serious. The need to get out of the building was first on his mind

“I'm…uhmm sorry to hear that. Please have a good rest of your week.” He didn't even let her say goodbye before he was at the elevators and gone.

“Wow. That is totally not how I expected that conversation to go. Something happened hard. I kinda wanna know.” Pulling up her contacts, she went down to the lady she was looking for.

《RING》

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

***Mama G**:*

Good afternoon, my dear.

***Cass**:*

Hi, Mama G.

I would ask if things are well,

but I know they aren't.

I know you said Mydei was ‘ill’

and left it at that.

I was wondering if Mr. Khaslana

anything to do with it?

Mama G:

Give me a second.

(She quietly walks outside, shutting the door behind her. Opening her car door, she gets in the driver's seat, shutting it. Giving them the most amount of privacy, she put the rest of the call on speaker.

I didn't want to disturb him or

set fire under anything else.

The short of it all

is Mydei asked him out

and got rejected.

***Cass**:*

WHAT!?!

You have to be kidding me.

Those two have been spending

quite a lot of time together recently.

There has been a

noticeable change in them both.

Like it all was a good thing.

Mama G:

That's what I thought

when I called them on their trip.

They got caught in the rain,

and my son made a call

to the hotel to book an onsen.

I had called him before he got in.

I got the impression that there were feelings.

At least on his side.

He wasn't so sure about Phainon.

I guess he asked him over for dinner.

Popping the question after.

From the sounds of things,

Phainon got very defensive,

calling himself a monster and rotten.

That Mydei deserved better.

(Cass couldn't believe what she was hearing. The bright and cheerful man who just brought her and everyone else presents from their trip...a monster?? Rotten?? Where in all the world's name would he get the idea that he was that bad a person? Undeserving of anyone.)

***Cass**:*

Mama, I just don't understand.

I guess none of us do right now.

I could tell something happened.

He had to put on a face

to talk to me before he left.

I made up a partial lie that

the boss was sick,

just to see where he would go.

There was shock

and guilt written behind those blue eyes.

Now I know why.

***Mama G**:*

So, I'm going to try whatever

I have in my resources to see if I can help.

Now, whether they get together

is for them to figure out.

They do work in the same building.

I finally got him to go to bed.

He's been up since Saturday night.

Cass:

Whatttt!?!? He was up that long??

Ohhhh…

My heart is breaking for those two.

I really thought an office romance was

finally going to happen

between two men who reject everyone.

All we got was heartbreak…

…..

…..

Ohhh nooo

Mama G:

What is it??

I have a feeling it isn't good.

Cass:

No, it isn't.

With Phainon taking a week off….

I'm very afraid that he is going to want to quit

or at the very least, get transferred.

Mama G:

Yeaaa, I was kind of thinking the same thing.

(Car sounds in the background)

Sweet, I have to go.

The thing I asked to help with this issue is here.

So I'll keep you updated.

Please just keep watch on things on your end.

***Cass**:*

Will do, ma'am.

Please take care.

I pray for those two.

I don't want to see either sad.

They are both such wonderful people.

¤¤¤¤¤¤

Pulling up her scheduling screen, Cass sadly puts in the vacation that was written down. Once it was entered, an email popped up. It was informing her of more people and vendors that were coming to the party.

I wonder if either will show up. The boss for sure. Phainon… I really wish.

~~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

Love hurts. Those two have so many things holding them back, that trying to be honest with each other blew up hard.

Hopefully Anaxa can find Mydei his answers and find some semblance of peace.

Thank you for reading through the emotions. ❤

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz
~~~~~~~~

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 13

Chapter Summary

> Gorgo's longtime friend finally arrives at the house to help with the sad and forlorn kitty. Mydei's mind is in shambles from rejection, not eating or sleeping; he's a mess. But for your first love rejecting you, in a world that only sees you for your status, there may be no glue that can put those tiny pieces back together.
>
> Anaxa has a pretty emotional case on his hands. Will his skills be enough to help the lost?

Chapter Notes

> No beta read. Small note at note at the end.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Cool mint hair was caught in the breeze as he exited the car. Looking around, he was taking in all the information he could. A case was going to be given to him for sure, but he wanted to have all angles covered to come to any conclusion.

Coming around the front of his car, he waited for the madam on the phone to join him.

“Good evening, Anaxa, it has been a while.” Extending her hand to shake his.

“Same to you, Lady Kremnos. I see the gods of time can't touch you. Still as beautiful as ever.” A small smirk adorned his face.

“Always having a way with words. Thank you for responding to my request on such short notice.” She leaned against his car, arms crossed over her chest. Her mind was just as frazzled as the situation was. Even she couldn't find an explanation.

“I only speak the truth. So, you are in need of my skills? And for you, they won't cost much. I have known you for a while, and you're a good friend. I am only glad to help.” He would have to come up with a cost later. It was always an equivalent exchange for him. Depending on the assignment given, how involved, and anything affecting him, then set his prices.

“You are well aware of my son running the Evernight. He has always chosen to be single because of his status and responsibilities. As of late, he had taken a shine to his IT manager. And confessions on Saturday have led to some things that were said that make no sense. So what I'd like from you is to find out ‘the why’. I'm going to leave this between you two for confidentiality. Anything said between them stays there unless he states otherwise.”

The pink and blue eyes are deep in thought, listening to the request. Finding information was his specialty. Almost no one could keep anything hidden from his fingers on the keys.

“I understand. I'll accept the request. Once a conclusion is reached, then I'll figure out payment. And yes, everything will stay between him and me. No problems there.”

“Come, I'll introduce the two of you.” Heading back into the house, sounds could be heard from the kitchen. They both wander down the hall, stopping at the threshold. The heir was on a stool, looking like a tornado went through him. His t-shirt looked like something out of an alternate teen music store. It was ripped in a few places and was just hanging off his shoulders. His bun was barely holding his hair back. His glasses look like they haven't been off his face in ages. The ripped jeans were starting to become his go-to pants, not at work. He did invest in other colors but the same style.

The bags hung very low on his face. Lack of sleep and anxiety were on full display. He was trying to nurse a bowl of oatmeal.

“My son, I thought you were in bed?” She walked over to him, gently pushing his bangs away from his face. Her hand then rubbed his shoulders for comfort.

“I was, then I felt ill. Tried to…” His head looked up, seeing a man wearing a dark teal suit in his kitchen. “My god, I'm so sorry. I didn’t realize you had guests. I'll remove myself…”

The man with teal hair words stopped him before he could go any further. With the most serious look on his face, words came out lacking emotion. “No need to leave, Mydeimos. I am here for you.”

His amber eyes shot up at her. Confusion and panic were all over his face. “Mother, am I being committed? I'm unfit to do anything?”

Gorgo's eyes shot at him. “Anaxagoras!! What the hell? With the state he's in, you're going to make a joke like that?”

“I'm sorry. I do apologize. Sometimes my humor is off. No, Deimos, you don't need to leave. I actually am here at the request of your mother, who is still shooting daggers at me.”

“Yea, well, I didn't find that funny.” She sat on the stool beside him, waiting for the rest of the conversation.

Clearing his throat, he tried not to laugh a little.”Your mother had informed me about the incident recently, and I'm here to help you find information. I am a private investor. We go way back, so I was more than happy to help.”

“Is this who you texted Saturday?”

“Yes, and Anaxa is very good at his job(maybe sometimes not his humor). So I am going to leave you two to discuss things. It is going to stay confidential. I am going to check on the restaurants and make sure everything is going well. I hope you find answers and get some sleep.” She kisses him on the forehead. Her arm wrapped around him like a security blanket, one Mydei didn't want to give up.

“I will try. I may get answers, but this may be it. I don't want to try again after this.”

“It's ok, just take your time. I am behind you for whatever you choose. Anaxa, please take care of my son. Find him answers, please.”

With a short bow, he gave his sign of affirmation. “I will try my hardest. No information escapes me.” With his confirmation, she was comfortable enough to leave her son alone. The worry was still there, but she had a good feeling with Anaxa being there.

Trying to fix himself to look a bit more proper. His hair was readjusted, and pulling the shirt up on his shoulders. “Can I get you anything to eat? Please pull up a chair.”

Anaxa couldn't believe his eyes when the refrigerator was opened. One could swear it was from an industrial kitchen. So big that a sheet tray could fit in both ways and still have room. “There is freshly made pasta salad if you're interested. We will probably be here a while. I would like to take care of you while doing all this.”

Still trying to take in everything around him, Anaxa finally reminded himself that someone was talking. “Ohh, that will be perfect, thank you. I'm sorry. I'm just very distracted by this kitchen. I've never seen a house have so much ‘stuff’. Especially industrial grade.”

Placing the bowl with silverware in front of him and water, he walked back to the stool that once held his butt. “When I got this place, I wanted to make sure it was all restaurant-grade. I tend to cook a lot. So if I were to make something here, I can replicate it in any kitchen.”

“Very smart thinking. Just like your mother.” Reaching into his bag, a netbook was retrieved for taking notes. “Now, anything that is said between us stays that way. Even though your mother is my friend, YOU are my client. So, when discussing things, I'd prefer if you were as honest as possible. NO matter the details. I've seen and heard just about everything; nothing is a surprise at this point.” Mydei just watched in awe as the bowl was devoured in front of him. All the while talking, but never being rude.

“I understand. I thoroughly appreciate your transparency and protection of the information. Uhmmmmm…may I get you another bowl?” A small

laugh left him, seeing it already empty.

The look of confusion crossed Anaxa's face. When he looked down, everything was gone. Not that it was a small portion. It was a very full bowl. Now it just sat empty before him. ”Shit, I didn't even realize. It was so good. Ate it like popcorn. One bite and you can't stop. My compliments to the chef.”

“No need, it was something simple. Right now, I don't really feel much of anything. Numb really.” Letting his hair down, it could even be seen in the strands - there was no life in it either. Once adorning his head like a fiery sunset, now it was dull as a crayon drawing.

He walked over to the container and returned with another for his guest. “So if you wouldn't mind, please explain to me what's happened." Mydei was more than impressed with him; not only was he taking notes, but consuming the pasta at the same time. That is somebody being ambidextrous whom he's never seen. With kitchen things, yes. This was totally different.

“I suppose my mother told you the short of it.” A simple nod was his response. Anaxa was letting him talk before any questions. “I have been single all my life, and I had no interest in people. No one wanted me for me. It was all the money. So I kept doing the one thing I loved, and that made me happy.” He motioned around the kitchen and even to the second helping being destroyed.

Another fork-full disappeared, as the other hand was writing notes.

“I have known our IT manager for almost 8 years. And when I bought the house, I wanted him to do the security for it. There was something in his enthusiasm that…” Stares down at the oatmeal before him. Hoping in the slopping mess, he'd find the answers. “…drew me in. Why at that moment, I had no clue?”

All the while he is retelling the past month, Anaxa sits quietly and listens. Feeling sorry for the man- *no boy*- in front of him. So much of his life had to be dictated by others. Never really got to live for himself. Yes, he may

have the skills to run a business, but being a normal person, there was no book on it. He could tell by how shaken the voice was retelling everything, that this was his first ever crush, making this all the more heart breaking.

The conversation went by fairly quickly. A month of recounting sporadic meetings didn't take as long as some who were giving him a lifetime of information.

“May I interject a personal question?”

Mydei stopped mid though. Kind of lost in his eyes, like no one was home running the shop. “Please, if it will help.”

“So you knew he had cameras in the house before this past weekend. Did you, at any time, wonder how much he was seeing? Any time you engage in activities outside your room, I mean.” He had seen so many things over the years of helping people with their issues that matters of mature content didn't faze him.

“Honesty, no. It didn't cross my mind at all. The only time I can think of that wasn't in my room was the night he bailed on me. I had done things out on the pool deck.” His insides were thoroughly embarrassed. Never had he talked about anything sexual to a living person before. It was all kept locked up, for fear of saving face for the family. Mydei knew it had to be done to find answers.

“I see. What happened this past Monday? Since you had mentioned things changed this past week.” Writing in a netbook helped get more notes down and keep them organized. Much better than paper could ever be.

“Well, to be fair, I think it was partially the whole trip. The thing that broke everything was seeing him aroused on the balcony, then hearing him finish in the room next to mine. I was doing the same. Monday came around. I was at first suspicious when he mentioned things to my secretary that no one, outside of family, had seen.” Mydei couldn't stomach any more. He took the bowl over to the sink. Didn't really know if he'd take care of it later or not.

“I got an email that my camera systems were going to be down for a while. No big deal. When I got home later, during maintenance, there was beeping in my room. I searched, finding a camera hidden in the molding above the fireplace. Later, I found one in the bathroom.”

An eyebrow went up, but no words were said. Anaxa continued to write.

“I was concerned, but not upset by it. I’m still not sure why they are there in the first place. I considered my feelings about him and gave him a show all week. I was hoping to bring him here and….” The memories were flashing back. He had thought the rivers had dried up. No more tears could be found. Somehow, the storm brought it back for him. Starting slow and steady. Not fully ready to engulf him yet. His body was too weak to sustain him.

For the old man that he was, Anaxa could still be quick on his feet. He was over to Mydei in an instant. Trying to catch the body from hitting the floor. Going down with him, he tried to lower them both carefully. Without consuming much or sleeping, Anaxa knew the body in his arms was in no condition to stand.

For now, he just held the man in tears. Anaxa figured that at this point, Mydei had stopped caring. If he were to drown in the lake, then so be it. The best he could offer would be the ferryman keeping him afloat.

After a good 5 minutes of tears, he could hear them softening. “Can you stand? Continue this on the couch?” A small yes was all he heard. Helping the lion to his feet, Anaxa was amazed at the muscles on his body. He didn't figure the CEO had time to work out, but he was wrong.

Once, finally getting him to a better seat, even lying down, he retrieved his notes to continue.

“...and ask him out. But…. I think there was a major misunderstanding. Since I've been allowed to be my own person, at home, I've changed up my style some. I bought the pair of boots over by the door. When he got here, he thought they belonged to someone else. Also, the things I was doing via the cameras were for someone else as well.”

“They were all for him, I take it?” A nod. “Was there part of you that liked being watched?”

“Yes, for the first part. Complicated for the second. I don't think it's really exhibitionism, per se. I am thinking more because I knew HE was watching. No one else had ever made me feel that way. Also, I wouldn't do that normally.”

“If I can also ask, because I know it's a private space, may I go up to your room to see the camera?”

Slowly, Mydei made his way to standing. His body hurt in so many places. Like, instead of running a marathon, the marathon ran over him. One by one, he dragged a tired and starved body up the steps. Right now, he is cursing about getting a house with a second floor. Anaxa was right behind him, giving him balance along the way.

Once there, he sat on the bed. Catching his breath was hard. “If you go to the top left corner, run your fingers along the seam of the molding, eventually you will push down.”

“While I do some work on this, please continue.” His lithe digits got to work, looking for the object in question.

“I think it shocked him that I found them, and more so that I wanted to date him. His response was quick and cruelly visceral towards himself. I tried to stop him, to tell him how much I cared and wanted him. It's his response that hurt the most….. “ Deep breathing could be heard. Anaxa could tell the worst part was coming. Keeping his back to Mydei was probably for the better. “....he was sorry that I cared for someone like him. I deserved way better. He called himself ….” A few tears rolled down his cheek” …. rotten and a monster.”

All of the intricacies Anaxa was doing screeched to a halt. He couldn't believe the words he heard. For as brilliant as his mind was, there would be no cause for that. From what he had heard, both men were just sad and lonely. They just so happened to find a common ground and desperately

wanted it to be more. The extreme negativity was breaking all those gears. Now he could see why both Gorgo and Mydei were concerned.

He knew that this was a sensitive subject, but had to be dealt with swiftly before either man, particularly the more guarded one, did something extreme.

Hooking up a cable to the camera, he let the notebook do some work. ”I am deeply sorry that this -well any of this- had to happen so poorly. I know of TTC and Phainon. They may be smart with security, but I am just a tad bit better.”

Mydei looked at him, confused. “Are you a hacker?”

“Uhmmmm… nnnnoo? I used to work for them a long time ago. So, I know things about the ins and outs of security. How can it be breached? So then, in turn, fixing it. Plus, as a private investor, I have to have ways of finding things I need. Nothing stops me in the pursuit of knowledge.”

“Look, I don't care if he ever accepts me. He probably won't. I……I just want him to be ok and not think so poorly of himself or worse. So, what if he has weird kinks...a lot of people do. I feel, though, he would never do anything to hurt anyone. Hell, I had a hard time getting him in the car with me.” Mydei readjusted himself on the bed.

Anaxa's mind lit up. Information was being added to the puzzle.”Car issues?? What do you mean?”

“I'm not sure.. if he isn't driving, his anxiety spikes hard. The only way I got, the long trip there and back, with him, was that he slept. Does that help things?” Mydei figures anything, no matter how small, can be of help.

“Yes, it does. Now I have the gist of the issue. My book is done downloading what it needs. Can I leave to do more work, or do I need to stay and babysit? “ A small smile adorned his face. Hoping the joke would help lighten the mood.

“No, I am fine. Just exhausted, and my whole body hurts from crying. If you need to leave, please do what you need to. I assume all the stuff that can help you isn't here. So, do what you must. I'll be ok.”

“If you go to bed, it will help me a lot. You can think more clearly with a rested mind and body. If you don't take care of one, the other will fail.” The wall was replaced as it was. “Do you know if any of the cameras are still working?

“I think maybe only the one at the entrance outside and at the gate. There was a quiet humming I could feel when the system was active. Now, the house is mostly silent.” Crawling up the bed, he sank into the blankets strewn about on it. Mydei was hoping that with exhaustion, sleep would come easier.

“Get some rest. If I find….. out…” His words were cut off by soft breathing. Coming around the bed, the lion was out. Maybe finding that little bit of hope, let his mind unfurl itself a bit and finally rest. He pulled the blanket up over him, gathering his things, and leaving just as quietly as he arrived.

~~~~~

Paying attention to the code she used on the door it was easy to remember. Locking the door behind him, he could feel all the emotion hanging in the situation. So much uncertainty was worrisome.

“I need to get back to my big computer. I have questions that need answering.”

“*Hacking”* the gate was no problem. With how the situation was and from what the netbook picked up, a lot of the system was down or deleted. Even with it offline, he was still able to extract data from it. It was a way to follow the trail back to the source.

Once back in his abode, Anaxa made quickwork with the information he was provided. To further help his investigation, he went to the TTC employee portal.
~~~~~

It still existed in his bookmarks, just in case. Seems his forward thinking paid off. The backdoor code surprisingly still worked. *Ppfft, they haven't changed anything in years?! I'm shocked. At least getting this information will be easy.*

Going off the already known information, the manager's section was easy to find. There were things in place keeping him from going deeper. He was not detoured by just a little locked code. Considering that he helped build the site ages ago. Some new things may have been added, but still the same.

A few quick command codes entered, accessing the managers' profiles was no issue. There almost at the very top.

Branch Manager: Khaslana, Phainon

Clicking into it, all information was available to him now.

“Let's see what all we are working with. He started that young and became head so quickly. Smart kid. Just as I thought too. He's around Mydei's age. Graduated from tech school early. Wait… what was it…” Pulling out the netbook, his notes gave him the information he was looking for. “His parents have been deceased for at least 5 years and are in the local graveyard. On here, though, there is no emergency contact.“

Pulling up a few more menus, it showed all the changes to the page and when it was updated. Sure enough, 5 years ago, the contacts were removed. Before then, it showed 2 names:

-Audata Khaslana, Mother

-Ierón Khaslana,Father

While pulling up a tab on the other monitor, Anaxa pulled up what information he could find on both of them. Lucky for him, it was very detailed. It showed they were immigrants to the area. His father was a farmer, and his mother did some farm work but was also a baker. More information was found on another page.

“Soooo, our tech wizard was adopted. Interesting. I wonder if I can find those adoption papers.”

Going by where their address was located, he searched around for orphanage adoptions 30ish years ago. There were a few places around where his parents lived that had children adopted at the time. The first place he checked was a bust. No good information was sourced. The second and third brought no fruit to his labor either. The fourth, there was the hint he was looking for.

Glancing over at the clock, it was already midnight. He'd been at it since he got back at six in the evening. Once he was hooked on a thing, there was no stopping.

Reading down through the information, what he found clicked so hard in his mind.

“No wonder he doesn't like anyone else driving. Poor boy was in a car wreck so young.” He tried very hard with all of his cases not to get attached, but something about this did tug at his heartstrings.

“He was the only survivor.”

Everything that Mydei had described fit into the puzzle now with this. Doing a bit more digging from the adoption papers, he found a crash report. At least this was detailed information.

So witnesses around note that his family's car was not in the wrong. They were hit head-on by a drunk driver. Because both cars stopped in an instant, the ones behind the family had no time to react. Smashing the back end. When emergency responders got on the scene, all tried to extract anyone from the wreckage.

Driver of car 1:

Perished on impact. The autopsy report showed alcohol levels 3 times the legal limit.

Driver of car 3:

Minor concussion and laceration on the right side of their face. Whiplash was evident. The body was stressed over impact. Survived.

Family of car 2:

Driver: male, mid 20s. Impact from the collision trapped him against the wheel. Was only alive for a short while after the crash. Died at the scene.

Front passenger: Female, mid 20s. Were able to extract from the car, internal bleeding. Only made it to the hospital. Perished

Back seat passenger 1: Female, very young. Thrown into the seat in front, causing concussions. Had glass from the window in her back. Internal bleeding was also found at the hospital. Passed not long after arriving.

Back seat passenger 2: Male, very young. Was stuck between front seats, glass from the back window embedded in his backside. Minor concussion. Was non-responsive for a time. Only survivor.

“Well, that explains his fear of anyone else driving. He has survivor's guilt. I'm very surprised at how well his mental state is, considering what he went through. I'm beginning to believe that's why he believes no one should be with him. Blames himself for everything. Maybe also that's why his sexual experiences are left to himself and behind a monitor. It's no one but him.”

Sitting back in his chair, he looks over everything. Yes, this case was easy, given his connection to the TCC, but he felt more needed done somehow. Yes, the case had been ‘figured out’ , but that didn't stop a nagging feeling he had.

“Well, I got the answers. I'll go see the lion in the morning. One, to check on him. Two, go over this information and see where we can take it.”

Sending all the info he found to the work folder, everything was logged out and put back in its place. He never leaves a trail when looking for information. When transfers were complete, he too made his way to bed. A lot was going through his mind on how to handle both of them.

Love is a very fickle mistress.

Chapter End Notes

Author's note:
-His adopted patients' names are the same as his real ones from the game. Except for his dad. His name in the game is Hieronymus, but doing a search for the name, it showed me all different spellings of it. This is part of the modern Greek translation: Ιερώνυμος (Ierónymos)

Anaxa, true to his word found the source of Phainon's troubles. Its always the decision when something bad happens, do you tell the party involved or not? How will it affect them? In this instance, not good. Hopefully, telling his findings to the sad lion will help some. But with a broken heart, is there a band-aid big enough?

Sanku so much for still coming along for the ride. We are getting closer to the end. 4 more chapters left. Will it ever work out between them? Or forever be alone?

❤❤

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 14

Chapter Summary

> Eveything still hurt. Mydei still feels the sting of what happned. Not only had a friend died when he was younger, now his once chance at being happy with another person is gone forever. After a shower his tired body goes down stairs to an odd smell. Anaxa was in his kitchen cooking him breakfast. After the small exchange, they go over what he had found.... he feels a bit better but still lost.

Chapter Notes

> no beta read

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The early morning rays tried to shine through the window. With the dark red curtains, not much made it in. Throwing off the covers, Mydei couldn't breathe.

“God.. I'm so warm. Why the..???” Looking down at the rest of his body, he fell asleep in what he had on yesterday. Exhaustion took over, and he slept. He couldn't even remember when it happened. Last thing he knew, Anaxa was talking to him about something, and then blank.

He wishes his dreams were as such. Seeing the past weekend again made his heart sink. It was the best time and feelings that have happened in a long time. He never knew that hanging around a person who meant a lot to you could also give the same feelings of putting on that white coat in the shiny steel jungle.

Once he finally finished culinary school and could wear that white jacket proudly, he did. Food was his passion in life. It was the most freeing cooking, creating meals, and serving the public. Sharing things that were part of his life with someone and that they were enthusiastic about it, made

his heart soar. This was the same feeling. Something about that white-haired man was infectious. It drew him in. He wanted to be a part of it.

He knew now that hope was lost. Phainon would probably never speak to him again. Worse off would probably put in for a transfer to escape what has happened between them. He figured that it was the major line he crossed. Trying to be more than friends wasn't on the terms he agreed. He broke that verbal contract. Now has to deal with the consequences.

Rolling over, his phone said 8:15am. What was beside it brought tears through a sad smile, the smallest he could muster. A small, white origami dog sat by his phone. Phainon had made it when they were going to eat breakfast at the hotel. Stopping in the book section of the hotel, he caught Phainon taking a picture in a book and couldn't tell what it was. Somewhere between that small library and the dining hall, paper was found. Being buffet style, Phainon told him to go first.

He thought it was weird, but didn't think anything of it. In about 5 minutes, he was joined. Asking Phainon if he wanted him to stay, he said no. The brightest smile was on his face. Since the table was chosen, Mydei could make a quick trip to the bathroom before eating. Phainon was up at the tables when he got back. But what was waiting for him, Mydei felt like his heart was shot over and over again with Eros' arrow. Phainon found a diagram for an origami dog. Just so happens that he made it out of white paper, matching his hair.

"I guess this is all I have left of him." Soft tears rolled down his face onto the pillow. "I guess it's time to lock it away. Caring about others only makes bad things happen. Hephaestion died, and now Phainon thinks he is a monster. He'll probably remove himself from my life entirely." Slugging his way out of bed, everything hurt, but not as much as the day prior. Trying to get out of his clothes, a shower would help try to relax his body, possibly his mind.

The marble seat on his butt was cold; he was at least glad his body had some feeling. Turning the knob on the wall, the shower head over the seat turned on. It was like a soft rain across his body. *Sorry father, you are not getting what you desire. I'm not doing this again. I'm dedicating myself to*

the restaurants, and that's it. Food and work will be my life. There is no room for love in this Kremnoan's life.

Getting redressed, his favorite pair of jeans was put on with an oversized black zipped hoodie. Colors of red, black, gold, and white were strewn about his shirt like paint splatters on a wall. Hair was up in a messy bun. Glasses sat on his head in case needed them. Right now, his eyes still hurt.

Descending the stairs, he smelled something in the kitchen. Walking in, a more casually dressed investigator was making him breakfast.

“Anaxa?? What?? I… don't understand?”

“I see the lion crawled out of the den finally. You look more alive than yesterday. I take it the 14-hour nap helped?” Eggs were stirred in the pan. Mydei meandered over to the stools, pulling a tired body into them.

“Look, not that I don't appreciate this, but I don't…..”

“Need anything from anyone? I figured you'd feel that way. That's why I didn't ask beforehand. Self-loathing will do that to you.” Grabbing a plate, eggs, and 2 pieces of toast were placed in front of him. “Don't argue and eat. You need it. I really don't want to have to call your mother. “

A small snoot was shot his way. Anaxa smiled, finishing his own plate, mildly smirking. “You do look better. I'm sure your head hasn't changed much.” He sat down beside the tired lion.

Twirling some of the eggs on his fork, a long sigh left his lips. “Pretty much. I've resigned myself to just living for my job. It's the only thing that has always been there. I've never felt sad about it. I've never been upset at getting hurt with it. I know what it feels like. I tried to swim in the ocean but ended up drowning.”

“Eat first, then we can go over what I found.”

Partway through their silent meal, a small vibration sounded against the counter. Flipping the phone over, the smallest smile graced the sad face.

“Can I ask?” Mint hair swayed softly in front of his face.

“My secretary. She just sent some emojis. A purple heart, a butterfly, and a single flower. She cares.”

“That's very sweet of her. See, you are cared for. No need to be so hard on yourself.”

Finishing his last bite, he took the plates over to the sink. To his surprise, all other dishes were done. It was empty. Anaxa had done them for him. He shouldn't have gotten angry. So much was brewing inside his head that it was hard not to have visceral emotions over it.

Sighing, his tired body went out to the couch to lie down. His guest was soon to follow. Sitting down on the reclining chair, Anaxa told himself he needed to get one. The comfort on it was exquisite.

“Are you prepared for my findings?”

“ You have stuff already?? God, you’re quick.”

“Well, when you've been doing it as long as I have, my fingers find everything I need.” Anaxa knew what sly comment was made. He was hoping it might bring some laughter to the sad lion.

“Sir…. That was dirty.” That small smile came back, even just for a second.

“It was?? I wasn't aware.” *I was totally aware.* “So the short version of it all is he is just like you.” Mydei's head rolled on the seat cushion, staring dumbfounded at the statement. “You both feel you can't have anyone in your life. Yours is because of status. His is because of survivor's guilt and slight mental insecurities.”

The words ' survivor's guilt’ made him sit straight up. This is the first he's ever heard of this. His own issues pale in comparison to hearing those words. “Now, just because his stuff sounds worse. Doesn't mean it's **worse** than the other. You both have experienced something that has greatly

affected your lives and changed who you are, how you feel about yourselves and others.”

Mydei just sat silent at the words being told to him. Anaxa wasn't wrong. It was just hard not to feel that way when everything had been good up until this point, and then went horribly south.

“The other short of it all. He has survivor's guilt from a car wreck that left him scarred and an orphan.” At those final words, Mydei's heart broke worse than it already had. Knowing that Phainon lost everyone he loved. He was the only one left. Having body and mind scars from it…. Feels like he can’t have anyone ever.”

“I guess that's why he rejected me. It hurts a little less now…. But….”

“I get it. It's gonna sting. At least you know. Here is a detailed report of what I found.” Anaxa hands him 2 papers detailing all his findings. With the car wreck and the adoption in his hand, Mydei wanted to love this man harder. Someone so young, having all their world destroyed and trying to live knowing so much got taken. He did deserve all the love, but he knew it was over for them before it had any chance.

~~~~~~~

Getting up hurt. Every scar on his back made themselves known. Not one part of his being didn't feel like shit. Phainon was mad at himself for so many reasons. The biggest one of all was alone in a house in the woods.

He broke the prince's heart and made him cry.

That sweet smile that just lit up his whole life, he will never see again. Toying with the idea of quitting or staying played over and over in his mind. He wanted to stay, but now that Mydei knew about his voyeurism and the cameras, he'd never look at Phainon the same way again. Nothing more than a pervert getting things so many have dreamed of.

Quitting was his other option. Then there would be no more problems at the office. No one would see his sordid face. This option, his prince……
~~~~~~~

No….noo… I can't say that anymore. I got so many nice things from him, and what did I do?? I fucking broke his heart. I have no right calling him that anymore. I can't let either of us get hurt. I'm a curse. I had to. You can't love a monster like me. I get people killed and spy on others having sex. What is there to fucking love??

Phainon wishes so hard that he could just reach his hand in, pulling out his heart and leaving it under a dome. Never to be seen or touched again. He didn't need it. All it brought was pain to everyone.

Flipping his phone on, it was now Friday. Time was lost to him. Days were a blur. Phainon couldn't even remember when he last ate. Trying to bear the weight of his world has crushed him. He wasn't strong enough.

Opening his email, there at the top was the reminder about the company party. It was a week away. “Maybe I'll go for the first and final time. Get my goodbyes in before I send my request to be switched to a new client. I have lived this long with that crushing weight of my sins on my shoulder; I'll just roll my ball somewhere else. Maybe it won't be so heavy there.”

His whole being stopped. With his phone being held above his face, back flat on the bed, arms stretched out, something caught his eye.

His wrist.

Or more about what he was wearing.

There was a little girl selling bracelets she made with just embroidery thread at the hotel. Mydei bought one for him before they left. Saying they were now even for the origami dog. It was small, simple, but so intricate. She had a way of mixing red and black with white and blue. *It's… it's…. Our colors. He even tied it on my wrist. I was so upset about everything, I forgot it was there.*

“God dammit!!!” Setting the phone down beside himself rubbing his hands all over his face in frustration. “I don't know what to do? Mom would have the answers. She always did. Firstly, she would tell me how much of a jerk I am for breaking his heart. Secondly, get told I need to stop worrying and

follow what my heart desires. Stop living in the past. Live for the here and now.” Phainon knew with his aliments, it was hard for him to want to trust anyone else with his burdens. It was his and his to share alone.

“Deimos, why do you try so hard? Why do you want to try with me? You could have anyone you wanted. Anyone in the world, but me? I just don't get it. Hell, you even shared a lot of your life with me. No one probably sees that.”

Running the strings between his fingers, the thread was soft and vibrant. *I at least owe him an apology before I leave. I'll go just for that. I can't take it any further; it will just hurt him more. One final time, one last dance before the villain bows out. Crushed by the weight of his own desires.*

Picking the phone back up, his company website was brought up. Typing in his info, he got to the payroll ledger. He never took time for anything. Compared to others he worked with, Phainon had a gross amount of vacation and sick time. Seeing the numbers available, he knew one more week was what he needed. Go to the party Friday night, probably break the heir's heart more. Saturday, go to the office and clean all his stuff out. Monday morning, go back to TTC and get a new client or just stay in the main office. Maybe never take clients again, just oversee operations.

“ It's the only way to save what little soul I have left. Be it damned otherwise.”

~~~~~~~~

Inputting the numbers she was working on got interrupted by an email notification. Clicking over to it, her heart got a bit sadder. The IT manager was taking another week off. Something deep inside told her things were going from bad to worse. Castorice didn't like the feeling at all. The boss was only technically back on Monday. She got confirmation from him that he was going to the closest restaurant branch to begin the prep for the party. So he was in, but not really.

She needed to make a phone call.
~~~~~~~~

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

《RING》

Mama G:

Afternoon, my dear.

How are things?

Cass:

Not so good.

I know you've been

handling the boss's issue on your end.

Getting him to be 'functional' again.

I just got an email that

Phainon is taking another week off.

The TTC HR did inform me in the email,

he does have time to use.

I just have a very, very bad feeling about it all.

Mama G:

God dammit all.

I'm just getting Mydei back to normal functioning without crying

and Phainon is probably going to do something stupid.

Cass:

He is probably going to get himself removed from this contract.

Just to take another week out of the blue.

When I doubt, either have seen the other since the Sunday of the trip.

Mama G:

Castorice, my dear, let me tell you a little life secret.

Men have always been this difficult.

My husband can be just as bad.

If it were up to me, I'd have those two together in an instant.

They are grown men; they have to sort out their feelings on their own.

I AM, though, going to intervene a little.

If I have to…but I'll hold it and see.

But thank you for letting me know.

Cass:

Any time, Mama.

Your son is a very sweet person.

Gives up so much for others,

I'd hope sometime he would do something special for himself.

I think it is him.

I have to go do a bit more work.

Please keep me updated.

《CLICK》

There was still something that bothered her. The best she could do was sit and wait. Cass was very much hoping she could do more, but it's all out of her hands.

~~~~~~~~

Anaxa spent the weekend with Mydei, helping him go over his feelings and the things that had transpired. Also, to make sure he looked like a normal person again and not a corpse, sleeping weird and not really eating wasn't helping him get better.

By the time Monday was finally here, Mydei looked normal again, albeit his heart was still broken. He knew that would take time. The worry still clung to him that he'd never see Phainon again. Even if it wasn't in his life. Mydei had to prepare himself for the possibility that an email would come to him that the IT manager would quit this project and would be replaced soon.

That's the part that stung the most. There must have been something there for Phainon to pull away so hard. The moments that they shared couldn't have been fake. At least he hoped they weren't.

Yes, he was a lion on Kremnos. Always prideful. Always ready to take on a challenge. Never backing down. Till now. This was something he wanted to dump his heart into. Take care of it. Spend time. This time, though, the lion had to back down for fear of the unknown.

Putting on his work pants, a thin black turtleneck, with no sleeves, adorned his torso. And to finish it all, his black chef's jacket was lined in golden thread. Looking at himself in the mirror, he had the confidence to get the work done for his people. They have done so much to support the restaurant and him that it was his turn to give back.
~~~~~~~~

The trip to the closest kitchen was a short one. There was one in town, only a few blocks from his offices. There were many nights, after being a businessman for a whole day, toiling away at the mountains of paperwork to keep everything running smoothly, he would end up in the kitchen. Sleeves rolled up, hair tied back, and not leaving till the last customer had left the building. While doing orders, every time he graced the kitchen to help, he always made some sort of pastry early in the evening to share with everyone who worked in the whole house. Not just the back.

Some places had the division between back and front of the house, 1st/2nd/3rd shifts, but not in his houses. Everyone was part of the team and knew it. If a concern from the ground ever reached him, he went personally to take care of it. No one was better than others when it came to being taken care of. Luckily for him, most issues never made it past the house. All taken care of, not wanting the boss to see to it personally.

Stepping out of the car, his gaze shifted skyward. Grey clouds were coming to settle in. The forecast for most of the week was rain. It never bothered him. It always made for a good afternoon nap or a long slumber. No matter the intensity, it was always a comforting blanket to him.

When he stepped into the building at 6 am, most of the staff were waiting for him in the dining room. They all pitched in for the party. Even the bussers contributed to it. Everyone in the company always looked forward to these events, so helping in any way they could made it that much more rewarding.

“Morning, Kyros. Surprised to see you this early.” Shaking the hand in front of him.

“Sir. Well, it's a busy week, and the more hands on deck, the better. The supplier got all the things you requested on Friday. The menus have been set and broken down for what needs to be done at the earliest and what needs to be done at the last minute. We were just waiting for you to assign tasks to get started.”

“See, this is why I leave you in charge. You always have it handled for me.”

“Well, you are here to be a chef, not a general manager. The kitchen is ready for you.”

Hearing his voice, the rest of the staff gathered in the dining room for the morning meeting. Once everyone was here, Kyros gave him a nod to start.

“Morning, everyone. I want to thank each and everyone of you for your help this week. The next 4 days will be busy. Between prepping for the party and still being open, everyone is valuable. Anything you contribute to the party will help make things easier to get to the finish. Some of you may be new and have not met me yet. I may carry the name of Kremnos, but any who knows me know the kitchen is my passion more than running the company. I am just like your chefs. Nothing more. When this jacket is on, that's my role. If you need anything, please come see me. Even if it is just to say hi and introduce yourself. I'd be more than happy to meet you.”

There was much cheering from everyone in the room. The energy to make this the best party it could be was infectious. A few new people go together in a small group to go meet the head of the company before getting to work. Everyone in the small group couldn't believe the type of person the CEO was. He was nothing like they had seen in other places.

Once everything was settled, he got to work. The menu was long for the 100+ people who would be there for the event. Everyone needed to be taken care of. It is why he does this in the first place. If your people are taken care of, everyone prospers.

The other side of the coin, though, kept his mind off the thing he really wanted and was concerned about. So much would be happening over 4 days, Mydei wouldn't have time to dwell on the “*what if’s*?”. Food was his focus; that's where it needed to stay.

Except for things with pomegranate.

There weren't many, but the few that did brought his mind back to that weekend. How the fruit was eaten in the orchard, excitement over the gelato, the wine….he tried to blink those thoughts away. They didn't matter now. That friendship was over. He was ready to be cut out of Phainon's life

forever. All he had now was beautiful memories that hurt like a knife slowly carving its way into the skin. It's there, it hurts, but eventually his nerves would give out. Not feeling the pain anymore. Right now, it was too fresh.

Time heals all wounds. Maybe….. but I never got over Hephaestion.… So what makes this.…him...any different?

~~~~~~~~~~

Regardless of how negative he felt about the whole situation, that bracelet never left his wrist. Something about it felt warm, comforting.

“So the party is tomorrow night. Am I ready for this?? Fuck no… I'm not. I'm scared as hell. I don't want to do this, but I have to, to protect him. It isn't that I don't want him, I do.” Phainon leaned his head against the shower wall. Neither heat nor cold did anything to help with how he was feeling. Everything felt so dead inside. The one person who had reached out the hardest, he broke.

“There is no way to fix this. I don't even know why I'm entertaining the idea to go…. It's probably mom and dad. Maybe.” The cold water ran down his back like a river flowing from a mountain, finding its way through all the muscles and scars on his back, looking for a way to head south. Snow white hair clung to his neck. His forehead was searching for the coolness of tiles on the wall.

He had been nursing a small headache across his forehead all week. It's all from the stress of the situation, but mostly his crying. Everything hurt. This is the worst he's felt in a long time. Not since his parents passed.

Turning off the water, he just stood there. Forcing his body to do anything constructive on these vacation days was a chore. It should have been considered sick time, but he had more vacation time to burn.

The only towel on him was the one drying some of the water off. Being in this apartment alone and on the top floor, he wasn't worried about anyone seeing him.
~~~~~~~~~~

Walking past the closet door made him pause. The outfit he had chosen to wear to this was hanging as a reminder. It was chosen when he was in a better frame of mind. When a partially happier him wanted to attend, just to see the boss. Now it was just for goodbyes.

White pants hung from the door. They looked brighter against the lights dancing in his room from the street below. Soft gold thread connected the fabric together, giving it a statue feel. A small star charm came from the belt loop to his pocket.

A gift from his mother. Being her star in the sky.

She always had to be with him in some way. Not that his father didn't care, she was just way more expressive about it. Of course, the dog they had was the most forward about his love for Phainon. That was ok in his book. He never had to explain anything. Just an unspoken bond between man and beast.

The silk under his fingers was exquisite. One of the few things that wasn't tech, he splurged on. The black shirt had a higher collar than most shirts, but it was styled that way. Gold thread was used for seams, which made the outfit match as a whole. Darkness and light. An allegory for his own life.

“Why not go out with a bang? Not like I will see anyone from there after tomorrow. Why don't I do a rope choker and gloves? Why the fuck not?”

Walking over to the window, he stared at the life below him. Everyone goes about their daily lives, cars lighting up the ground like the night sky. Everything was peaceful behind glass. Quiet. Serene. Not a feeling he felt often. It felt as though Mother Nature decided to cry along with him. Small rivers flowed down the glass, mirroring his own soul.

“Maybe I should move back home, work remotely? I wouldn't have to worry about physical interactions anymore, unless it's on my terms. No worries.”

Slipping on a pair of white boxers, he needed a drink before bed. The quiet hum of the refrigerator was all that could be heard in his small apartment.

All other electric items were off.

Just before opening the door, his heart slowed its beats. He forgot that on the counter were the rest of the pomegranates from the trip. Running his fingers over the fruit, he could see the laughter and smiles Mydei gave him from eating it like a crazy man, making a mess everywhere. His lips pulled in his mouth. He didn't know which direction he wanted. Sad about his choices or happy about the memories.

Both hurt.

It was time to make the last happy dream he'll have.

Chapter End Notes

> Both boys are in such a state right now. They don't know where to go with their emotions. Yes, they are hard, but it's what makes us human. The party is soon, will it fix anything?

> Thank you for reading!! It's almost done....thank you for coming along for the ride. ❤

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 15

Chapter Summary

> It is time to face the music. Phainon decided he is going to look his hottest to tell the man he was(still is) hopelessly in love with that this will be their final meeting. This is goodbye.
>
> What he wasnt prepared for was what will happen on the other side of the entrance doors.

Chapter Notes

> No beta read.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Twilight Courtyard Convention Center. Never thought I'd have to come here for anything.” Taking a deep breath, hands still tight on the steering wheel, he got the first step done by at least being in the parking lot. So many cars were around him. Every employee was invited to it. No one was left out. It was the one day a year when all 5 of the restaurants were closed.

The venue was big enough to carry a small event like this. There were some bigger companies and trade shows that used this building as well. 100+ people weren't an issue. Being that the family is a big part of things going on in the city, everyone was actually fighting to host it. Somehow, Twilight won above the others. Every year, they always look forward to hosting this.

“Why wouldn't you? When your CEO is this selfless, it makes sense.”

His wandering thoughts get cut off by the sound of his text message alert. *Who could possibly want me? Unknown number??*

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

430-XXX-XXX

Taking a risk is all a part of life. It is what makes us human. If you shut out the sun, what will grow? There is no labor of love without a bit of strife. When you persevere, glory will be delivered to your future. You fought for what mattered most. Will you take that leap into the sun? Embrace its warmth like flowing wheat fields? Or let the tides of darkness consume another victim. You are strong enough to get what is yours.

Will you take it?

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

He reread the message over and over. This person knows who he is. They are dropping hints that they know things, very aware of the situation he was in. Part of him was shocked that he was found. Once he got the number of the current phone, he made it untraceable because of the content he enjoyed, covering his tracks.

Who is better than me and knows about what's going on? I don't like it that they are maybe right. I need to get in there and get this done. The sooner I say goodbye to everyone and break his heart for a second time, the sooner I'm leaving.

Giving himself one final look in the mirror, he got out. Adjusts the ribbon collar and gloves. Going out with a bang is what he was after. The buttons on the front of his shirt were dangerously low, even for him, not starting till after his pecks. Much of his chest could be seen. He hid the good looks behind a computer screen. They draw too much attention.

I'm ready.

~~~~~~

Scanning his badge at the door, he was allowed in. They found it the safest way to know who's coming and going. Also, to prevent anyone from getting in to start trouble. Many security measures were taken.

Everyone was dressed up for this occasion, so bringing his best wasn't out of place.
~~~~~~

Once inside, it smelled heavenly. The far corner was the buffet of food. Anything you could possibly imagine.

This is from all the love from their head chef, amazing. Why did I fall for the sweet one? Is there really any room in his heart for me? No.. I broke it, remember.

The party was already well underway by the time he decided to show up. At least an hour to two had already passed. Many were just now eating, some were mingling, and others took to the dance floor. Everyone was having a good time.

His cerulean eyes scanned the area. He knew what was being hunted.

The buffet….???? No. How about the dance floor?? Nothing there either. So I guess that just leaves the tables and groups.

He started at the far end nearest the food, slowly scanning his eyes around, looking for a sunset in a sea of color and lights. Just when all hope was lost, there it was.

Found you.

In a back corner was a group of people and the man of the party. Moving through the crowd, a stool was found in the opposite corner. Sitting by the wall, from his angle, Mydei could be clearly seen.

He looks so good. Dressed in an all-black three-piece suit. Dark red tie. I think that's his lion pin that's on most of his jackets. Kinda funny, he matches mine in gold trim. There are too many to go over now. I'll wait. I've heard some don't leave till almost 3 am. Party while you can, I suppose….

He stayed glued to his chair the whole time. A waiter came by a few times to offer him anything to drink. He just took water. He wanted a clear head to ruin the night.

Something about this group bothered him. Popping open his phone, he did some quick work accessing the signed in guest list. He skipped through the

restaurant's employees. The people around him looked important. In the other section, people were invited guests. Some of the pictures started lining up. Some were shareholders in the whole family business. Others seemed to be important friends of his father's.

The one, though, was sending an itch under his skin. Phainon had been there an hour, just watching. And the one man standing close to Mydei was too close.

Who the fuck does this bitch think he is? He is practically on top of him. He's been inching closer over the past twenty minutes. Trying to keep a smiling face. Ppft, that's the face of an ugly, smug bastard. Thinks he is gonna get places. Just because he is….. wait!!

He remembered a conversation that they had a while ago. He had mentioned that Mydei's father wanted him to marry, but his mother just wanted him to follow his heart. Looking through the names again. The older man beside him was his father. He's a business partner of Eurypon's. The younger man was his son.

More tabs opened, something about this guy was bothering Phainon to his core. Yes, he was 'good looking', but something about the face said he had an ugly soul.

Let's see here….

With a few more clicks, the fire of anger was being stoked. He knows he shouldn't be mad or jealous, but when he said Mydei deserved better, it wasn't this.

This… this...bastard was kicked out of and forbidden from going into a brothel? The fuck did he do? Assaulted the workers and forced them into acts that were not authorized by the establishment. There were rules to follow, and he broke them…..

There was more information about the charges against him, but like any person of power, his dad got him out of it. Now he has his eyes set on Mydei.

Glancing back at the group, his hand was going slowly lower every few minutes and was almost over his backside. The coat Mydei was wearing only covered part of it. He also noticed there was something in Mydei's body language that Phainon didn't like as well.

The lion was trapped in a cage of hospitality and had no means of escape. The grossness kept him close. Too many were around to make a scene.

Then he snapped. The hand was placed on him. Not hovering, he could see the indent of fingers in the fabric. Phainon saw a quick body jump when the hand made contact; he was done.

That's it. I've had enough. I may not be what he needs… but that cesspool of sin isn't having the prince. No way. No how.

Pushing aside all doubt in his mind, his focus was just on saving Mydei from the situation. He had to be suave, but forceful.

“So, Master Kremnos, your father tells me you have yet to settle down. I think a strapping young man like you would be a great fit for anyone. Even including my so…n...” The old man got cut off.

“Pardon the intrusion,” Phainon's slick golden voice pierced the conversation. “This party is absolutely wonderful, Mydei.”

The amber eyes just stared in shock. Mydei thought he had drunk too much, but he hadn't touched anything. The one person he was giving up hope on seeing was right in front of him. Looking more dashing than ever.

“And just who are you, young sir? I don't think you have enough position to call Master Kremnos by a nickname.” The old man was clearly pissed at the interruption. His son was, too. Trying to play it off cool. Phainon took note of where his hand still was.

“Ohh me?? No one special.”

“Then maybe we should ask you to leave our private conversation, then.” The snark from his son, who was just asking for a punch to the face.

“Sorry, I didn't get to finish before I was cut off.” The brightest smile adorned his face. “I am Phainon Khaslana, one of 3 head managers at Telesaltes Technology Company, and just so happen to be the holder of Evernight Restaurants’ security contract. Pleasure.”

Mydei was stunned by what he was seeing. A side of Phainon he didn't know existed. *What in all of Fury's name is going on here? I have to be in a dream. He…. He looks amazing. Why does he look...mad? There is something behind that smile.*

The whole group was stunned. The TTC was a very highly respected company. With some of the brightest people working there, they could be a force to be reckoned with if need be. And to have one of their managers here was taking them all aback.

“The night is still young, and I was hoping to borrow the Prince of Kremnos for a dance.” Phainon was taking that leap. He was climbing those chains again, afraid to fall. He so desperately wanted the hand to reach out for his.

“If you will excuse me, I would love to accept this request.” Quickly as he could, Mydei pulled his body away from the hand trying to molest him secretly.

They both silently walked to the far end of the dance floor. Mydei wrapped his arms around Phainon's neck, feeling his hand gently placed around his waist, and he smiled. Like they were meant to be.

Mydei looked up at the blue eyes he was very fond of, the blush coming back to his face.

“Uhmm, hi, I didn't know you arrived.”

Trying to calm his nerves, he noticed the soft pink dusting his cheeks. “I have been here for a while, doing security.”

“On what? This place is already….”

“For you.”

“Ohh, I see. You didn't…..”

“No, I had to. That piece of trash had you cornered with nowhere to run. I saw him touching you.” Mydei looked down at the statement, knowing it was right. Also, looking down seeing how low the shirt was unbuttoned wasn't helping right now.

A soft blush was dusted on his cheeks and now ears.

“Why did you step in?? I….” The words wanted to come out, but it hurt. “Can we go talk somewhere?”

A small nod was all it took for them to disappear from the room. Mydei walked with his puppy in tow, down a long, unlit hallway. At the very end was an office. Grabbing the handle, it was unlocked. He opened the door, letting his puppy go in first. Mydei soon followed, locking it behind them. Luckily for them both, there were no windows on the inside of the building. The far wall had some long paneled ones, seeing the city before them, still lighting up the night sky at this hour. People are still hard at work. Such was life.

Phainon leaned back against the wall, right foot propped up on it. Mydei sat on the conference desk, resting his feet on a chair.

“There is no one here but us, and the room is soundproof. We can discuss anything.”

“Well, to answer you honestly, if I didn't have better self-control, I may have started a fight. I've been here for about an hour…. Watching you.”

“Seems you can't get enough of watching me, can you?” There was a soft playfulness to his words. Mydei was hoping they would be taken as harsh.

“Yeah, you're right. I can't. So I did some digging on your guests. The old guy is a friend of your dad's and that…..” He tried to hold back his words.

“Piece of shit?” It was Phainon's turn to be stunned.

“I was going to say ugly cess pool of sin, but that works too…. is his son. I'm figuring they want to get you two hooked up since you defy your father's wishes.”

“Yea, pretty much. I wanted to punch him in the face when his hand touched my back. When it went lower, I panicked. I had no way of getting a hold of my guards.”

“Good thing I was there. So, the more digging I did on this bastard, the more I kinda felt better about myself……sorta. I may be into some things most wouldn't approve of, but I have NEVER hurt anyone. He was banned from a brothel for assault and breaking the rules. Some of their workers had to go to the hospital because of him.”

Mydei could feel the rage burning in his words. He wasn't aware of the crimes, but that's what happens when people who abuse power have money. He was sure his father didn't know about it.

“Phainon.. I am sorry about pushing you. I cared too much. I wanted something I know now I can't have, ever. I’m….” He tried to hold back the tears. The wounds were still too fresh. “....never loving another again. I'm not fit for it. I don't even know how normal friends work.”

There was a defining silence between them.

“You're going to leave me, aren't you?” The lion was on the brink of tears.

Phainon's head shot up. He was shocked and hurt that Mydei hit the note before he got to say it.

“Yeah, I thought so. If this is goodbye, I want a chance to say some things. Before you step out of my life forever. “

“I won't run. Please.”

“Look, first of all. Your watching me, never hurt anything. I was shocked, but I kinda liked it...OK, I liked it a lot. Considering what happened at the hotel.”

“What are you talking about?” He was scared to hear the answer.

“I saw you with a hard-on on the balcony. I was getting myself off from seeing it. Then it got worse when I heard you. I made a mess everywhere. I don't think I've ever been so turned on in my life.”

It was now Phainon's turn to be embarrassed. He was caught pleasuring himself, but they did it together, separately. He was glad the shirt was a loose material. He was getting extremely warm.

“Then, when I found out about the bedroom camera, a lot of things I felt made sense. I did like...no love having you watch me. I had a feeling no matter what I did, you'd be doing something to it.”

Fuck is the AC on.. dammit. Phainon almost wanted to lose the shirt.

“And you can't be a monster if someone else was at fault.”

His head tilted to the side.

The lion knew it was time. “It was a drunk driver, not you.“

Phainon’s heart was all over the place, emotions didn't know which road to turn down. “What makes you think that?”

“There was a newspaper article about it. 25 years ago. All witnesses say he was out of control. They had a hard time stopping him. He was 3 times the legal limit. They don't know if he blacked out or was distracted; that man took your family away. Not you. 5 year-old you didn't do anything wrong. You were a child. All you can do is love.” Mydei got off the table, going over to the man in tears.

Once close enough, Phainon wrapped his arms around Mydei's waist and cried. It was so hard for him to believe, but it confirmed what the nurses said a long time ago. No words were exchanged between them. There was an arm across his shoulders and in his hair, comforting him.

Finally leaning back, a sleeve came up to dry his face off. “Look, I don't want you to leave, but I also can't stop you. I can't MAKE you change your

mind about me….. or us. I guess, of anything, thank you for the wonderful time we had. It means the world to me. It's the last thing, though."

"What do you mean by *the last thing*?"

"I can't do this again. My heart has hurt too badly from both experiences of caring. I can't do it for another. It's too much. I'm just going to break it to my father; he is never getting his wish. Even more so with assholes like that piece of shit around."

Mydei tried to pull back, but Phainon's arms held him tight. "There is so much I want to say. First off, I am sorry for all the times I've made you cry. You are too beautiful to be that sad." His head tilted into Phainon's hand along his face.

"Also…."

A slamming fist against the door broke his thought. "Mydeimos, I know you're in there. Please come out."

It was the son. Being back in a hallway, secluded, Phainon had enough. "Text your guards. Have them come here in about 10 minutes."

He went over to the door, unbuttoning a few more buttons before opening it. Just to provoke him into starting first, he leaned against the door frame. The most sultry pose he could muster showed off more of his skin. "Mr. Kremnos is having a meeting right now. I can take a message if you like."

"I think you need to move out of my way and let me have some private time with him. YOU did interrupt me." The son was almost to the point of boiling over.

"Ohh, do I now? And what makes you think that time needs to be spent on you? I think that's more his choice." Phainon knew his snark was going to win.

"Because I'm the type of man that can make that prince submit. He would look sooo pretty as my wife." There was the cess pool.

“So you just want to control him?....Nothing is there for love. Treat him like you did all those workers at the brothel?”

“WhY YoUuu!?!? ” The anger was flaring, just a bit more pushing.

“And treat him like your own personal cock sleeve and not the prince needing worship and love?? I think not, Haikas.”

From inside the room, everything could be heard. Mydei was stunned by the conversation. *When the hell did he learn that word??*

There was the spark. A fist came flying at his face. Dogging, it slammed into the door frame. The other hand came at him, Phainon caught it mid-flight, twisting it around. His knee came up, right into the area below the ribs, in the stomach.

The body dropped to the ground. And just on time, the guards were there. They saw the physical altercation, not the words.

“Mr. Khaslana!! Are you alright? Are you hurt at all??”

“Well….I had to have something of a conversation with him, which was gross, and the stuff he said about Mydei was deplorable. But physically, I am fine. He is safe in the room. “

“Thank goodness, we will take care of him right away. Thank you for protecting Mr. Kremnos.”

“Security is my job.” He said with a smile to them. “Ohhh, and boys, you may want the authorities to look into his background. There are many questionable things there… not sure how recent.” There were times when he used his skills for nefarious purposes. Like making criminal accounts reappear on his civilian records. *That's what you get for fucking around with an IT wizard like me. I know hacking skills most don't. You aren't hiding your sins from anyone any longer.*

“Thank you, sir, will do.” With a bow, they dragged the body away. Once out of sight, he could safely go back into the room.

Once back inside, he relocked the door behind him.

“So anyways… as I was saying…”

Mydei reached up, grabbing the ribbon hanging from his neck, pulling it towards him. It was just enough of a tug that Phainon couldn't stop his body from being pulled forward, slotted right up against Mydei's.

He wasn't sure when the jacket came off or when Mydei was back against the table, but the AC needed to work a little harder.

Mydei took the ribbon, winding it around his hand. “Then I need to thank my knight, for protecting HIS prince.” Before a word of interjection could be had, Mydei took that leap. He pulled their lips together with the ribbon. Shock overtook Phainon's system first. Never in his lifetime or anyone's lives did he ever think that his first kiss would be from the man he's had sexual fantasies about since he was 16. Now with them both being 30, his love has grown with time. The last 8 years let him see so much.

The second shock to him was just how good it felt. To have that command pull him into something that was wanted, just made his desire work overtime. Phainon's whole body was being ignited with a pleasure he's never felt. No other person had come this far. He was being made to let go. Giving up control for just that moment, he enjoyed it.

The 3rd and most important shock of them all, being slotted up against Mydei's body, he could feel the erection straining in those dark pants. It was rubbing right up against his.

Lips that were soft, but needy broke from his. Mydei tried to catch his breath. “Look, I'm sorry. I overstepped again. I just wanted to feel a kiss once in my life, from someone who means the world to me.” He let the ribbon fall from his hands. Even though both men were very turned on, Mydei didn't know what his place was in Phainon's heart. He was afraid to ask.

He grabbed his coat, ready to leave the table.

“Where are you going?”

“Not going to give you the chance to say goodbye.” He didn't want to hear those words. It already hurt too much.

Hands were placed on either side of him, boxing Mydei into the table. “How about you help me test something instead?" Sunset hair flopped to the side in confusion. “I WANT to see…. Just how soundproof these walls are.”

Amber eyes widened, and then closed. Opening again with a softness and lust. “Am I too much?"

“No, I'm willing to touch the fire. Take the trial, try to get over what haunts me. I want to take that journey with you. I want to let you in. In turn, worship you, as you deserve.” He pushes his own aching tent against Mydei's. Hearing a soft gasp escape his lips.

“Will you make love to me right here and now?” Soft fingers came down the side of Phainon’s face.

“Your wish is my command.”

~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

See, all the angst and sadness was worth it. They finally admitted their feelings. Now what will happen behind the closed will be maybe more than Phainon's wildest dreams.

2 chapters left!!!

Thank you for reading!! It's almost done....thank you for coming along for the ride. ❤
~~~~~~~

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Chapter 16

Chapter Summary

> With the cesspool of sin throughly taken care of, Phainon could now get back to what was most important: a hot young CEO in a three-piece suit that wanted him badly. Everything before his eyes made Phainon want him more.
>
> But ohh was he going to be in for some suprises. They always say its the quiet ones you have to watch out for, and Mydei was no exception.

Chapter Notes

> No beta read
>
> SOOOOOO!!! Originally this was the last chapter. But my friend that I roll suggestions and ideas off of said that yea where the story ended was fine.. but there should be ar least a little bit more.
>
> Soo, 1 more is coming 😏😉

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“My command? Take me how you've always dreamed. I want to feel how much you adore me. Why did I make this(*slotting his leg between Phainon’s, pushing up*)so hard at the hotel? The hardon I tried to hide, soaking wet in front of you in the car, most likely teasing. You probably saw it. I want whatever you will give.” Mydei shifted his hips up a little more, getting the slightest bit of friction for it.

“You know, you look so amazing in that three-piece suit. That does really turn me on. With those glasses on, I wanted those eyes on me.” Leaning in, he placed soft kisses along any exposed neck available. Hand moving down his chest to the snaps of the vest, undoing them one by one.

“Maybe….maybe I'll have to wear it and no shirt.” His whole body was alive. Every sensor didn't know how to handle the new feeling surging through his veins. It was addictive. It felt good. One hand balanced on the table, the other ran through the fields of winter snow. Once the vest was free, he shrugged it off his shoulders, throwing it wherever.

Right now, neither cared.

Both of Phainon’s hands came up to the luscious chest he'd only seen from afar and squeezed.

“Ahhhh gawd!” followed by a soft moan.

The reaction was visceral and quick. Feeling a bit more, both nipples were very hard and erect. Not enough to pinch hard, he rolled the already swollen nubs between his fingers.

Feeling.

Phainon bit his lip, grinning. ”Mydeimos Kremnos, when did you get these done?” Giving each a soft roll again, small metal bars could be felt on each one. He was more than excited to see them up close.

Hearing the breath catch in his own throat, he had to hold himself up with both hands now. With getting this excited, one wasn't enough to hold him. He would have collapsed.

“I uhmm…. What you saw Thursday.. uhmmm huhn… “ He was trying so hard to keep his thoughts straight to answer.”... they were there that day. I got them… Wednesday after work. They were so sensitive afterwards.”

“God damn, I bet. You had us both edged for hours.” A pink tongue came out, licking his lips. “ May I see?”

With the nod of approval, he got to work unwrapping his present. Both hands made quick work of the belt. Pulling it out of the loops with a snap, then tossed it aside. The top of his dress pants was slowly undone. He was just teasing both of them now. With the button undone, zipper down, and

now the black shirt was pulled from Mydei's pants. Fingers made their way up the flesh, some, feeling the toned muscles beneath them. Electricity jumped between them with the skin under his touch. It was all new for them both, but desperately needed and wanted. The shirt was grabbed, pulling it up and over Mydei's head.

The sight before his eyes was exquisite, beautiful, exotic, stunning… the right word couldn't be found. Leaned back on the conference desk, the prince showed off his upper body, flush with excitement. Pants just slightly undone, and the best part was the small metal piercings adorning each nipple. Nothing extravagant. Simple and sinful at the same time.

“Phainon." A hand came under his chin, lifting it to meet amber eyes. “I trust you, worship me as you will.”

Permission was given.

Mydei wanted to give himself over to the man who has his heart and soul. Something about the white-haired man clicked in him. Eros took way too long to deliver Phainon to him. Now he wasn't letting go.

“As you wish, my Prince.” Boxing him back in against the table, he peppered kisses up his body, starting right at his trail line. Each connection of their flesh made the muscles jump and tense. When the kisses stopped, he was right above the left nipple. He looked up at Mydei through his bangs; lust floated in a sea of blue. When Mydei opened his eyes to see the sight before him, a quick smirk was on Phainon's face before wrapping his lips around it.

Mydei's body pushed itself forward into Phainon's mouth. Touching it himself was one thing, but having someone else do it was another. The feeling was divine. Better than anything he did to himself. Lips and tongue worked in tandem. The small metal bar danced around in Phainon's mouth. It was still so fresh that every touch made the prince's body react. Phainon didn't want to leave the other alone. Wet lips let go of the aroused flesh in front of him.

Mydei was already trying to catch any semblance of breathing. His chest heaving was not helping to make him look less sinfully delicious in the eyes of his knight.

With amber eyes watching every move, Phainon used his teeth to pull off the gloves adorning both hands. Feeling the cool air against his hot skin, he went back to work. When lips and fingers found their respective piercing, each was played in unison. Testing the waters, he bit down some.

“Uhhhnnnmmm ohh god please..nmhn” Mydei's hips were looking for any friction; he was straining so much it hurt. He was about ready to cum just from his chest alone.

“Do you want it?” No words could be heard, just watching the lips say *Please.* The quiet plea was all he needed. His hot mouth returned to the already abused nipple, sucking on it harder. Phainon knew it was going to bruise.

“Fu….kk.. th..e..r…r.”

The bar was toyed with on both, pushing him over the edge.

Letting go of the flesh beneath him, he stood back a bit. Admiring his work. Mydei, disheveled from his own hands, was a much better sight. Wetness could be seen on the lace fabric of his underwear.

Even though neither man had ever experienced a partner, they knew what the other desired. Both are drowning in the new feelings between them.

Not to be outdone, Mydei shakingly pulled himself up. Sliding his hands into the silk shirt. His fingers danced along the skin, removing it from pale shoulders. Sliding it down toned arms, exposing all of his chest. Mydei wasn't letting him get off so easily. The shirt was pulled down but not off. He held it behind Phainon’s back, trapping his hands. He wasn't allowed to touch.

When Mydei's mouth connected with his chest, part of Phainon’s insides melted. Feeling his prince suck and bite with the same love and care made

his world spin. Unlike what he did, Mydei left bites and sucked on both. One never got more than the other, and having his arms restrained behind his back was turning him on harder.

Phainon wanted to touch so badly, but even being restrained just this much helped him realize there was something more than just watching from the shadows that got him excited.

Mydei's legs wrapped around his, holding them in place. He was restrained entirely. Each lick and bite made him twitch, jumping in his pants. He knew how swollen it was. From his usual sessions, it was at least once a day. Now to have gone over 2 weeks without being touched, it wanted to be touched so badly.

He tried to move, but the legs held tighter.

A hard pop came off his nipple. Blood can be seen pooling at the surface. The bruising felt incredible on him. The love bites he could endure. “I didn't say you could move.” Hearing those words, in that lustful tone, did things to his mind he didn't know was needed. They were commanding, but gentle. Through the breathy words, he felt loved.

“I want you….to show me you can be a good boy. Can you finish without friction, too?”

“Mydei… I could finish from your voice alone. My whole being belongs to you. It has been since I was a teenager. I've wanted you for so long; working with you only made it more desperate.”

Licking the reddened flesh before him, he peppered the top with the lightest kisses. “Did that desperation lead to the cameras?”

“Ahhhh uhn uhhh ohh gawd…. I…. Yes… I knew.. fuck…”

“If you're a good boy, we will soon.” The praise went straight to his head(s). Not only was it engorged with blood, but also with praises. He didn't know he needed it.

I guess I have new kinks now.

“I..knew….I never had a chance. Everyone who's ever called was rejected. I thought I was no different. I desperately wanted to see more of you. The house ones weren't enough. I want to get into your private world.”

“I see.” The neglected right nipple was licked a few times. “Well, I did give you permission to put up cameras.”

“AHHHhhhh uhm.. ughn..not in there.”

“As I said, I didn't mind. I already had feelings, just didn't understand my own or wanted to hurt you.” His mouth went back to working harder; he wanted to feel the body under him get wrapped up in pleasure.

Stopping, Mydei licked his own fingers. Making a light sheen of wetness flow down them. Touching the red flesh made Phainon feel like two tongues were on him. Trying to buck his hips towards the restrains on his legs were loosened, but only enough to move his hips in his pants.

Phainon’s breathing became more rapid; the end was approaching. Inside his boxers were soaked, probably going onto his pants. A soft, sultry voice was heard, ending it all. ”Be a good boy, cum for me.”

Phainon's body shook against the restraints. His brain overflowed with euphoria. Both his body and mind have their own orgasms. Together and separately. Mydei let go of what he was holding. Pulling the shaking body into his, he just held him.

His back felt suddenly wet. Then, realizing tears were hitting his skin. Knowing what he knew about the accident, he avoided Phainon’s back altogether. That was permission he would need not only to see, but to touch.

“I have you. It's ok.”

Those words hit his closed-off heart. Someone giving everything to their person. Asking nothing in return, just wanting to care. He knows the man

holding him. Knows the care he would receive. Treat him the same as his company. Selfless. He would give Phainon the world if he asked.

Hands came up, caressing his hair. “If it's too much, we can stop.”

Leaning back, sad blue met loving amber. He couldn't have fallen for this man any harder if he tried. “I… uhm..I do want more, but…”

“Please.”

Phainon looked around the room they were in, trying to give hints that maybe they shouldn't. Not here.

“Well, let me put it to you this way. If we do, it won't be a problem. Where do you want to take me? I was almost thinking up against the glass, but that's hard on the body.”

Phainon just stared at those words. He didn't just hear that. “God damn.. You are way dirtier than I gave credit for. Seeing what you can do is one thing. But hearing it…what a dirty lion you are.”

“It’s part of the learning experience for us both. You'll probably bring out a lot of things I didn't know I felt or liked either.” Their lips connected; it was soft. Nothing desperate. Just feeling the other person's love.

“Uhmm, well… I think we are both going to get ruined. We are already a mess. How about you take me home and we utilize that blanket you bought?” The playful side of him snuck a hand up, brushing over the piercing.

Mydei could feel himself stirring again. “Uhnnn.. fuck you're a menace. That does sound like a better idea.”

“How are we going to get out looking like this, though?” Phainon looked over his art piece. Mydei's skin was all flushed. Both nipples were redder than the pomegranates he demolished on their trip. Dark purple bruising could be seen on each of them and his collarbones. *It's a damn good thing he wears a suit all the time.*

“I've been here a lot. There is a door down the hall to the parking garage. My car is in there. We'll come back later tomorrow to get yours. Trust me, it won't be an issue. Some are over in the hotel because of hangovers and for other things.” To enact some payback, he blew soft air over the bruises on Phainon's chest. He shuttered. The feeling was too good.

“Let me up, I need to look somewhat presentable to leave and drive.” Phainon backed up, pulling his own shirt back onto his shoulders. Picking up the pile on the floor, he held them for his prince to pick what he was going to wear.

Mydei grabbed the vest, fastening it back up. His toned arms and upper chest were shown off more with it. ”God fuck, I knew you'd look amazing.” Putting his own gloves back on, he held the shirt, jacket, and belt. “Are you just gonna wear that for me?”

The ribbon was grabbed again, pulling their faces close. ”I will always reward good behavior. And you...” a soft pink tongue licked over his lips “..are my best boy.” The ribbon was dropped, and Phainon just stood in his excitement with ears on fire. He really had no clue that praise like this would get him off. He was beginning to like being told he was a good boy.

Mydei looked over the room, turning off the lights. The room didn't look any worse for wear. Phainon followed him out of the room and down the hall. This time not behind him, but beside. He felt that he could be Mydei's equal now.

“I can take my stuff, you know.”

“Nooo, I wanna stare. Can you blame me? Just the vest accentuates your whole upper body. I can't lie. I'm getting excited looking at it.” Stopping at the door, he waited for Mydei.

“Well..” An eyebrow came up looking at him.

A soft pink tongue licked dry lips. “We'll just have to take care of it all on the way home.” Before any words could be said, he was out the door.

I'm so fucked. I love it…. I love…him.

~~~~~~~

The violet eyes jump to attention, hearing a door slam in the parking garage. She thought she was alone. The party had been getting too much for her. Plus, the heels were making her feet hurt. Castroice had intended to leave early, but this was a little later than she wanted.

I guess sitting around does pay off.

Catorice saw both men she was concerned about. She was very confused for just a second as to why they looked so disheveled.

Then it hit her.

Her car was a bit away from Mydei's, so he couldn't see her. But what she saw was just like out of the books she read. Mydei was in front with just his vest on and dress pants. His hand was over his left shoulder, holding on to a ribbon. Following it back led to a more loosely wrapped one around Phainon's neck, like a collar. He was carrying the rest of Mydei's missing clothes.

They stopped by the car. Clothes were thrown on top of the roof. Phainon braced his hands on either side of the CEO's body. Lips stealing any and all the kisses he could find. Every bit of skin was worshiped. Hands came around Phainon's waist, hovering over his ass. Then Mydei grabbed two handfuls, pulling their bodies together. A few thrusts and they broke apart. Both getting into the car and leaving the garage.

Castorice couldn't believe her eyes. The romance that she had seen try to blossom over a month was now a full-blown field of flowers. Just from their body language, she could tell that they were finally finding themselves and each other.

Besides being embarrassed by what she saw, Castorice was more than happy for both of them. Now the office could get back to a semi-normal state. Not all the sad tension chokes out any happiness. It then dawned on
~~~~~~~

her. They might try to pull things in the office now, but that was ok, at least they were happy.

And she was happy for them.

Sending out a quick text, she had to let someone know things were well.

▪▪▪▪▪

Cass:

The lion and oryx have left the party together. Someone's getting eaten tonight. ;]

▪▪▪▪

Once the text was sent, her heart felt lighter. The worry and haze that had dampened a lot of things were being ushered in by the new dawn. She was excited to see where things led.

“Good luck, boys, you both deserve all the happiness.”

~~~~~~~

Not looking over, Mydei could tell there was a strain in his white pants. “I have to know, though, for being an IT wiz, how do you have such a nice ass?”

Trying to pull his pants down at the crotch, his length felt suffocated. “I do work out at home. There are times I have to do physical maintenance. Some of that shit is heavy.”

Fully leaning back in his seat, left hand on the wheel, Mydei let a full shit-ass grin adorn his face. His free hand reached over to squeeze Phainon’s thigh, way too close to his needy member.

A long groan pulled from his chest. “Shit dude...you can't do that. I'm so easy when it comes to you.”
~~~~~~~

“Then why don't you do something about it?”

“You're driving, what can…I…possibly…” The dots connected so fast, excitement rising in his whole chest. “Are you sure?? How good is your control?”

“I'm Kremnoan. We are built for battle. I can handle a little pleasure while driving.” Reaching the controls on the panel, the seat slid back enough to make room for a body in his lap.

Ohhh fuck. He's really letting me blow him while driving.. fuck… I really want to impress him...I hope I don't fuck it up. I WANT to see that level of control.

Being at a stoplight, Mydei took it to his advantage. The belt was in the back seat, not an obstacle. Zipping down his pants, his hips lifted off the seat.

Phainon swallowed hard, watching the delicious scene in front of him.

Mydei slid his pants down to mid-thigh, exposing the sweat and semen-soaked black lace underwear. Knowing a show needed to be put on, his fingers pushed against the fabric. His veins scream for release from their confines. Giving his dick a strong squeeze, stroking the shaft, he grabbed the fabric on the way down. Once it was past his length, it was pushed under his balls, just to keep it out of the way.

Being able to see it up close was everything he's always dreamed of. He couldn't wait for a taste. “Before I get to work, can I ask? Am I allowed to get off as well?”

A smirk dawned on his face. “I would love nothing more than to see all your skills in action.”

With full permission given, his body leaned over the center console. Phainon almost thought this was a fever dream. All too good to be true, but it was very true and ready to be taken. Mydei gave him plenty of room to get in behind the steering wheel.

Taking a deep breath, his heart was racing. Licking his lips, he was ready. Wrapping his left hand around the leaking erection felt amazing for them both. A few strokes up and down, spreading around all the juices, his lips descended on the head. Breath was hot against it.

Taking it a little at a time, the head was pleased first. Rolling his tongue around the crown, he could feel the abs beside his face breathing faster.

Luckily for him, the light was very long. Traffic coming off the highway had a longer priority. Gave him plenty of time to get started before feeling the leg move to the accelerator. As the car moved forward, Phainon’s mouth was fully on the driver's erection, giving him the leeway he could take care of his own.

Phainon's own hand made quick work of his pants, not bothering to take them down. Reaching in, he moaned against the fullness in his mouth when fingers connected. Phainon knew he couldn't waste time; he needed to come again.

Now being free, he made sure his own hand and head were in sync. Moving in time for them both, it all felt so good. Phainon had seen videos of car sex, wondering if it was doable or even good. Knowing now the answer was yes to both.

Mydei's moans were soft, leaving his lips. He was getting such a show, being blown while driving and watching Phainon get himself off. He knew now there was no going back. Everything felt perfect. Laid back a bit more against the seat, making more of himself available to the wanting mouth. He could feel it was gladly taken.

They were getting to the easier part of the drive home. Mydei relaxed a bit more in his seat, laying his hand on the snow-white locks. Not pushing or grabbing, just feeling it go up and down on him.

“God, you are such a treat. Uhnn so…. Ohh gawd… fucking amazing.” He noticed that when the praise hit its subject, motions of Phainon’s hands and mouth got faster.

Please… please… I want to be your good boy. I want to please you. You feel so good. I love all this praise.

They both were so close to finishing. Good thing for them, the drive was almost over. Hitting the button early, the car kept driving past the gate, never stopping.

Getting closer to orgasm, the accelerator was pressed down a bit harder. Both could feel the rumble of the engine through their bodies, spurring them on to go faster. With just a bit more to go, the car finally slowed down to a stop. Mydei kept it running to keep the AC on. They were both sweating due to the risque thing they did through town. It turned them both on.

Placing the car in park, he made more space for the body to be above him. With more room, Phainon's left hand popped the snaps on the vest. He wanted to play with the nipples more to get him to come first.

Fingers laced their way into his hair. Mydei's whole body was alight with pleasure. Not wanting to hurt him, his hips made calculated thrusts into the mouth, pleasuring himself.

“Uh.. ohh fuck. Right there… god… be a good…. Boy…nnhn… make me come.” That hit the pleasure center of his brain; it needed to happen and fast. Running his fingers over the top of the nipple, he found the bar under the skin. Using feather-light touches made it ache more. Same with the head, his mouth went to work, just at the top, coaxing him to finish. The thrusts became more erratic. His moans filled the space.

Music to Phainon's ears.

Looking up quickly, the scene he saw made his own hand pump faster. Mydei was so close to finishing, he was playing with his other neglected nipple. Moaning with his mouth stuffed full was enough to get the prince to get to completion.

Mydei's body got stiff, gripping his hair lightly. Being prepared for it, Phainon took everything that was shot in his mouth.”Uhhhnn finish for

me…. Good boy.”

That was what he needed. Phainon came in his hand, trying to catch anything that came out, not wanting to make a mess all over the car. Once he calmed down, he let the spent member fall from his mouth.

Trying to adjust himself in the seat, he looked back at the most beautiful sight ever. Mydei was lying back still on the seat, the sexy vest pulled to the side. Chizzled pecks with just the slightest gleam of metal, trying to catch his breath. Spent cock lying against his stomach, just over a sunset trail.

God damn. I am the luckiest man ever. …wait… wait… his trail matches. It isn't hair dye. That's so fucking sexy.

“Are you ok?? How do you feel?” Running his hand over Mydei's leg in comfort.

“I feel so fucking good. That was crazy.” Mydei ran his fingers through the white locks.

“I’m so impressed, though. That control. Damn. Maybe we'll have to do it again on a longer trip?”

A long, drawn-out ‘yea’ was all he got. Mydei was still floating on cloud 9. Phainon was ready for more. That bedroom was calling. His mind came back to when a shirt was pushed into his arm.

“Here, use this; it can go in the wash.” Phainon felt it was already wet. It was used to clean up its owner first. Hurrying with it, he shoved himself back in his pants to get out of the car. Once around the driver's side, he opened the door.

“Come on, let's get inside.”

Mydei pushed himself, too, back in his pants, turning off the car. Shoved the key in his pocket. Mirroring the time before, it was Phainon's turn to extend a hand for help. It was grabbed to get out of the car, but legs were still a bit shaky from driving and orgasming.

Propping himself up against the back door, he finally shut it. “Ready to go, my prince?” With a nod, Mydei was going to try to walk into the house, but arms came under his knees and back, picking him up. Arms scrambled around his neck for support.

“THE FUCK!?!? HAIKAS!!”

Finally, a bright smile adorned a once-sad face, lighting up both their lives. “But Mydeimos, I'm your haikas.” Phainon was hell-bent on carrying his prince into the house. He didn't give any room for argument. “Can you put the code in for the door?”

Pushing in the code, kisses adorned the prince's neck. “Where in all hell's name did you learn that word from anyway?”

Opening the door, he brought them inside, heading towards the steps. “I overheard you call a suitor that one time. I was standing at Cass’ desk when it happened. Must have been six years ago.”

Carefully, Phainon took the steps to get to their destination. “And???” Mydei held onto his neck, peppering it with soft kisses.

“OHH….and I was wondering what it was. So I found a Kremnoan dictionary to figure it out.” They were back in the room that fueled so many fantasies. Mydei was gently placed on the bed. “But I think, at me, there is still affection behind it.”

Shaking his head, smiling, “There is. That fuck face deserved worse. Besides, we are here now. I do truly thank you for saving me. I was beginning to panic with him.”

“I could tell. Cass was over by the food when it happened. There's no way.”

“I guess jealousy can be a good motivator?”

“Yea, maybe… ok.. yes it was. Even if I couldn't be with you, I didn’t want some sick fuck having his way with you. I could see his dad pushing you

into something with his son, and.....you know, I don't want to think about it. The report on the brothel made me sick."

"We'll talk about it later. Right now I want more of you, but….." Mydei stopped in his words, staring at the floor.

Phainon got on his knees before his prince, concerned about what changed his attitude.

"Did I do something wrong?? Are you ok??"

"Noo, no. You're my…" that smile hits Phainon in the heart every time."... goodest boy. I want to know something before we do it."

Holding Mydei's hand close to his heart, he needed to hear it, no matter how bad. "Please, I can't keep hiding myself from you."

"What are your boundaries? What do you not want me to say, do, or touch? I don't want to cause any harm to you physically or mentally." The look in his Amber eyes showed nothing but care and love. No one has EVER given that much thought to him. Mydei truly was his prince.

"Damn.. I mean. No one ever got this close to me before. I suppose the only thing that is a hang-up for me is my back. Everything else on me looks normal. It's all the scars I hate." Mydei held his head in his hand. Pushing the white bangs behind his ears.

"Then that's fine. I won't look at or touch them. Until you are ok with me seeing them. They are a part of you, and I would love to praise all of you, but that is on your time."

"You are way too good to me."

"Only because…." The words hung on his lips. He wanted to say them, but didn't know if he was ready. His heart was pushing yes. He needed to follow it. "....because I love you."

"I love you, too." Kissing the back of Mydei's hand like the prince he is. The man he once thought to be a fantasy was right here before him. Read to

give him the world. Be his world. Phainon couldn't ask for more.

“Soo, blow jobs and hands are one thing, how do you want to do this? Neither of us has had partners before. And I assume toys have been all over the place.”

A nervous laugh left him. Mydei was right about so much. “Yeah, they have been.”

Lifting up his chin to look into amber eyes, laced with love and lust, “Then I would love nothing more than for my good boy to fuck me so good….so I'm only moaning his name.”

Those two words went right to his dick every time. Not waiting any longer, he crawls up from the floor, pinning Mydei to the bed. Lips locking, searching for that lust. His lower lip was licked, and he greedily accepted the tongue intruding into his mouth. Both are searching for more. The yearning never ceases.

With hands pinned above his head, bodies slotted together, both clothed erections needing to feel the friction from the other. Hips slowly moved up and down on each other. Neither of their dress pants was very thick, so the rubbing was causing them to seek it harder.

Breaking the kiss for air, Phainon wanted more. Sitting them both up, he pulled off the vest, throwing it to the side. His own top was discarded. Once both upper torsos were free of clothes, he grabbed the button holding his pants up, snapping it free. Pants falling to the ground. Phainon made quick work of his underwear as well. Mydei was also just as quick to get out of his own garments.

Both of them were now fully exposed to one another, well-toned and their erection standing proud and aching for the other. Mydei shimmied back to the bed a bit more, propping his feet up to fully expose himself. “It’s all yours.”

“You are such a sinful dish, Mydei.” The only light in the room was the red and white accent around the weapon alcove. It made his body look more

delectable. Crawling up the bed, a trail of kisses started at his knees, moving slowly up each muscle, revering each one.

Occasionally, Phainon’s eyes caught glimpses of a hand holding on to the pillow beside him. Those fingers obey the request not to touch his exposed back. Continuing up his body, once at the piercings, each was given a light kiss. The body is twitching each time. Finally meeting face to face, Phainon could see how heavy Mydei was breathing.

Reaching over into the top drawer, he retrieved the lube. “Thanks for keeping it there and leaving the blanket on the bed. Helps.”

A soft moan leaves his body. “Haikas… you're incorrigible.” Kissing his cheek.

“When it comes to you, I am….Ready?” The nod was given, telling him it was time. Phainon was ready to live his biggest fantasy. Knowing beforehand that no person had ever touched his prince this way, he was honored to be the first. And hopefully the last.

Lubed up fingers found their way back to his leaking slit, touching it ever so slightly. Watching his cock respond to the lightest touches, just enough to make Mydei's breath hitch. Not wanting to tease themselves any further, Phainon found the tight ring of muscles. Rubbing a finger around it, Mydei's legs spread wider. Inviting him in. Taking the invitation, just one was slowly pushed in. It was tight, but all the toys he used made it a bit easier.

Getting down to the first knuckle, it pulled back. Pushing back in again, same thing. The third push went the whole way. Waiting just a second, after hearing the moans sing to his ears, Phainon pulled back out and inserted a second. He knew he had to work quickly because he couldn't take much more teasing himself. The third finger was added, close enough to his width. It pumped in and out of the body. The body responds in turn. It was craving the feeling.

“Uhmmnnn I… don't know…you… want it wrapped?” Phainon was concerned.

The head shook no. “ I know we … both are good.”

Phainon pushed his lips together, smiling. He was truly going to feel Mydei wrapped around him. A ragged breath left him. Part of his mind had to prepare. It wasn't just his own body or a toy; he had to get ready to take the prince under him. He had to lock his worries away; there was no hiding anymore. He wanted it and wasn't going to deny himself happiness any longer.

Squeezing some lube over his own member, quick strokes cover it. He was ready. Getting back on his knees between open legs, his head lined up with the aching hole. Grabbing hold of the hips, he pushed the head in.

“Ohh damn.. fuck… “ More slid inside. The feeling was better than any toy in his drawer, not even the life-like ones. It felt so good. Phainon pulled back just enough to see the bottom of the crown, then pushed back into the hole. Clear to the base.

Mydie's back arched off the bed, and a loud moan tore from his throat. Phainon was in his own headspace, trying to get over the feeling of being sheathed completely. The tightness was better than any Fleshlight he'd used. This was warm and begged for more.

When Mydei's back finally contacted the bed, his hair splayed out like a halo around him, their eyes met.

The next words broke him hard.

“Good boy…. Fuck…fuck me like you mean it.” Mydei's legs wrapped around his waist, keeping him locked in. His prince wanted to be wrecked.

Grabbing hold of his hips, it started slowly, but then it was being used just like one of the toys. He was thrusting into the hole with reckless abandon. He wanted to worship the body below him, but that would have to come later. They both were seeking pleasure from the other, desperately scratching for more.

Mydei's head was thrown back, moans of pleasure filling the room. Phainon was trying to hold his back, just to listen. Hearing it right before him was the best sound ever made.

Slowing down a little, his eyes picked up on something shiny in the still-open drawer. Reaching up to grab it, the gold chain dangled in his fingers. Slower thrusting enabled him to line the clamps up. Mydei was too lost in pleasure to notice what was about to happen. He slowed his hips to almost a stop. Then, at the same time, he attaches both clamps.

“Fuck…. Ohhmmgodd…fu…ckkk.. “ Mydei was having a hard time forming words. Now, a beautiful gold chain connected each piercing.

“I ….I..didn’t want them to …..miss the fun…..too” Bracing one hand on the bed, the other pulled on the chain as his hips picked back up. Every pull on the chain made Mydei's insides clench around him harder. It was the best feeling ever.

He needed more.

He wanted to GIVE more.

Bracing himself on his knees, the chain was placed in his mouth. He was getting to the breaking point, knowing the prince would soon be there too.

Pulling his head back, pulled it forward. Each nipple was red like the blazing fires of the prince's homeland. Scorching hot. Grabbing his hips, the thrusting became erratic. He couldn't take much more.

He felt a hand sneak between them. Mydei was stroking himself to help finish.

They wanted this moment to last forever. Unfortunately, they didn't have the stamina of God's; they took what they could handle.

Amber eyes met his; they told so many things. Right now, it was the impending climax.

“I…..lo..v..e…” Mydei never got to finish his words. Clenching around the length in him, he spilt all over his own chest. The chain dropped from Phainon’s mouth, thrusting a few more times before emptying inside.

His head fell to the heaving chest below him. Their bodies were both in a state of elation. Euphoria. Neither had ever felt this good.

It was several minutes before either could move. Legs slipped off Phainon’s hips; they had no strength.

Getting up on his elbows, he moved the sweaty hair off Mydei's face. “Love you too.”

“I've never…. Felt …this good ever.”

“Me neither.” Phainon kissed the chest below him. Some fluid got on his lips, but that was his secret for right now. It was licked clean before looking back up.

“Phainon??”

“Yes, my prince?”

With a completely fucked out of his mind look, Mydei uttered the winning words. ”Such a good boy.” Squeezing his insides slightly.

“Uhnnnn god.” He just about came again, following the shutter down his spine. “ You're so bad, but I love you.”

“Me too. Can we both make it to the bathroom?” Grabbing a remote, water can be heard running.

“You have a remote for the tub???”

“Well, yeah, silly. When I'm being impatient, I get it started before I'm ready to get in. No waiting.“

Slowly, Phainon started to pull out. “Hey…. If you wanna bath…. Uhnn stop.. squeezing.”

“Sorry, you feel too good to let go.” Relaxing, he let the member fall from his entrance, leaking all over the blanket.

“Sooo uhmmm, we gonna fuck in the tub too?”

“If you're a good boy, maybe I'll ride you.” The sex look on Mydei's face, he knew, was going straight to Phainon's libido.

“This will definitely be a night to remember.”

~~~~~~~

Chapter End Notes

Hahaha those two are so bad. Mydei has to have the control of a god to get those presents while driving. I guess then Phainon does live up to his in game nickname of Deliverer becasue ohhhh boy did he ever.

So the boys finally admitted their feelings and are now a thing. But like I said above, a friend suggested not to end on just sex. So there is one more FINAL CHAPTER for you guys. Please stay turned for it!!

thank you so much for reading and support.<3

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.
~~~~~~~

Chapter 17

Chapter Summary

> You know what the worst thing is for a needy, clingy puppy? For the one thing you have attached yourself to has to go on a business trip for a whole month. Ok, yea, you can have texts and video calls, but it isn't the same as the warm body next to you or in a tight hug.
>
> So, Phainon has a month without Mydei. What will he do with this time and where does Kyros fit into all this?

Chapter Notes

> Happy 1 year writing anniversary!! I hope you enjoy the ending !

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Sat. October 4th, one week left

Against all things he loves on the weekend, Phainon got his butt out of bed at 6am. Right now, sleeping in was for the weak.

It's been almost a month since Mydei went on a conference trip with his parents. Leaving him alone in a big soft bed, all by his lonesome. Because of the nature of the trip, they wouldn't have had much time to spend together. So Phainon had the whole big house to himself.

Which is terribly lonely.

Even video chats were short. He could tell at the end of the day that his prince was tired. The hotel they were in was very posh, but he knew Mydei wanted HIS bed and HIS Phainon.

Eating was even worse.

Sure, Mydei did make him a lot of food for the duration of his trip, and froze it for him, but it just wasn't the same. Spending evenings together making food. Phainon wasn't a gourmet chef by any stretch of the imagination, but he tried to help. Poorly cutting vegetables(though it did improve), stirring soups or sauces, and anything to help the meal prep together. The most fancy thing he's ever made was stuffed French toast. Everything else was basic things.

But this...this was special. Loneliness and boredom can lead to incredible things. Mydei always does so much for him. Before and after they got together, the CEO never changed. Always stayed the same selfless person. He always gave so much to those around him. NEVERasking for anything in return. There were times when he would walk into the office at 7 am, meetings and business work all day, and not walk into his own place till 1 am. Then do it all again the next day. If one of the restaurants needed help, he was the first one that was called, per his request.

Buying a house for himself was the first time in, probably forever, that he did something for himself. Getting out and doing something on your own, not tied to the family, must have been a huge relief. Now sharing a big house with someone made his soul that much happier. If one could read auras, he would be much brighter now.

After they confessed their feelings, Mydei tried to ask him to move in in the most subtle ways possible. He was still afraid of asking for big things like that. Phainon took a little bit to get the hints, but when he did, was overjoyed to come and share his life with a partner.

Once black pants and a white shirt were all neat and presentable, Phainon made his way downstairs. Turning on his phone, he was greeted with a ‘good morning’ message from Mydei, sent everyday before heading to work. Below was the one he was looking for.

Kyros

He was one of Mydei's head chefs for the restaurant in town. The best man to help head operations, if you ask a lot of people, that person was him.

Phainon wanted to do something special, romantic. Have a proper date. Since getting together, they have spent most of their free time at home. Weekends were even hectic from time to time.

Through it all, they still made love at least 3 times a week. Both were finding new things about themselves and the other. With how much care and attention Phainon was given, more barriers were crumbling. Mydei's love carried a hammer that wasn't huge or overbearing. It was soft chisels that worked into the pressure points, cracking the whole wall.

Mydei had at least gotten him to the point where parts of his shoulders and neck could be thoroughly touched. He always waited, never asked for more; it was on Phainon's time with what he was comfortable with. It wasn't much, but it was progress. Helping him get over his own insecurities was a big hurdle, now done together.

So how did Kyros fit into this whole date equation?

Phainon had found the perfect condo to rent in town. Top floor. Looking over the entire city. The landscape could be seen for miles. He wanted to TRY cooking something special for Mydei. Knowing his own skills were less than par, he didn't have time with videos on the internet to learn. He needed a master. That master was Kyros.

Phainon had known him ever since he took the contract from Evernight. Besides setting up his security, he saw him a lot of nights for takeout. They were well acquainted with each other.

¤¤¤¤¤¤

The day Mydei left for his trip, the decision was made for the romantic dinner. Picking a place was easy; he just needed help with the hard part.

That afternoon, shortly after the lunch rush, at 2pm, Kyros was in his usual haunt. The back corner of the kitchen, sitting on a bar stool, tablet in hand, going over the meals and prep for the evening.

“It's almost like they put you on time out,” the bright smile said, meandering back to his hiding spot.

“Mr. Khaslana?! Sir, I…uhmm…shit.” Kyros was totally not expecting company. “Hi, is something wrong? You don't normally come see me, unless it's an important matter.”

Phainon smiled again. He was nervous to ask for help. “Well, it is important. You see Mydei...”

“Did you two break up already?? Dude, I’m so sorry.” His hand was over his heart, showing how much he cared.

“WhATtt!? Ohh gods noo… noo.. and uhmm no.”

“Are you sure?? Like you two good?” Kyros figured their relationship out the night Mydei told him that he was paying for the tech's dinner.

“Yea, dude.. noo we are good. I just have a problem. I was wondering if you could help me with it.” Pulling up a stool next to the head chef, Kyros poured him a drink.

The glass was slowly filled with a creamy white fluid, slightly yellow in color. Pulling it to his face, he caught the slightest whiff of alcohol from it. What he did pick up on was sweet lemons. Even though it wasn't wine, using what he learned at the Vineyard, he tasted it like a culinary master. He was trying to show off a little.

“I can see why he likes you, you're as bright as the lemons used to make this.”

“Is it usual to drink this early in the day? Does the boss know you get drunk at work?” Taking another sip, it went down smooth. It was creamy with just the hint of the sweet lemons.

A big, hearty laugh came from the chef, confusing him more. He then took a drink of his own. It was on the more clear side with just a slight hint of yellow. Bubbles floating to the top. “Well, no, I don't. You just looked like

you needed something to take the edge off. That is a ‘*crema di limoncello'; it is* a creamer version of the regular. Mine is just a sparkling fruit drink.”

Phainon felt dumb, but also cared for. It was becoming a new thing for him.

“You're good. So what's up with the boss?”

“He has to go on this month-long trip with his parents. I couldn't go because it was all business stuff. We face time at night. I can tell he's tired. There is probably so much going on that it's a lot, physically and mentally. Doesn't want to, but it's his job.” Hand just held the glass, staring at his image, distorted in the fluid.

“Puppy having separation anxiety?” Kyros was aware of the joke between the two men. Mydei made an off-hand comment one night, rolling out dough for the special dish of the night. He could never take it back.

“Yes,” Mydei hadn't even been gone 24 hrs yet, and he was already lonely. He was attached and didn't want to let go.

Rubbing him on the shoulder, “It will get easier with time, trust me. So how do I fit into your pining?” Laughing, he continues the work on the tablet.

Steeling himself, he takes a very big drink of the liquor in front of him. Letting the words come right out.”TEACH ME TO COOK!”

Kyros stopped what he was doing, very confused.

“He always does so much for everyone, for me. Never asking anything back. I want to do something romantic for him when he comes back. Watching the internet won't help me fast enough. I only have a month. I wanted to see if you could help me. I'll even pay you for your time.” He tried not to look at the man beside him. He was prepared for rejection. Running a restaurant is a lot of work. Phainon was just some dude trying to impress his boyfriend. Who just so happens to be his boss.

“You know he'd be impressed with just grilled cheese?” There is no tone to Kyros’ voice. Just words.

Phainon knew it was dumb to ask. He felt dejected and stupid. He would just have to do the best with his measly skills. He went to get off the stool, eyes to the ground, “I'm sorry for bothering you. Uhmm… thanks for the drink. I'll pay for it on my way ou….”

A strong calloused, burnt, and cut-ridden hand grabbed his wrist. “But I'd be more than happy to help.”

“But you…”

“Was just messing. Plus, it's different seeing your vulnerable side. Sit”

Just like the puppy he was, Phainon sat back down.

“Look, to be honest, I have no issue helping, but I owe you.” The snow-haired man pointed at himself in confusion. “Yes, you. For saving the boss at the party. I didn't like them from the minute they walked in, and something just didn't sit right when they were around him like vultures. I couldn't get over it. They had people in the way. I'm glad you did what you did. So for many reasons and because you're important to a good friend, I'll help.”

“Please don't talk about them, it will spoil my drink.” A laugh finally came from them both.

“So Mr. Tech Wizard, what did you have in mind?”

“I was gonna rent a condo in the city. Top floor. Amazing view. I wanted to cook for him. Cook something special, but my skills are ass, and the internet is too slow and inaccurate.”

Kyros was touched by hearing the plan. That someone was willing to put that much heart and effort into the once untouchable CEO. “You know it isn't gonna be easy? I have been doing this for a long time. I have been told by many under me that I am a tough teacher.”

“I know, but it's worth it for him.”

Setting his tablet down, he pulls out his own phone. “Let's get started on planning.”

¤¤¤¤¤¤

Being the head of security, Phainon could let himself into the building. Considering it was 6:30am, it was no big deal. A few of the overnight staff were in. They had gotten used to seeing the two men, even before the sun had peaked over the mountains.

“We have 6 days left. I have to say, for someone who spends a lot of time behind a computer screen, I'm very impressed.” He paused, pushing his lips together, sucking them in. “You're very good with your hands.”

Just a small snicker left Phainon's nose. Trying to be professional this early is hard.

“So, here is what we are gonna do over the next 3 days. I'm gonna have you do 1 dish a day. On the 4th day, you have to do the full course meal. So, come Friday night, you can do it all before he arrives.” Kyros tied his usual apron around, watching the sleepy man before him.

“Yes, chef.” It was affirmative, but still sleepy. He had been going every day before work, after, and longer lessons on the weekends.

Phainon looks down his list of things:

-Appetizer:

~Small loaf of Bruschetta

~Italian wedding soup

-Drink:

~Crema di Limoncello

-Main 1:

-Baked Gnocchi with Vodka Sauce and

Burrata cheese

~Main 2:

-Osso Buco: Braised veal shanks, tomato-based sauce, and gremolata

~Desert:

-Tiramisu

“What we will do, the desert will be made on Wednesday. So it has time to sit and get its flavors. Are you good with your 3-day task? Do each one so you can get it perfected. Then bring it all together. Hopefully, on Thursday, I can go with you to get everything you need and set the place up.” Kyros wanted this to go well for them both. They deserve to have a good time. If all it takes is a bit of shopping, lessons, and set up, he's more than happy to help.

Phainon’s head almost touched his knees, bowing in thankfulness and respect to Kyros for helping him. “DUDE.. I can not begin to thank you enough for all this.”

He was slightly embarrassed by all the praise. “Come on, lover boy. No need for all this praise. You two are my friends. I'm more than happy to help. So let's get this started. Everything will be done by yourself today. What you need for the first set is all back in our area. I'm going to go help the rest of the morning crew with their prep. I'll come back in an hour just to check. Good deal?”

Phainon stood tall with his orders, like a soldier on the front lines. He was ready to prove the lessons paid off. Everything up to this point was all small portions of things. The next four days will be portions made out for two people. “Yes, Chef!”

~~~~~
~~~~~

Mydei finally had some time to himself. Meeting and traveling have been very tiring. He knew it needed to be done, but missed HIS home. He was so grateful that it was almost over. *Six more days. I'm just so done. I never thought I'd miss sex. Hell, it isn't just that, it's everything. It wasn't so bad in the past, but now having someone at home, it makes it hard to be away.*

A knock on the wall brings his attention back to the present.

“Dear?? Are you alright? After the meeting, you snuck off. That isn't like you.” Gorgo comes over and sits beside her son on the window bench.

“Nope, I'm great.” He didn't want to worry her.

A soft smile adorns her strawberry blond hair, just like her son's. “You miss him, don't you?”

“I have work to do, mother. I can't be…”He is silenced when her finger is placed over his lips.

“My son, you have found love. It is ok to let it show. I don't want you to end up like your father and not show it when it matters. Phainon is an incredible person. You have found love with him. You were harder to crack than the toughest pomegranate shell.” Holding her son's hand to give him comfort.

“He was so nervous to meet you guys. I told him he was fine, but his anxiety was telling him otherwise. Probably seeing the type of people that came to court me, he figures some ‘nerd’ like him would be looked down upon.” A heavy sigh left his chest. He knew this relationship was going to be a lot of work for both of them. To trust and care for another person, but also to let that care in, it’s tough.

“Was he afraid that we wouldn't accept him, also, because he was a man?”

“That may have been a worry of his, piled up on everything else. I told him it was fine. And for the off chance neither of you two would like him(which I knew you would love him) or not, then I would cut ties for him. It was my life, and if he wasn't accepted, then I wanted no part of it.”

A warm laugh emanated from her. She knew her son. If it was something he wanted, nothing would stop him. Always like a true Kremonan. “Well, I'm glad things turned out. Just a couple more days.”

“There is the issue. Yea, I'm getting back around dinner time, but apparently I won't see him till way later. He told me something had come up, and he wouldn't be able to get me from the airport.” The sadness was so evident in his voice. His yearning was probably as strong as Phainon’s was.

Gorgo rubbed her son's back; she could tell he was hurting. Being a first love would be hard for anyone to be away from for a long period of time. They had only been together for three months, and Phainon had just moved in at the end of August.

“If you want, I can try to get you out of some meeting tom….”

“No, mother, I'm fine. It's my job. I have to do this. You both entrusted me to take care of these restaurants, and I'd be failing them if I bailed on meetings because I miss my boyfriend.”

She knew there was no convincing him. He was just like her after all. Not taking no for an answer, doing what the heart desired. His father wasn't so bad back when his parents first got together, but then business became his life. It was hard to peel him away from it. She was just glad Mydei wasn't becoming like that.

“We have some time before the next meeting, about a half hour or so. Give him a call. It will help.” Getting up, she moved his bangs, kissing her cub's forehead. “I want a happy kitty when I see you in a bit.”

With that direct order, she disappeared down the hall.

“I guess I have to then. I don't want to be yelled at. I fear her more than my father.”

Opening his phone, it was two in the afternoon. Being that it is on a Saturday, things shouldn't be too busy.

“I'll at least send a text asking if he's busy.”

The quickest text was sent. The waiting game began. Was he busy, awake?? It was hard to tell. They both knew constant massaging would be a distraction; per Phainon’s decision, they would wait. They only had their calls at night and a text when each got up. This was going to be out of the blue.

About 10 minutes had passed. Mydei was starting to lose hope that he wasn't busy.

Then dots appeared.

He wanted to make sure nothing was being interrupted. The reply made a soft smile appear on his face, the first genuine smile he's had during the day.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

Phai:

I'd stop the world. Even hold my breath. If it meant I could share even 5 minutes of your fire. It brings me so much warmth that when we aren't together, I always want to seek it out. All because …..I love you.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

The video call was placed.

¤¤¤¤¤

Mydei:

Are you always this romantic?

Do you woo all the circuitry and programs with that language?

Phai:

****the brightest smile is on his face****

Dude, if I knew that language,

I would have to be afraid of machines trying to take me from you. So…. Uhmm, is everything ok?

You normally don't call during the day.

(Lucky for him, he was just done with Kyros. The surprise may have been ruined if he called any sooner. They were still in the kitchen. The dishes that he worked on, he could take home, but he decided to share them with the house. They were all excited to try it. Knowing their head chef was teaching, they all had faith in Phainon's abilities. So going to get pizza would be an easy cover.)

Mydei:

Yea, mother is just too perceptive of things.

She told me I'd better stop moping and call you

or her and I were going to have words.

Phai:

****the smile was brighter****

Thanks, mom. Guess we can't fool her.

Sooo…. Uhmm..

I know I say this a bunch…but I really miss you.

It's hard having that big bed to myself.

Or not helping you cook things.

I'm being needy.

I'm sorry.

Mydei:

Noo, don't be sorry.

I feel the same way.

I'm gonna be totally honest with you.

I have maybe ***‘done it’*** *once since I've been on this trip.*

Like some time during the first week.

My mood has been so killed by everything.

On top of just being tired at the end of the day.

I can't even have a long conversation with you.

Phai:

I know.

I’m that irresistible.

Mydei:

****a soft grin peaks on his lips****

Ok, haikas. I'll let you think that.

Phai:

I will, ‘caz I know it's true.

‘Caz you love me.

Mydei:

I do.

Just sucks that I have to wait so long to see you.

Late Friday night is too far away.

I'm thankful Kyros offered to get me.

He had texted me way after I talked to you about it.

I was complaining that I'll have to take a cab home, when he offered.

Still not the same.

Phai:

I know, he's just not as handsome as me.

PLUS, he's taken.

I guess he does kinda have that DILF energy.

Bet his husband makes everyone jealous.

The kid is cute as well.

Mydei:

I can't believe…. No, I can.

I can believe you said that.

Please don't say that around him.

*(*He notices the box on the front seat. It's a pizza box from Evernight.*)*

At least you aren't going to other places to get that.

Everyone there would be offended.

You're dating the CEO

and going to a commercial chain....God.

Phai:

I wouldn't dream of it.

…

…

Hey

****a soft grunt was his reply****

I do really miss you.

It's so lonely.

I'm whining again.

Mydei:

Yea, me too, but soon.

I'm gonna have to work on this time frame next time this happens.

I just might say fuck it and bring you.

(Soft shoes can be heard in the background. A woman sits down beside him.)

Gorgo:

Good afternoon, Phainon.

Phai:

Ohhh uhmm..

Hi, Mrs. Kremnos.

Lovely to see you again.

Gorgo:

Phainon, really??

It was less than a week for Castorice to call me Mama G.

You are dating my son.

I hope you can be less stiff around me.

Phai:

Sorry, I just get nervous.

You're very important to him.

I just want….

Mydei:

‘Make a good impression’?

Again… we sleep together.

Phai:

****face becomes instantly red****

Dddduuuddeeeee..

Gorgo:

Mydei stop being proud of yourself.

He's all embarrassed now.

Anyway, I just came to check on you boys,

the next meeting is soon, unfortunately

So, I'm afraid I have to steal your lion.

This is the last one for the day, but it's longer.

Plus dinner.

I'll make sure he calls after.

Mydei:

Mother, you don't have to.

I have called him every night.

Phai:

Sometimes, he falls asleep on the phone.

I wait a good 5 minutes before I hang up.

Just till he's out.

Gorgo:

Well, dear, you take care,

and I'll see you whenever we get back.

****She leaves as effortlessly, as she arrived****

Mydei:

I guess I have to go.

Don't eat all that pizza in one go.

It would be bad for your system.

Phai:

Thanks.

*****smiling alot****

Go to your meeting,

the sooner you do, the closer you are to coming home.

Love you.

Mydei:

Yea, yea haikas. I love you, too.

Behave yourself till later.

¤¤¤¤¤¤¤

The call ends from Mydei's end. He's always been very weird at phone goodbyes. It may seem weird, but Phainon knows he cares. There was a part deep down inside that was just a bit happier getting to see his lion, more than just being tired at the end of the day.

He could tell Mydei felt the same.

All the time, he only got up because he had to, not because he wanted to. The want to get up deteriorated very quickly upon his move into the house. Mydei insisted they share the bedroom. It would have made dating very weird, having separate rooms. Phainon was given his own space, though.

The room down the hall, upper floor, on the outer wall was the perfect place for his computers. The house wasn't in line with anything outside, so all types of internet signals could reach him easily. The best thing for him? He

didn't have to share the internet with anyone. Being throttled down because there are too many people taking up bandwidth in one building is gone. Phainon was given full leeway to do whatever with the room.

Having a lot of tech initially made housing hard in his small apartment, but then it all had a place. Now he had so much more room for things. He even added some new items he's been itching to get his hands on.

Living in the same house, not so many cameras were needed. There's more than one person living in the abode now. The secrets in the bedroom, however, he still kept them just in case. Maybe he wanted to watch them later or catch a sneaky lion doing things while he was away.

Once back at the house, he ate in the kitchen. Phainon didn't want to drag leftovers all over the house. The ricotta and steak pizza would last him a few days. This pie, in particular, was extra special; he helped make it. Tons of pictures were taken of his schooling to show Mydei later.

Now he needed to go over the list:

Is the condo booked for the weekend? Check.

Grocery list finished? Check.

Prettiest flowers ordered? Check.

Sexy suit laid out? Check.

The most beautiful necklace with a gold sun and a silver moon that interlocked. Both getting the other's opposite piece?

Check.

“Well, now that this is all in order, I just have to make it through the rest of the week. It's going to take forever." The pizza he helped make was so good that he ate at least 4 pieces. All the slices were skinny to get the most out of the pie.

Soon. I just hope you love it.

~~~~~~

The week flew by in a flash. There were so many meetings he had attended in the past month, Mydei didn't want another for the next month. He might have to have Castorice schedule any requests for a very future date, unless it was urgent.

No more people. He was exhausted from seeing and listening to so much talking. Yes, the family ate together during the day, but there was no respite.

The plane ride was six hours long, taking his arrival time to around 4:30pm. Just enough time to take a nap. He wanted to be up when Phainon came home from work.

Or so he thought.

Closing the distance to home, the nearer they approached, a storm was passing through. The pilot had informed everyone that they were going to be an hour late.

A nudge shifted him out of a dreamless sleep. “Mydei, honey?”

“Hmph”

“Hey, you might want to text Kyros. We are going to be an hour late. We just hit a storm. Nothing bad, just a delay.”

The grumpy and sleepy look on her cub's face said everything. It was bad enough having all these meetings, not seeing his boyfriend, and now he had to wait longer to get home. He was not a happy kitty.

Fishing the phone from his jacket pocket, a quick text was sent. Informing his driver of the bad news. The reply was very quick.

I wonder if he took the day off for me. I guess that is what friends are for.

The reply was simple. Mydei was told to take his time and stay safe. He'll be there when the plane gets in. Not to worry about anything.
~~~~~~

His eyes couldn't stay open any longer. For the duration of the flight, Mydei was going back to bed. Deep down, he was hoping Phainon wasn't too sleepy to see him. So the more rest he got now, the longer they could stay up.

Phainon was worth it.

The rest of the flight went by in a flash for a sleepy passenger. Gorgo gently woke her son, informing him that they would be landing soon. Kyros must be watching the boards for the flight. He sent a text saying '*see you in 20 mins*'. Mydei was fully aware that even on a more private flight, unloading passengers and luggage would take a while.

The plane touched down at 5:30pm. Rain was still falling outside, but not enough to be disruptive. It cooled everything off. The smell of fall was in the air.

Leaving the terminal, Kyros was waiting for him. Engrossed in something on his phone.

"I didn't take you to play games on your phone?" A touch of sleepiness could be heard in his jab, but he was way more awake than earlier.

"No, sadly, that's my husband's thing with our daughter. He and Serena love to play either co-op or against each other. It's funny to watch. How are you feeling?"

"I guess ok after that nap. More like a sleep, I suppose." A faint grumble sound emanated from him.

"Hungry as well. I guess you slept through the meal on board?" Grabbing Mydei's on board luggage, they headed to the area where the rest was.

"Yea, that chair was almost better than any hotel bed."

"Well, let's hurry up and get your stuff. Then we can get you fed."

20 minutes later..

“I'll take you to get something to eat. I'm gonna text Theo to see if there is anything they want. I'll take it home after I drop you off.”

In reality, he texted Phainon to see how everything was going. His reply was good. All the food is done. Got a little burn on the inside of his arm from the oven, just wasn't at the right height. (The joys of being a chef).Phainon was finishing getting dressed right now.

I'm so excited for them. Even more so because of the work the puppy put into this. He's got this. Kyros smiled to himself.

Mydei was busy playing on his phone when the car stopped. Looking up, it didn't feel like a restaurant, more like a hotel or a business office. Kyros got out of the car, pulled out an umbrella, and came around to his side. Opening the door for him.

“Uhmm Kyros… Do we have the right place? This doesn't look like a place for food.” Getting out of the car, he was more confused than ever. The chef walked quietly beside him to the front door. The umbrella was closed, and Kyros fished for something in his jacket.

Grabbing Mydei's hand, a key was placed in it.

Room 702

Confusion was written all over the blond's face.

“You need to pick up dinner there. Get going.” With no more words being said, Kyros shushed him inside. Then promptly ‘leaving’ from the view of the confused lion. He went around back to the extra parking space. Phainon left his car unlocked for him to deposit the luggage. An envelope was left in the trunk with his name on it. Phainon had used Mydei's influence to show his appreciation. Buying Kyros a thank-you gift for everything. The hotel where they stayed, he got them a week's pass for it, with all the amenities and entertainment included.

He was so touched by it all, and Kyros knew he couldn't argue. When Phainon put his mind to it, there was no stopping.

The rest was up to them.

~~~~~~

The whole elevator ride to the top floor left the tired and hungry kitty in such a confused state. This wasn't someone's home or a place to get food. These were living condos. The only thing he could fathom was that a friend of Kyros' had food, but then he took off. Leaving him here. Questions just hanging in the air.

Nothing made sense.

Room 702

Taking a deep breath, the key was placed in and turned. Mydei was bewildered and didn't know what to expect.

"Hello?" Quietly, he walked in, but then his senses were hit with all sorts of things going on at once.

Classical music was playing. The soft sound of the rain could be heard against the windowpanes. The air was full of so many familiar smells. He knew them all by heart.

Cresting the opening of the hallway to the rest of the condo, he stopped. Breath was taken away to some far-off land. His amber eyes tried to take in everything he saw.

The ambiance of the rain. Medium length table with a beautiful bouquet of flowers adorning it. Candles are lighting the table in a soft glow.

His feet pulled him forward. His mind was trying to piece everything together. Fingers gently touching the red and black petals. "God, these are beautiful."

A voice from the bedroom, pulling his eyes towards it. "Not as beautiful as you, my Prince."

"Ph..ai..non??"
~~~~~~

“In the flesh.” Mydei couldn't take his eyes off the man coming toward him. Phainon’s suit perfectly mirrored his own. White suit with a black shirt and a striking blue tie. It all complemented his own black suit, black shirt, and a red tie, always in perfect sync with each other.

“What…what is all of this?”

Once close enough, Phainon picked up Mydei's hand, kissing the back. “I wanted to do something special for you. You always give so much to everyone, including me. Never asking anything in return. So, I wanted to give you something to show how much I love you. For all that you've done for me. Helped me understand my past. Been there through all my breakdowns. Everything. You mean so much to me.”

Just listening to him speak, Mydei was trying so hard to hold back the tears. Just seeing him was enough, but to have all these caring words spoken to him like a love poem. Then to have done all of this. The dam was so hard to hold back.

“Soo, I have a confession. Kyros was in on the whole thing.”

Mydei's face had the slightest bit of shock, but he wasn't surprised at all. Kyros has an amazing poker face.

“So after you left, I went to visit him to see if he'd teach me how to cook. Almost made me sad when he said you'd be happy with just grilled cheese, but then he was more than happy to teach me. Because my passion was that strong for you, he couldn't say no. Plus, it's you. So, over the past month, I learned how to cook you a full meal. I did it every day. Even on the weekends.”

“Really?? I don't buy that. You value your weekend sleep.” Folding his arms over his chest, a smile adorns his face.

“I did. Even when there were overnight people still there working in the morning..”

“Phainon… that’s from 2am till 10am. Are you really telling me you forwent your weekends to get up early?” He was still very skeptical.

Phainon pulled out his phone, showing him the gallery of his work. There were pics every day of progress. There were ones taken on the weekend with a time stamp of 7:10am.

“Anything for you.”

He couldn't hold back any longer, arms wrapped around Phainon's neck. His face nuzzled into the snow-white locks, smelling the sweet scent he's become so fond of. Arms came around his waist, pulling him in. After being gone so long, bombarded with meetings, and a longing that rivaled any poem, Mydei's tears were flowing. Caught by the snow before him. Everything was just so wonderful.

Phainon was wonderful.

Yes, he can sometimes be a pain. It was never done out of malice. He's always been playful. Possibly, if the accident never happened, the sun would be shining even brighter. It didn't matter. Mydei was home and being spoiled by the man he loves.

Pulling back, a deep blue napkin wiped his tears. Lips trying to kiss them all away.

“Hungry?” Loving lips touched the side of Mydie's face.

“I haven't eaten since this morning. I was too tired to eat on the flight.”

“Hey, before we eat, I have something for you.” Reaching into his pants pocket, Phainon pulls out a red velvet box. All neatly tied off with a black and gold bow.

“You didn't have to.”

“Yea, well I did, so no take-backsies.” There was that infectious smile Mydei had missed. There was something about it that warmed even the gloomiest days. That smile belonged to him and was so easy to get.

The ribbon was pulled and set aside on the counter. The box was slowly opened to jewelry that danced in the light. Two necklaces, interlocked in the middle. A half sun holding on to the moon. Almost like an eclipse. A rare thing in the night sky, just as rare as their love.

“I wanted to get us some kind of matching jewelry. Rings would be at a later date, but this we can keep closer to our hearts when the other isn't around.”

Wait.. did I hear him right? Rings?? At a later date?! He'd....really want to marry me? Shit…. I need not think about this right now, or I'm going to cry again.

Closing the box, it's placed on the counter. Amber eyes meet cerulean. Oceans of time just flow between them. Mydei wrapped his arms around the snow-white fields, getting lost in their soft feel again. Lips came together in a most tender kiss. It was slow but desperate. The time being apart has made their need for each other stronger.

They held this kiss in what felt like eternity. Neither wanted to let go, but oxygen was needed. Breaking apart to heavy breaths, foreheads against each other.

“Soo, are you going to let me woo you with my fantastic cooking?”

A light smirk and laugh left his kiss-swollen lips. “Is it though?” Not mean, just to tease.

“I would hope to fuck so.. or Kyros needs to go back to culinary school. And I worked on this for like a …”

Finger was placed on his lips.”It's ok. I'm just picking. I know what he demands of his cooks and even more so of himself. It wouldn't be as harsh with you, but wouldn't let you go easy either.”

“Yeaaa, he is a tough teacher. I had an easier time in tech school, but he was an amazing teacher.”

“Soo, tell me puppy, what did you make good?”

“Well, how about you sit down and I can serve you. Let someone take care of you for once.” Walking over to his seat, Phainon pulled out a chair for his love.

“Not that I don't appreciate it, but just to note: Prince, not Princess.” Part of him is having a hard time being pampered. Seeing how excited his puppy was over the whole thing, it was just something he'd have to get used to.

A kiss is placed on his cheek. “I know.” Walking away mumbling to himself; *Maybe princess in bed.*

“You'd better be glad I like you. I heard that smart ass comment.”

“It’s from an ass you love.” Plating up the starters. “Especially when I'm getting you to beg for more.”

“Haha, you are so insufferable, but…. You’re not wrong.’

With the smile on his face, Phainon knew he won.

Everything that Phainon is doing for him, the surprise hits Mydei right in the heart.

I don't think I could love this man any harder. It just sucks it took so long for us to meet. Now that I got him, I'm not letting go for anything. This is where I want to be.

Chapter End Notes

> Haha wasn't quite what you were expecing, was it? Oomf helped me though the story and thought that having something sweet would be a perfect way to end the story for these two. They have been through so much, so why not have something touching for the finale?
>
> Thank you so much for reading!!! I appreciate it so much!!

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

End Notes

How can Phainon's heart deal with being around his desire so much and that Mydei wants to be friends with him? So much of Phainon’s past is going to make this situation very difficult.

thank you so much for reading and support.<3

Strawpage
AsuranDreamz

Twitter
AsuranDreamz

Blogspot
AsuranDreamz Blog
All property of Mihoyo. not for AI training. No copy.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!